IELTS ACADEMIC READING

Volume 3

10 complete Academic Reading tests — three full passages and 40 questions each — with a complete answer key and passage evidence for every answer

IB

10
FULL TESTS

400
QUESTIONS

Full
ANSWER KEY

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Introduction

Welcome to **IELTS Academic Reading — Volume 3**, a printable practice book of 10 complete Reading tests, compiled and prepared by Teacher Ibodullaev Bekhruz.

Every test follows the real exam format: three passages of increasing difficulty and 40 questions covering the full range of IELTS question types — True/False/Not Given, Matching Headings, Matching Information, Multiple Choice, Summary and Sentence Completion, and more. Answer circles and blank lines are left for you to write your answers, just like on test day.

Part One contains all 10 tests with questions only, so you can practise without seeing any answers. **Part Two** contains the complete Answer Key for each test, with the keywords from each question and the exact sentence in the passage that proves the correct answer.

How to use this book:

- Sit each test in one go, under timed conditions — 60 minutes for all three passages.
- Write your answers directly in the circles and blanks provided.
- Check your answers in Part Two and read the passage evidence for every question you got wrong.
- Use the band-score table on the answer key pages to estimate your result, then revisit weak question types.

Good luck with your preparation, and follow **@bekhruzposts** for more free IELTS materials.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 1

Volume 3 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Fishbourne Roman Palace

The largest Roman villa in Britain

Fishbourne Roman Palace is in the village of Fishbourne near Chichester in West Sussex, England. This large palace was built in the 1st century AD, around thirty years after the Roman conquest of Britain, on the site of Roman army grain stores which had been established after the invasion, in the reign of the Roman Emperor Claudius in 43 AD. The rectangular palace was built around formal gardens, the northern half of which have been reconstructed. There were extensive alterations in the 2nd and 3rd centuries AD, with many of the original black and white mosaic floors being overlaid with more sophisticated coloured ones, including a perfectly preserved mosaic of a dolphin in the north wing. More alterations were in progress when the palace burnt down in around 270 AD, after which it was abandoned.

Local people had long believed that a Roman palace once existed in the area. However, it was not until 1960 that the archaeologist Barry Cunliffe, of Oxford University, first systematically excavated the site, after workmen had accidentally uncovered a wall while they were laying a water main. The Roman villa excavated by Cunliffe's team was so grand that it became known as Fishbourne Roman Palace, and a museum was erected to preserve some of the remains. This is administered by the Sussex Archaeological Society.

In its day, the completed palace would have comprised four large wings with colonnaded fronts. The north and east wings consisted of suites of private rooms built around courtyards, with a monumental entrance in the middle of the east wing. In the north-east corner there was an assembly hall. The west wing contained state rooms, a large ceremonial reception room, and a gallery. The south wing contained the owner's private apartments. The palace included as many as 50 mosaic floors, under-floor central heating and a bathhouse. In size, Fishbourne Palace would have been approximately equivalent to some of the great Roman palaces of Italy, and was by far the largest known Roman residence north of the European Alps, at about 500 feet (150m) square. A team of volunteers and professional archaeologists are involved in an ongoing archaeological excavation on the site of nearby, possibly military, buildings.

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The first buildings to be erected on the site were constructed in the early part of the conquest in 43 AD. Later, two timber buildings were constructed, one with clay and mortar floors and plaster walls, which appears to have been a house of some comfort. These buildings were demolished in the 60s AD and replaced by a substantial stone house, which included colonnades, and a bath suite. It has been suggested that the palace itself, incorporating the previous house in its south-east corner, was constructed around 73-75 AD. However, Dr Miles Russell, of Bournemouth University, reinterpreted the ground plan and the collection of objects found and has suggested that, given the extremely close parallels with the imperial palace of Domitian in Rome, its construction may more plausibly date to after 92 AD.

With regard to who lived in Fishbourne Palace, there are a number of theories; for example, one proposed by Professor Cunliffe is that, in its early phase, the palace was the residence of Tiberius Claudius Cogidubnus, a local chieftain who supported the Romans, and who may have been installed as king of a number of territories following the first stage of the conquest. Cogidubnus is known from a reference to him by the historian Tacitus in Agricola, and from an inscription commemorating a temple found in the nearby city of Chichester. Another theory is that the palace was designed for Sallustius Lucullus, a Roman governor of Britain of the late 1st century, who may have been the son of the British prince Adminius. Two inscriptions recording the presence of Lucullus have been found in Chichester, and the redating by Miles Russell to after AD 92 would be consistent with Lucullus' ownership. If the palace was built for Lucullus, it would have been confiscated following his execution by the Emperor Domitian in or shortly after 93 AD.

A further possibility is that either Verica, a British king in the period preceding the Claudian invasion, or Tiberius Claudius Catuarus, was the owner of the palace, the latter following the recent discovery of a gold ring belonging to him. A modern museum has been built by the Sussex Archaeological Society, incorporating most of the visible remains, including one wing of the palace. The gardens have been re-planted using authentic plants from the Roman period.

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Questions 1–6

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

1 Fishbourne Palace was the first structure to be built on its site.

2 Fishbourne Palace was renovated more than once.

3 Fishbourne Palace was large in comparison with Roman palaces in Italy.

4 Research is continuing in the area close to Fishbourne Palace.

5 Researchers agree on the identity of the person for whom Fishbourne Palace was constructed.

6 Fishbourne Palace was burnt down by local people.

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Questions 7–13

Complete the notes below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** *from the passage for each answer.*

Fishbourne Palace

CONSTRUCTION

- the first buildings on the site contained food for the (7) _____
- the palace building surrounded (8) _____
- in the 2nd and 3rd centuries colour was added to the (9) _____ of the palace

DISCOVERY

- the first part of the palace to be found was part of a (10) _____

POSSIBLE INHABITANTS

- Cogidubnus – he is named in several writings
- Sallustius Lucullus – he may have lived there until approximately (11) _____ AD
- Verica – a British king
- Catuarus – his (12) _____ was found there

PRESENT DAY

- a (13) _____ has been built on the site to help protect it

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Reading Passage 2

Insect Decision-making

A It has long been held that decisions made collectively by large groups of people are more likely to turn out to be accurate than decisions made by individuals. The idea goes back to the jury theorem of Nicolas de Condorcet, an 18th-century French philosopher who was one of the first to apply mathematics to the social sciences. Condorcet's theory describes collective decisions. If, for example, each member of a jury has only partial information, the majority decision is more likely to be correct than a decision arrived at by a single juror. Moreover, the probability of a correct decision increases with the size of the jury.

B Now it is becoming clear that group decisions are also extremely valuable for the success of social animals, such as ants, bees, birds and dolphins. Bees make collective decisions, and they do it rather well, according to Christian List of the London School of Economics, who has studied group decision-making in humans and animals. Researchers led by Dr List looked at colonies. Among the bees that depart to form a new colony are some that have searched for and found some new nest sites, and reported back using a characteristic body movement known as a 'waggle dance' to indicate to the other bees the suitable places they have located. The longer the dance, the better the site. After a while, other bees start to visit the sites signalled by their fellow workers and, on their return, also perform new waggle dances. The process eventually leads to a consensus on the best site and the breakaway swarm migrates. The decision is remarkably reliable, with the bees choosing the best site even when there are only small differences between alternative sites.

C But exactly how do bees reach such a robust consensus? To find out, Dr List and his colleagues used a computer-generated model of the decision-making process. By experimenting with it they found that, when bees in the model were very good at finding nesting sites but did not share their information, this dramatically slowed down the migration, leaving the swarm homeless and vulnerable. Conversely, problems also arose when bees in the model blindly followed the waggle dances of others without first checking. The researchers concluded that the ability of bees to identify successfully and quickly the best site depends on both the bees' interdependence in communicating the whereabouts of the best sites, and their independence in confirming this information for themselves.

D Another situation in which collective decisions are taken occurs when animals are either isolated from crucial sources of information or dominated by other members of the group. José Halloy of the Free University of Brussels in Belgium used robotic cockroaches to subvert the behaviour of living cockroaches. The artificial bugs were introduced to the live ones and soon became sufficiently socially integrated that they were perceived by the real

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cockroaches as equals. By manipulating the robots, which were in the minority, Halloy was able to persuade the living cockroaches to choose an inappropriate shelter, even one which they had rejected before being infiltrated by the robots.

E The way insects work out effective collective decisions can be as complex and as important as the decisions themselves. At the University of Bristol in the UK, Nigel Franks and his colleagues studied how a species of ant establishes a new nest. Franks and his associates wanted to know how the insects reduce the problems associated with making a necessarily swift choice. If the ants' existing nest becomes suddenly threatened, the insects choose certain ants to act as scouts to find a new nest.

F How quickly they accomplish the transfer to a new home depends not only on how soon the best available site is found, but also on how quickly the migration there can be achieved. Once the suitable new nest is identified, the chosen ants begin to lead others, which appear to stay behind, to the new site, by a method known as tandem running. The study emphasised the necessity, for people as well as insects, of having active leaders in order to execute decisions successfully.

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Questions 14–19

Reading Passage 2 has six paragraphs, **A–F**. *Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.*

LIST OF HEADINGS

i The effect of man-made imitations on insects
ii The need to instruct additional insect guides
iii Signals used by certain insects to indicate a discovery
iv How urgency can affect the process of finding a new home
v The use of trained insects in testing scientific theories
vi The use of virtual scenarios in the study of insect behaviour
vii How the number of decision-makers affects the decision

Q	Paragraph	Answer
14	Paragraph A	
15	Paragraph B	
16	Paragraph C	
17	Paragraph D	
18	Paragraph E	
19	Paragraph F	

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Questions 20–23

Look at the following findings and the list of academics below. Match each finding with the correct academic, **A–D**. *NB You may use any letter more than once.*

LIST OF ACADEMICS

A Nicolas de Condorcet

B Christian List and colleagues

C José Halloy

D Nigel Franks and colleagues

Q	Finding	Answer
20	Certain members can influence the rest of the group to alter a previous decision.	
21	Individual verification of a proposed choice is important for a successful decision outcome.	
22	The more individuals taking part in a decision, the better the decision will be.	
23	The decision-making process of certain insects produces excellent results even when fine distinctions are required.	

Questions 24–26

Complete the summary below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

A study of insect decision-making

A Bristol University study looked at how insects make decisions when their home has been (24) ————————. The ants in the experiment relied on the use of individuals called (25) ———————— to find a new nest and efficiently direct the others to go there. The study concluded that the effective implementation of the ants' decision meant that the insects could change homes quickly. The study emphasised the necessity, for people as well as insects, of having active (26) ———————— in order to execute decisions successfully.

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Reading Passage 3

Fear of the Unknown

American companies fear that innovation is the secret of success — and that they cannot innovate

A In the small Umagic office in midtown Manhattan, a team of 30 computer programmers are working on setting up websites that will allow subscribers to feed in details about themselves and their problems and to receive advice from 'virtual' versions of personalities regarded as experts in their fields: for example, a well-known dietician, a celebrity fitness trainer, a psychologist well known in the media for her work on parent-child relationships. Umagic Systems is a young firm and it's hard to predict how far they'll go. In ten years' time, consulting a computer about your diet problems might seem natural or it might seem absurd. But the company and others like it are beginning to seriously worry large American firms, who see such half-crazy new and innovative ideas as a threat to their own future success.

B Innovation has become a major concern of American management. Firms have found that it is increasingly difficult to redesign existing products or to produce them more economically. The stars of American business tend today to be innovators such as Amazon (the internet bookstore) and Wal-Mart (the supermarket chain) which have produced completely new ideas or products that have changed their industries.

C Over the past 15 years, the firms which have achieved the greatest profits have been the ones which have had the most innovations. But such profits aren't easy to come by. One of the reasons for the increasing number of mergers between companies is a desperate search for new ideas. And a fortune is spent nowadays on identifying and protecting intellectual property: other people's ideas. According to the Pasadena-based Patent & License Exchange in the United States, trading in intangible assets such as intellectual property rose from $15 billion in 1990 to $100 billion in 1998, with an increasing proportion of the rewards going to small firms and individuals.

D And therein lies the terror for big companies: that innovation seems to work best outside them. Many of the large established companies have been struggling to come up with new products recently. 'In the management of creativity, size is your enemy,' argues Peter Chemin, who runs the Fox TV and film empire for News Corporation. 'One person managing 20 movies is never going to be as involved as one doing five movies.' He has thus tried to break down the studio into smaller units, even at the risk of incurring higher costs.

E It is easier for ideas to develop outside big firms these days. In the past, if a clever scientist had an idea he wanted to commercialise, he would take it first to a big company. Now, with the banks encouraging individuals to set up new businesses through offering special loans, innovators are more likely to set up on their own. Umagic has already raised

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$5 million and is hoping to raise $25 million more. Even in capital-intensive businesses such as pharmaceuticals, entrepreneurs can conduct profitable, early-stage research, selling out to the big firms when they reach expensive, risky clinical trials.

F Some giants, including General Electric and Cisco, have been remarkably successful at buying up and integrating scores of small companies. But many others worry about the prices they have to pay and the difficulty in keeping hold of the people once they have acquired them. Everybody would like to develop more innovation in-house. Many companies now offer their most creative people extra rewards, freedom and resources, anything to stop them leaving to set up on their own.

G And yet there is a danger in getting carried away with this. Innovation is extremely difficult to keep up, year after year, especially the brilliant ideas. Underneath all the experts' diagrams, lists and charts, it is extremely difficult to commercialise an idea. Many people assume that it is the job of product designers to look first to the technology, but the available answers seem to focus on two strengths that are hard to impose: a culture that looks for new ideas, and leaders who are prepared to back them.

H Will all this reorganisation and culture tweaking make big firms more creative? David Post, the founder of Umagic, isn't so sure. He recalls with glee the looks of total incomprehension when he tried to sell his 'virtual experts' idea to firms such as IBM, though, as he cheerfully adds, of course they could have been right. Apparently, innovation - unlike diet, fitness and parenting - is one area where a computer cannot tell you what to do.

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Questions 27–33

Reading Passage 3 has eight paragraphs, **A–H**. *Which paragraph contains the following information? NB You may use any letter more than once.*

Q	Statement	Answer
27	the methods some companies use to try to keep their most creative employees	
28	a new way of getting help with your personal difficulties	
29	how much investment goes into safeguarding the ideas of individuals	
30	two examples of companies which have succeeded through being innovative	
31	how some innovators manage to avoid spending large sums of money on testing out their ideas	
32	a commonly held opinion about product designers that needs to be proved wrong	
33	the target of one large company that has changed its business focus	

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Questions 34–37

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 3?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

34 Umagic Systems is an example of a new innovative company.

35 Amazon and Wal-Mart have exchanged successful ideas on innovation.

36 Using financial rewards to encourage innovation is an outdated practice.

37 IBM failed to understand David Post's 'virtual experts' idea.

Questions 38–40

Choose the correct letter, **A, B, C** *or* **D**.

38 What does the writer say about innovation as intellectual property?

A It can be lost when firms merge.
B It tends to belong to companies rather than individuals.
C It is valued more than it used to be.
D It is not usually owned by small companies.

39 Peter Chemin is an example of someone who has realised that

A large companies are less innovative than small ones.
B other businesses are more innovative than the film business.
C his employees need more experience of innovation.
D he is the best person to encourage innovation.

40 In conclusion, the writer suggests that

A computer-based industries cannot be innovative.
B big firms are right to be cautious about innovation.
C small firms should not worry about early failures.
D innovation will always involve some uncertainty.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 2

Volume 3 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Bovids

The family of mammals called bovids belongs to the Artiodactyl class, which also includes giraffes. Bovids are a highly diverse group consisting of 137 species, some of which are man's most important domestic animals.

Bovids are well represented in most parts of Eurasia and Southeast Asian islands, but they are by far the most numerous and diverse in the latter. Some species of bovid are solitary, but others live in large groups with complex social structures. Although bovids have adapted to a wide range of habitats, from arctic tundra to deep tropical forest, the majority of species favour open grassland, scrub or desert. This diversity of habitat is also matched by great diversity in size and form: at one extreme is the royal antelope of West Africa, which stands a mere 25 cm at the shoulder; at the other, the massively built bisons of North America and Europe, growing to a shoulder height of 2.2m.

Despite differences in size and appearance, bovids are united by the possession of certain common features. All species are ruminants, which means that they retain undigested food in their stomachs, and regurgitate it as necessary. Bovids are almost exclusively herbivorous. Typically their teeth are highly modified for browsing and grazing: grass or foliage is cropped with the upper lip and lower incisors (the upper incisors are usually absent), then ground down by the cheek teeth. As well as having cloven, or split hooves, the males of all bovid species and the females of most carry horns. Bovid horns have bony cores covered in a sheath of horny material that is constantly renewed from within; they are unbranched and never shed. They vary in shape and size: the relatively simple horns of a large Indian buffalo may measure around 4 m from tip to tip along the outer curve, while the various gazelles have horns with a variety of elegant curves.

Five groups, or sub-families, may be distinguished: Bovinae, Antelope, Caprinae, Cephalophinae and Antilocapridae. The sub-family Bovinae comprises most of the larger bovids, including the African bongo, nilgae, eland, bison and cattle. Unlike most other bovids they are all non-territorial. The ancestors of the various species of domestic cattle - banteng, gaur, yak and water buffalo - are generally rare and endangered in the wild, while the ancestor of the domestic cattle of Europe, the auroch, is extinct. The term 'antelope' is not a very precise zoological name - it is used to loosely describe a number of bovids that have followed different lines of development. Antelopes are typically long-legged, fast-

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running species, often with long horns that may be laid along the back when the animal is in full flight. There are two main sub-groups of antelope: Hippotraginae, which includes the oryx and the addax, and Antilopinae, which generally contains slighter and more graceful animals such as the gazelle and the springbok. Antelopes are mainly grassland species, but many have adapted to flooded grasslands: pukus, waterbucks and lechwes are all good at swimming, usually feeding in deep water, while the sitatunga has long, splayed hooves that enable it to walk freely on swampy ground.

The sub-family Caprinae includes the sheep and the goat, together with various relatives such as the goral and the tahr. Most are woolly or have long hair. Several species, such as wild goats, chamois and ibex, are agile cliff and mountain-dwellers. Tolerance of extreme conditions is most marked in this group: Barbary and bighorn sheep have adapted to arid deserts, while Rocky Mountain sheep survive high up in mountains and musk oxen in arctic tundra.

The duiker of Africa belongs to the Cephalophinae sub-family. It is generally small and solitary, often living in thick forest. Although mainly feeding on grass and leaves, some duikers - unlike most other bovids - are believed to eat insects and feed on dead animal carcasses, and even to kill small animals.

The pronghorn is the sole survivor of a New World sub-family of herbivorous ruminants, the Antilocapridae in North America. It is similar in appearance and habits to the Old World antelope. Although greatly reduced in numbers since the arrival of Europeans, the pronghorn is still found in considerable numbers throughout North America, from Washington State to Mexico. When alarmed by the approach of wolves or other predators, hairs on the pronghorn's rump stand erect, so showing and emphasising the white patch there. At this signal, the whole herd gallops off at a speed of over 60 km per hour.

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Questions 1–3

Choose the correct letter, **A, B, C** *or* **D**.

1 In which region is the biggest range of bovids to be found?

A Africa
B Eurasia
C North America
D South-east Asia

2 Most bovids have a preference for living in

A isolation
B small groups
C tropical forest
D wide open spaces

3 Which of the following features do all bovids have in common?

A Their horns are short.
B They have upper incisors.
C They store food in the body.
D Their hooves are undivided.

Questions 4–8

Look at the following characteristics and the list of sub-families below. Match each characteristic with the correct sub-family, **A–D**. *NB You may use any letter more than once.*

LIST OF SUB-FAMILIES

A Antelope
B Bovinae
C Caprinae
D Cephalophinae

Q	Characteristic	Answer
4	can endure very harsh environments	
5	includes the ox and the cow	
6	may supplement its diet with meat	
7	can usually move at speed	
8	does not defend a particular area of land	

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Questions 9–13

Answer the questions below. Choose **NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

9 What is the smallest species of bovid called?

10 Which species of Bovinae has now died out?

11 What facilitates the movement of the sitatunga over wetland?

12 What sort of terrain have barbary sheep adapted to?

13 What is the only living member of the Antilocapridae sub-family?

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Reading Passage 2

Photovoltaics on the Rooftop

A natural choice for powering the family home

A In the past, urban home owners have not always had much choice in the way electricity is supplied to their homes. Now, however, there is a choice, and a rapidly increasing number of households worldwide are choosing the solar energy option. Solar energy, the conversion of sunlight into energy, is made possible through the use of 'photovoltaics', which are simple appliances that fit onto the roof of a house.

B The photovoltaics-powered home remains connected to the power lines, but no storage is required on-site, only a box of electronics (the inverter) to act as the interface between the photovoltaics and the grid network. Figure 1 illustrates the system. During the day, when the home may not be using much electricity, excess power from the solar array is fed back to the grid, to factories and offices that need daytime power. At night, power flows the opposite way. The grid network effectively provides storage. If the demand for electricity is well matched to when the sun shines, solar energy is especially valuable. This occurs in places like California in the US and Japan, where air-conditioning loads for offices and factories are large but heating loads for homes are small.

C The first systematic exploration of the use of photovoltaics on homes began in the US during the 1970s. A well-conceived program started with the setting up of a number of residential experiment stations at selected locations around the country, representing different climatic zones. These stations contained a number of 'dummy' houses, each with a different solar-energy system design. Homes within the communities close to these stations were monitored to see how well their energy use matched the energy generated by the stations' dummy roofs. A change in US government priorities in the early 1980s halted this program.

D With the US effort dropping away, the Japanese Sunshine Project came to the fore. A large residential test station was installed on Rokko Island beginning in 1986. This installation consists of 18 'dummy' homes, each equipped with its own 2-5 kilowatt photovoltaic system (about 20-50 square meters for each system). Some of these simulated homes have their own electrical appliances inside, such as TV sets, refrigerators and air conditioning units, which switch on and off under computer control, providing a lavish lifestyle for the non-existent occupants. For the other systems, electronics simulate these household loads. This test station has allowed the technical issues involved in using photovoltaics within the electricity network to be explored in a systematic way, under well-

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controlled test conditions. With no insurmountable problems identified, the Japanese have used the experience gained from this station to begin their own massive residential photovoltaics campaign.

E Meanwhile, Germany began a very important '1,000 roof program' in 1990, aimed at installing photovoltaics on the roofs of 1,000 private homes. Large federal and regional government subsidies were involved, accounting in most cases for 70% of the total system costs. The program proved immensely popular, forcing its extension to over 2,000 homes scattered across Germany. The success of this program stimulated European countries to launch similar programs.

F Japan's 'one million roof program' was prompted by the experience gained in the Rokko Island test site and the success of the German 1,000 roof program. The initially quoted aims of the Japanese New Energy Development Organization were to have 70,000 homes equipped with the photovoltaics by the year 2000, on the way to 1 million by 2010. The program made a modest start in 1994, when 539 systems were installed with a government subsidy of 50 percent. Under this program, entire new suburban developments are using photovoltaics.

G The Japanese initiative in embracing residential photovoltaics on a large scale prompted responses in both Europe and the US. The European Commission has called for one million solar residential systems before the year 2010, with 500,000 in Europe and 500,000 in the developing world, to be subsidised by the Commission. In 1997, a similar one million roof target was announced in the US. Since then, several other countries including Germany, Italy, the Netherlands and Australia, have announced their own targets for residential photovoltaics.

H This is good news, not only for the photovoltaic industry, but for everyone concerned with the environment. The use of fossil fuels to generate electricity is not only costly in financial terms, but also in terms of environmental damage. Gases produced by the burning of fossil fuels in the production of electricity are a major contributor to the greenhouse effect. To deal with this problem, many governments are now proposing stringent targets on the amount of greenhouse gas emissions permitted. These targets mean that all sources of greenhouse gas emissions, including residential electricity use, will receive closer attention in the future.

I It is likely that in the future, governments will develop building codes that attempt to constrain the energy demands of new housing. For example, the use of photovoltaics or the equivalent may be stipulated to lessen demands on the grid network and hence reduce fossil fuel emissions. Approvals for building renovations may also be conditional upon taking such energy-saving measures. If this were to happen, everyone would benefit.

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Although there is an initial cost in attaching the system to the rooftop, the householder's outlay is soon compensated with the savings on energy bills. In addition, everyone living on the planet stands to gain from the more benign environmental impact.

Questions 14–19

Reading Passage 2 has nine paragraphs, **A–I**. *Which paragraph contains the following information? NB You may use any letter more than once.*

Q	Statement	Answer
14	examples of countries where electricity use is greater during the day than at night	
15	a detailed description of an experiment that led to photovoltaics being promoted throughout the country	
16	the negative effects of using conventional means of generating electricity	
17	an explanation of the photovoltaics system	
18	the long-term benefits of using photovoltaics	
19	a reference to wealthy countries being prepared to help less wealthy countries have access to photovoltaics	

Questions 20–26

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 2?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

20 Photovoltaics are used to store electricity.

21 Since the 1970s, the US government has provided continuous support for the use of photovoltaics on homes.

22 The solar-powered houses on Rokko Island are uninhabited.

23 In 1994, the Japanese government was providing half the money required for installing photovoltaics on homes.

24 Germany, Italy, the Netherlands and Australia all have strict goals with regard to greenhouse gas emissions.

25 Residential electricity use is the major source of greenhouse gas emission.

26 Energy-saving measures must now be included in the design of all new homes and improvements to buildings.

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Reading Passage 3

How Should Reading Be Taught?

By Keith Rayner and Barbara R Foorman

A Learning to speak is automatic for almost all children, but learning to read requires elaborate instruction and conscious effort. Well aware of the difficulties, educators have given a great deal of thought to how they can best help children learn to read. No single method has triumphed. Indeed, heated arguments about the most appropriate form of reading instruction continue to polarise the teaching community.

B Three general approaches have been tried. In one, called whole-word instruction, children learn by rote how to recognise at a glance a vocabulary of 50 to 100 words. Then they gradually acquire other words, often through seeing them used over and over again in the context of a story. Speakers of most languages learn the relationship between letters and the sounds associated with them (phonemes). That is, children are taught how to use their knowledge of the alphabet to sound out words. This procedure constitutes a second approach to teaching reading - phonics. Many schools have adopted a different approach: the whole-language method. The strategy here relies on the child's experience with language. For example, students are offered engaging books and are encouraged to guess the words that they do not know by considering the context of the sentence or by looking for clues in the storyline and illustrations, rather than trying to sound them out. Many teachers adopted the whole-language approach because of its intuitive appeal. Making reading fun promises to keep children motivated, and learning to read depends more on what the student does than on what the teacher does. The presumed benefits of whole-language instruction led to its growing acceptance across America during the 1990s, and a movement away from phonics.

C However, many linguists and psychologists objected strongly to the abandonment of phonics in American schools. Why was this so? In short, because research had clearly demonstrated that understanding how letters relate to the component sounds in words is critically important in reading. This conclusion rests, in part, on knowledge of how experienced readers make sense of words on a page. Advocates of whole-language instruction have argued forcefully that people often derive meanings directly from print without ever determining the sound of the word. Some psychologists today accept this view, but most believe that reading is typically a process of rapidly sounding out words mentally. Compelling evidence for this comes from experiments which show that subjects often confuse homophones (words that sound the same, such as 'rose' and 'rows'). This supports the idea that readers convert strings of letters to sounds.

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D In order to evaluate different approaches to teaching reading, a number of experiments have been carried out, firstly with college students, then with school pupils. Investigators trained English-speaking college students to read using unfamiliar symbols such as Arabic letters (the phonics approach), while another group learned entire words associated with certain strings of Arabic letters (whole-word). Then both groups were required to read a new set of words constructed from the original characters. In general, readers who were taught the rules of phonics could read many more new words than those trained with a whole-word procedure. Classroom studies comparing phonics with either whole-word or whole-language instruction are also quite illuminating. One particularly persuasive study compared two programmes used in 20 first-grade classrooms. Half the students were offered traditional reading instruction, which included the use of phonics drills and applications. The other half were taught using an individualised method that drew from their experiences with language; these children produced their own booklets of stories and developed sets of words to be recognised (common components of the whole-language approach). This study found that the first group scored higher at year's end on tests of reading and comprehension.

E If researchers are so convinced about the need for phonics instruction, why does the debate continue? Because the controversy is enmeshed in the philosophical differences between traditional and progressive (or new) approaches, differences that have divided educators for years. The progressives challenge the results of laboratory tests and classroom studies on the basis of a broad philosophical scepticism about the values of such research. They champion student-centred learning and teacher empowerment. Sadly, they fail to realise that these very admirable educational values are equally consistent with the teaching of phonics.

F If schools of education insisted that would-be reading teachers learned something about the vast research in linguistics and psychology that bears on reading, their graduates would be more eager to use phonics and would be prepared to do so effectively. They could allow their pupils to apply the principles of phonics while reading for pleasure. Using whole-language activities to supplement phonics instruction certainly helps to make reading fun and meaningful for children, so no one would want to see such tools discarded. Indeed, recent research has indicated that the combination of literature-based instruction and phonics is more powerful than either method used alone. Teachers need to strike a balance. But in doing so, we urge them to remember that reading must be grounded in a firm understanding of the connections between letters and sounds. Educators who deny this reality are neglecting decades of research. They are also neglecting the needs of their students.

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Questions 27–31

Reading Passage 3 has six sections, **A–F**. *Choose the correct heading for sections* **B–F** *from the list of headings below.*

Example: Section A — **ix** *(given)*

LIST OF HEADINGS

i Disagreement about the reading process
ii The roots of the debate
iii A combined approach
iv Methods of teaching reading
v A controversial approach
vi Inconclusive research
vii Research with learners
viii Allowing teachers more control
ix A debate amongst educators *(used in example)*

Q	Section	Answer
27	Section B	
28	Section C	
29	Section D	
30	Section E	
31	Section F	

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Questions 32–36

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 3?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

32 The whole-language approach relates letters to sounds.

33 Many educators believe the whole-language approach to be the most interesting way to teach children to read.

34 Research supports the theory that we read without linking words to sounds.

35 Research has shown that the whole-word approach is less effective than the whole-language approach.

36 Research has shown that phonics is more successful than both the whole-word and whole-language approaches.

Questions 37–40

Complete the summary of sections E and F using the list of words, **A–G**, *below.*

LIST OF WORDS

A the phonics method
B the whole-word method
C the whole-language method
D traditionalists
E progressives
F linguistics
G research studies

In the teaching community, 37 _____ question the usefulness of research in methods of teaching reading. These critics believe that 38 _____ is incompatible with student-centred learning. In the future, teachers need to be aware of 39 _____ so that they understand the importance of phonics. They should not, however, ignore the ideas of 40 _____ which make reading enjoyable for learners.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 3

Volume 3 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

The Pesticide-free Village

Gerry Marten and Dona Glee Williams report on the Indian village of Punukula, so nearly destroyed by reliance on pesticides

Around 25 years ago, a handful of families migrated from the Guntur district of Andhra Pradesh, south-east India, into Punukula, a community of around 900 people farming plots of between two and ten acres. The outsiders from Guntur brought cotton culture with them, and this attracted resident farmers by promising to bring in more hard cash than the mixed crops they were already growing to eat and sell, such as millet, mung beans, chilli and rice. But growing cotton meant using pesticides and fertilisers - until then a mystery to the mostly illiterate farmers of the community.

Local agrochemical dealers obligingly filled the need for information and supplies. These 'middlemen' sold commercial seeds, fertilisers and insecticides on credit, and guaranteed purchase of the crop. They offered technical advice provided by the companies that supplied their products. The farmers depended on the dealers. If they wanted to grow cotton - and they did - it seemed they had no choice.

A quick 'high' of booming yields and incomes hooked growers during the early years of cotton in the region. Outlay on insecticides was fairly low because cotton pests hadn't moved in yet. Many farmers were so impressed with the chemicals that they started using them on their other crops as well. The immediate payoffs from chemically-dependent cotton agriculture obscured the fact that the fields had gone into a freefall of environmental degradation, dragged down by a chain of cause and effect.

Soon cotton-eaters, such as bollworms and aphids, plagued the fields. Repeated spraying killed off the most susceptible pests and left the strongest to reproduce and pass on their resistance to generations of ever-hardier offspring. As the bugs grew tougher and more abundant, farmers applied a greater variety and quantity of poisons, sometimes mixing 'cocktails' of as many as ten insecticides. At the same time, cotton was gobbling up the nutrients in the soil, leaving the growers no option but to invest in chemical fertilisers.

By the time some farmers tried to break free of their chemical dependence, insecticides had already decimated the birds, wasps, beetles, and other predators that had once provided natural control of crop pests. Without their balancing presence, pests ran riot if

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insecticide was cut back. As outlays for fertilisers and insecticides escalated, the cost of producing cotton outgrew the cash value of the crop, and farmers fell further and further into debt and poverty. Their farming cycle was only broken by the willingness of a prominent village elder to experiment with something different.

He had been among the first villagers to grow cotton, and he would be the first to try it without chemicals, as set out by a programme in Non-Pesticide Management (NPM). This had been devised for Punukula with the help of a Non-Government Organisation called SECURE that had become aware of the hardships caused by the pesticide trap.

It involved turning to neem, a fast-growing, broad-leaved evergreen tree related to mahogany. Neem protects itself against insects by producing a multitude of natural pesticides that have evolved specifically to defeat plant-eating insects. Thus they are generally harmless to humans and other animals, including birds and insects that eat pests.

The plant is native to India and Burma, where it has been used for centuries to control pests and to promote health. To protect cotton, neem seeds are simply ground into a powder, soaked overnight in water and sprayed onto the crop at least every 10 days. Neem cake applied to the soil kills pests and doubles as an organic fertiliser high in nitrogen. As neem grows locally and is easy to process, it is much less expensive than the chemical insecticides sold for profit by the dealers and their corporate suppliers.

Quick, short-term gains had once pushed Punukula into chemical-dependent agriculture. Now they found that similar immediate rewards were helping to speed change in the other direction: the harvest of the next 20 NPM farmers was as good as the harvest of farmers using insecticides, and they came out ahead because they weren't buying insecticides. Instead of investing cash (in short supply) in chemicals, they invested time and labour in NPM practices.

By the end of 2000, all the farmers in Punukula village were using NPM rather than chemicals for cotton, and they began to use it on other crops as well. The change gathered momentum as NPM became even more effective once everyone was using it. The status and economic opportunities of women improved - neem became a source of income for some of them, as they gathered seeds from the surrounding area and produced neem cakes to sell for NPM in other villages. The improved situation meant that families could afford to put more land under cultivation.

In 2004, the panchayat (village government) formally declared Punukula to be a pesticide-free village. And they have big plans for the future, such as water purification. The village now serves as a model for disseminating NPM to other communities, with around 2000

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farmers visiting each year. What began as a few farmers desperate to find a way to farm without poisons has become a movement with the potential to pull an entire region back from ecological disaster.

Questions 1–4

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

1. Cotton growing was expected to raise more money than other crops.
2. Some of the local agrochemical dealers had been farmers in the past.
3. Initially the farmers' cotton yields were low.
4. At first, the farmers failed to notice the negative effects on their fields of pesticide use.

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Questions 5–10

Complete the notes below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

Non-Pesticide-Management Programme

- Developed with the aid of SECURE
- Based on use of an (5) _____ called neem
- Neem contains many (6) _____ that target plant-eating predators

NEEM

Used as a pesticide

- (7) _____ formed by grinding seeds
- left (8) _____ to soak in water
- sprayed regularly

Used as a pesticide and as a fertiliser

- added in (9) _____ form to soil
- contains a lot of (10) _____

Questions 11–13

Answer the questions below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** *from the passage for each answer.*

(11) In which year did farmers finally stop using chemicals on cotton crops in Punukula?

(12) What did the women of Punukula produce and sell to make money?

(13) What project do the authorities in Punukula hope to set up in the future?

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Reading Passage 2

New Filter Promises Clean Water for Millions

An ingenious invention is set to bring clean water to developing countries, and the materials are extremely down to earth

A handful of clay, yesterday's coffee grounds and some cow manure are the ingredients that could bring clean, safe drinking water to many developing countries. The simple new technology, developed by Australian National University (ANU) materials scientist and potter Tony Flynn, allows water filters to be made from commonly available materials and fired (or baked) using cow manure as the source of heat, without the need for a kiln (an oven for baking or drying pottery). The filters have been tested and shown to remove common pathogens (disease-producing organisms) including E-coli.

The invention was born out of a project involving the Manatuto community in East Timor. A charity operating there wanted to help set up a small industrial site manufacturing water filters, but initial research found the local clay to be too fine - a problem solved by the addition of organic material. While the problems of producing a working ceramic filter in East Timor were overcome, the solution was kiln-based and particular to that community's materials and couldn't be applied elsewhere. Flynn's technique for manure firing, with no requirement for a kiln, has made this zero technology approach available anywhere it is needed.

Other commercial clay filters do exist, but, even if available, with prices starting at US$5 each, they are often outside the budgets of most people in the developing world. Unlike other water filtering devices, Flynn's filters are inexpensive and simple to produce. Take a handful of clay, mix it with a handful of organic material such as used tea leaves, coffee grounds or rice hulls, add water in a sufficient quantity to make a stiff mixture and form a cylindrical pot that has one end closed, then dry it in the sun. According to Flynn, used coffee grounds have given the best results to date. The walls of the filter can be measured using the width of an adult finger as the standard. Next, surround the pots with straw, put them in a mound of cow manure, light the straw and then top up the burning manure as required. The filters are finished in 45 to 60 minutes.

The properties of cow manure are vital, as the fuel can reach a temperature of 700 degrees in half an hour, and will be up to 950 degrees after another 20 to 30 minutes. The manure makes a good fuel because it is very high in organic material that burns readily and quickly. The manure has to be dry and is best used straight from the field; there is no need to break it up or process it any further. In contrast, a potter's kiln is an expensive item and can take up to four or five hours to get up to 800 degrees. It needs expensive, scarce fuel,

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such as gas or wood, to heat it, and experience to use it. With no technology, no insulation and nothing other than a pile of cow manure and a match, none of these requirements apply.

It is also helpful that, like clay and organic material, cow manure is freely available across the developing world. A cow is a natural fuel factory. Manure is a mixture of vegetable materials of different sizes, and cow manure as a fuel is much the same wherever it is found.

Just as using manure as a fuel for domestic use is not a new idea, the fact that liquid can pass through clay objects is something that potters have always known, and clay's porous nature is something that, as a former ceramics lecturer in the ANU School of Art, Flynn is well aware of. The difference is that, rather than viewing the porous nature of the material as a problem - after all, not many people want a pot that won't hold water - his filters capitalise on this property.

The filtration process is simple, but effective. The basic principle is that there are passages through the filter that are wide enough for water droplets to pass through, but too narrow for pathogens. Tests with the deadly E-coli bacterium have seen the filters remove 96.4 to 99.8 per cent of the pathogen - well within safe levels. The thickness of the clay container needs to be the same thickness as an adult finger for the process to be effective. If this is the case, using only one filter, a litre of water can be obtained in two hours.

The use of organic material, which burns away leaving cavities after firing, helps produce the structure in which pathogens will become trapped. It overcomes the potential problems of finer clays that may not let water through and also means that cracks are soon halted. And like clay and cow manure, organic material is universally available in the developing communities that need most assistance, as tea, coffee and rice are grown in these areas.

With all the components being widely available, Flynn says there is no reason the technology couldn't be applied throughout the developing world. He has no plans to exploit his idea financially by registering ownership through a patent. If he did, any commercial copying would legally entitle him to a share in any profits made. Without a patent, there will be no illegality in it being adopted in any community that needs it. 'Everyone has a right to clean water, and these filters have the potential to enable anyone in the world to drink water safely,' says Flynn.

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Questions 14–19

Complete the flow-chart below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** *from the passage for each answer.*

Step-by-step guide to making Flynn's water filters

► Make the mixture for the filter from organic material (e.g. tea, coffee, rice),

(14) _____ and (15) _____.

► Shape into pots and place them in a fire made from (16) _____ and

(17) _____.

► Fuel the fire to reach a maximum heat of (18) _____.

► Remove the filters from the fire.

► Bake the filters in the fire for a maximum period of (19) _____.

Questions 20–23

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 2?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

(20) The clay in the Manatuto project was initially unsuitable for the project's purpose.

(21) Coffee grounds produce filters that are twice as efficient as those using other organic materials.

(22) It takes half an hour for a cow-manure fire to reach 950 degrees.

(23) E-coli is the most difficult bacterium to remove from water by filtration.

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Questions 24–26

Choose the correct letter, **A, B, C** *or* **D**.

24 The Manatuto project aimed to set up a

A charitable trust.
B filtration experiment.
C water filter factory.
D community kiln.

25 To be effective, the Flynn filters must

A remove all dangerous pathogens.
B be a particular thickness.
C filter water as quickly as possible.
D be made from 100 per cent clay.

26 Flynn does not intend to patent his filter because he

A wants it to be freely available.
B has produced a very simple design.
C cannot make a profit in poor countries.
D has already given the idea to a charity.

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Reading Passage 3

Putting the Brakes on Climate Change

Are hydrogen cars the answer?

A It is tempting to think that the conservation of coral reefs and rainforests is a separate issue from traffic and air pollution. But it is not. Scientists are now confident that rapid changes in the Earth's climate are already disrupting and altering many wildlife habitats. Pollution from vehicles is a big part of the problem.

B The United Nation's Climate Change Panel has estimated that the global average temperature rise expected by the year 2100 could be as much as 6°C, causing forest fires and dieback on land and coral bleaching in the ocean. Few species, if any, will be immune from the changes in temperature, rainfall and sea levels. The panel believes that if such catastrophic temperature rises are to be avoided, the quantity of greenhouse gases, especially carbon dioxide, being released into the atmosphere must be reduced. That will depend on slowing the rate of deforestation and, more crucially, finding alternatives to coal, oil and gas as our principal energy sources.

C Technologies do exist to reduce or eliminate carbon dioxide as a waste product of our energy consumption. Wind power and solar power are both spreading fast, but what are we doing about traffic? Electric cars are one possible option, but their range and the time it takes to charge their batteries pose serious limitations. However, the technology that shows the most potential to make cars climate-friendly is fuel-cell technology. This was actually invented in the late nineteenth century, but because the world's motor industry put its effort into developing the combustion engine, it was never refined for mass production. One of the first prototype fuel-cell-powered vehicles has been built by the Ford Motor Company. It is like a conventional car, only with better acceleration and a smoother ride. Ford engineers expect to be able to produce a virtually silent vehicle in the future.

D So what's the process involved - and is there a catch? Hydrogen goes into the fuel tank, producing electricity. The only emission from the exhaust pipe is water. The fuel-cell is, in some ways, similar to a battery, but unlike a battery it does not run down. As long as hydrogen and oxygen are supplied to the cell, it will keep on generating electricity. Some cells work off methane and a few use liquid fuels such as methanol, but fuel-cells using hydrogen probably have the most potential. Furthermore, they need not be limited to transport. Fuel-cells can be made in a huge range of size, small enough for portable computers or large enough for power stations. They have no moving parts and therefore need no oil. They just need a supply of hydrogen. The big question, then, is where to get it from.

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E One source of hydrogen is water. But to exploit the abundant resource, electricity is needed, and if the electricity is produced by a coal-fired power station or other fossil fuel, then the overall carbon reduction benefit of the fuel-cell disappears. Renewable sources, such as wind and solar power, do not produce enough energy for it to be economically viable to use them in the 'manufacture' of hydrogen as a transport fuel. Another source of hydrogen is, however, available and could provide a supply pending the development of more efficient and cheaper renewable energy technologies. By splitting natural gas (methane) into its constituent parts, hydrogen and carbon dioxide are produced. One way round the problem of what to do with the carbon dioxide could be to store it back below ground - so-called geological sequestration. Oil companies, such as Norway's Statoil, are experimenting with storing carbon dioxide below ground in oil and gas wells.

F With freak weather conditions, arguably caused by global warming, frequently in the headlines, the urgent need to get fuel-cell vehicles onto the market is obvious. Even now, fuel-cell buses are operating in the US, while in Germany a courier company is planning to take delivery of fuel-cell-powered vans in the near future. The fact that centrally-run fleets of buses and vans are the first fuel-cell vehicles identifies another challenge - fuel distribution. The refuelling facilities necessary to top up hydrogen-powered vehicles are available only in a very few places at present. Public transport and delivery firms are logical places to start, since their vehicles are operated from central depots.

G Fuel-cell technology is being developed right across the automotive industry. This technology could have a major impact in slowing down climate change, but further investment is needed if the industry - and the world's wildlife - is to have a long-term future.

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Questions 27–32

Reading Passage 3 has seven paragraphs, **A–G**. *Choose the correct heading for paragraphs* **A–F** *from the list of headings below.*

LIST OF HEADINGS

i Action already taken by the United Nations
ii Marketing the hydrogen car
iii Making the new technology available worldwide
iv Some negative predictions from one group of experts
v How the new vehicle technology works
vi The history of fuel-cell technology
vii A holistic view of climate change
viii Locating the essential ingredient
ix Sustaining car manufacture

Q	Paragraph	Answer
27	Paragraph A	
28	Paragraph B	
29	Paragraph C	
30	Paragraph D	
31	Paragraph E	
32	Paragraph F	

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Questions 33–36

Complete the sentences below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

33 In the late nineteenth century, the car industry invested in the development of the _____ rather than fuel-cell technology.

34 Ford engineers predict that they will eventually design an almost _____ car.

35 While a fuel-cell lasts longer, some aspects of it are comparable to a _____.

36 Fuel-cells can come in many sizes and can be used in power stations and in _____ as well as in vehicles.

Questions 37–40

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 3?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

37 Using electricity produced by burning fossil fuels to access sources of hydrogen may increase the positive effect of the fuel-cell.

38 The oil company Statoil in Norway owns gas wells in other parts of the world.

39 Public transport is leading the way in the application of fuel-cell technology.

40 More funding is necessary to ensure the success of the fuel-cell vehicle industry.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 4

Volume 3 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

The Wonder Plant

Bamboo is used for a wide range of purposes, but now it seems it may be under threat

A Every year, during the rainy season, the mountain gorillas of central Africa migrate to the lower slopes of the Virunga Mountains to graze on bamboo. For the 650 or so that remain in the wild, it's a vital food source. Without it, says Ian Redmond, chairman of the Ape Alliance, their chances of survival would be reduced significantly. Gorillas aren't the only ones keen on bamboo. For the people who live close to the Virungas, it's a valuable and versatile raw material. But in the past 100 years or so, resources have come under increasing pressure as populations have exploded and large areas of bamboo forest have been cleared to make way for commercial plantations. Sadly, this isn't an isolated story. All over the world, the ranges of many bamboo species that depend on them are shrinking, endangering the people and animals that depend upon them.

B Despite bamboo's importance, we know surprisingly little about it. A recent report published by the UN Environment Programme (UNEP) and the International Network for Bamboo and Rattan (INBAR) has revealed just how profound our ignorance of global bamboo resources is, particularly in relation to conservation. There are almost 1,600 recognised species of bamboo, but the report concentrated on the 1,200 or so woody varieties distinguished by the strong stems, or 'culms', that most people associate with this versatile plant. Of these, only 38 'priority species' identified for their commercial value have been the subject of any real scientific research to date. This problem isn't confined to bamboo. Compared to the work carried out on animals, the science of assessing the conservation status of plants is still in its infancy. 'People have only started looking at the problem over the past 10-15 years, and only now are they understanding how to go about it systematically,' says Dr Valerie Kapos, one of the report's authors.

C Bamboo tends to grow in 'stands' (or groups) made up of individual plants that grow from roots known as rhizomes. It is the world's fastest-growing woody plant and some species grow over a metre in one day. But the plant's ecological role extends beyond providing food for wildlife. Its rhizome systems, which lie in the top layers of the soil, are crucial in preventing soil erosion. And there is growing evidence that bamboo plays an important part in determining forest structure and dynamics. 'Bamboo's pattern of mass flowering and mass death leaves behind large areas of dry biomass that attract wildfire,'

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says Kapos. 'When these burn, they create patches of open ground far bigger than would be left by a fallen tree. Patchiness helps to preserve diversity because certain plant species do better during the early stages of regeneration when there are gaps in the canopy.'

D However, bamboo's most immediate significance lies in its economic value. Many countries, particularly in Asia, are involved in the trade of bamboo products. Modern processing techniques mean it can be used in a variety of ways, for example as flooring and laminates. Traditionally it is used in construction, but one of the fastest growing bamboo products is paper - 25 per cent of paper produced in India is made from bamboo fibre. Of course, bamboo's main function has always been in domestic applications, and as a locally traded product it is worth about US$4.5 billion annually. Bamboo is often the only readily available raw material for people in many developing countries, says Chris Stapleton, a research associate at the UK's Royal Botanic Gardens. 'Bamboo can be harvested from forest areas or grown quickly elsewhere, and then converted simply without expensive machinery or facilities,' he says. 'In this way, it contributes substantially to poverty alleviation.'

E Keen horticulturists will spot an apparent contradiction in the worrying picture painted by the UNEP-INBAR report. Those in the West who've followed the recent vogue for cultivating exotic species in their gardens will point out that, if it isn't kept in check, bamboo can cause real problems. 'In a lot of places, the people who live with bamboo don't perceive it as being under threat in any way,' says Kapos. 'In fact, a lot of bamboo species are very invasive if they've been introduced.' So why are so many species endangered? There are two separate issues here, says Ray Townsend, arboretum manager at the Royal Botanic Gardens. 'Some plants are threatened because they can't survive in the habitat - they aren't strong enough or there aren't enough of them, perhaps. But bamboo can take care of itself - it's strong enough to survive if left alone. What is under threat is its habitat. When forest goes, it's converted into something else: then there isn't anywhere for forest plants such as bamboo to grow.'

F Around the world, bamboo species are routinely protected as part of forest ecosystems in national parks and reserves, but there is a view that protects bamboo in the wild for its own sake. The UNEP-INBAR report will help conservationists to establish effective measures aimed at protecting valuable wild bamboo species. Townsend, too, sees the UNEP-INBAR report as an important step forward in promoting the cause of bamboo conservation. 'Until now, bamboo has been perceived as a second-class plant. When you talk about places like the Amazon, everyone always thinks about hardwoods. Of course, these are significant but there's a tendency to overlook the plants they are associated with, which are often bamboo species.'

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Questions 1–7

Reading Passage 1 has six sections, **A–F**. *Which section contains the following information? NB You may use any letter more than once.*

Q	Statement	Answer
1	an assessment of current levels of knowledge about bamboo	
2	a comparison between bamboo and more fragile plants	
3	details of the commercial significance of bamboo	
4	a human development that is threatening the availability of bamboo	
5	a description of the limited extent of existing research on bamboo	
6	examples of the uses to which bamboo is put	
7	an explanation of how bamboo may contribute to the survival of a range of plants	

Questions 8–11

Look at the following statements and the list of people below. Match each statement with the correct person, **A–D**. *NB You may use any letter more than once.*

LIST OF PEOPLE

A Ian Redmond

B Valerie Kapos

C Chris Stapleton

D Ray Townsend

Q	Statement	Answer
8	Some people do not regard bamboo as an endangered plant species.	
9	A scarcity of bamboo places certain wildlife under threat.	
10	Research methods investigating endangered plants have yet to be fully developed.	
11	The greatest danger to bamboo is disturbance of the places it grows in.	

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Questions 12 and 13

Answer the questions below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

12 What ecological problem do the roots of bamboo help to control?

13 Which bamboo product is undergoing market expansion?

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Reading Passage 2

Renewable Energy

An insight into the progress in renewable energy research

The race is on for the ultimate goal of renewable energy: electricity production at prices that are competitive with coal-fired power stations, but without coal's pollution. Some new technologies are aiming to be the first to push coal from its position as Australia's chief source of electricity.

At the moment the front-runner in renewable energy is wind technology. According to Peter Bergin of Australian Hydro, one of Australia's leading wind energy companies, there have been no dramatic changes in windmill design for many years, but the cumulative effects of numerous small improvements have had a major impact on cost. 'We're reaping the benefits of 30 years of research in Europe, without having to make the same mistakes that they did,' Mr Bergin says.

Electricity can be produced from coal at around 4 cents per kilowatt-hour, but only if the environmental costs are ignored. 'Australia has the second cheapest electricity in the world, and this makes it difficult for renewables to compete,' says Richard Hunter of the Australian Ecogeneration Association (AEA). Nevertheless, the AEA reports: 'The production cost of a kilowatt-hour of wind power is one fifth of what it was 20 years ago,' or around 7 cents per kilowatt-hour.

Australian Hydro has dozens of wind monitoring stations across Australia as part of its aim to become Australia's pre-eminent renewable energy company. Despite all these developments, wind power remains one of the few forms of alternative energy where Australia is nowhere near the global cutting edge, mostly just replicating European designs.

While wind may currently lead the way, some consider a number of technologies under development have more potential. In several cases, Australia is at the forefront of global research in the area. Some of them are very site-specific, ensuring that they may never become dominant market players. On the other hand, these new developments are capable of providing more reliable power, avoiding the major criticism of windmills - the need for back-up on a calm day.

One such development uses hot, dry rocks. Deep beneath South Australia, radiation from elements contained in granite heats the rocks. Layers of insulating sedimentation raise the temperatures in some locations to 250 degrees centigrade. An Australian firm, Geoenergy, is proposing to pump water 3.5 kilometres into the earth, where it will travel through tiny fissures in the granite, heating up as it goes, until it escapes as steam through another

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drilled hole. No greenhouse gases are produced, but the system needs some additional features if it is to be environmentally friendly. Dr Prue Chopra, a geophysicist at the Australian National University and one of the founders of Geoenergy, notes that the steam will bring with it radon gas, which must be passed through a heat exchanger and then sent back underground for another cycle. Technically speaking, hot dry rocks are not a renewable source of energy. However, the Australian source is so large it could supply the entire country's needs for thousands of years at current rates of consumption.

Two other proposals for very different ways to harness sun and wind energy have surfaced recently. Progress continues with Australian company EnviroPower's plans for Australia's first solar chimney near Mildura, in Victoria. Under this scheme, a tall tower will draw hot air from a greenhouse built to cover the surrounding 5km². As the air rises, it will drive a turbine to produce electricity. The solar tower combines three very old technologies - the chimney, the turbine and the greenhouse - to produce something quite new. It is this reliance on proven engineering principles that led Enviropower's CEO, Richard Davies, to state: 'There is no doubt this technology will work, no doubt at all.'

This year, Enviropower recognised that the quality of sunlight in the Mildura district will require a substantially larger collecting area than was previously thought. However, spokesperson Kay Firth says that a new location closer to Mildura will enable Enviropower to balance the increased costs with extra revenue. Besides saving in transmission costs, the new site 'will mean increased revenue from tourism and use of power for telecommunications. We'll also be able to use the other 500 metres for agribusiness.'

Another Australian company, Wavetech, is achieving success with ways of harvesting the energy in waves. Wavetech's invention uses a curved surface to push waves into a chamber, where the flowing water column pushes air back and forth through a turbine. Wavetech was created when Dr Tim Devine offered the idea to the world leader in wave generator manufacturers, who rather surprisingly rejected it. Dr Devine responded by establishing Wavetech, and making a number of other improvements to generator design. Wavetech claims that, at appropriate sites, 'the cost of electricity produced with our technology should be below 4 cents per kilowatt-hour.'

The diversity of forms of greenhouse-friendly energy development in Australia is remarkable. However, support on a national level is disappointing. According to Richard Hunter of the AEA, 'Australia has huge potential for wind, sun and wave technology. We should really be at the forefront, but the reality is we are a long way behind.'

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Questions 14–20

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 2?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

14 In Australia, alternative energies are less expensive than conventional electricity.

15 Geoenergy needs to adapt its system to make it less harmful to the environment.

16 Dr Prue Chopra has studied the effects of radon gas on the environment.

17 Hot, dry rocks could provide enough power for the whole of Australia.

18 The new Enviropower facility will keep tourists away.

19 Wavetech was established when its founders were turned down by another company.

20 According to the AEA, Australia is a world leader in developing renewable energy.

Questions 21–26

Look at the following statements and the list of companies below. Match each statement with the correct company, **A–D**. *NB You may use any letter more than once.*

LIST OF COMPANIES

A Australian Hydro

B Geoenergy

C Enviropower

D Wavetech

Q	Statement	Answer
21	During the process, harmful substances are prevented from escaping.	
22	Used to force air through a special device.	
23	Techniques used by other countries are being copied.	
24	Provides services other than electricity production.	
25	It is planned to force water deep under the ground.	
26	Original estimates for part of the project have been revised.	

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Reading Passage 3

Inside the Mind of a Fan

How watching sport affects the brain

A At about the same time that the poet Homer invented the epic hero, the ancient Greeks started a festival in which men competed in a single race, about 200 metres long. The winner received a branch of wild olives. The Greeks called this celebration the Olympics. Though the ancient sprint remains, today the Olympics are far more than that. Indeed, the Games seem to celebrate the dream of progress as embodied in the human form. That the Games are intoxicating to watch is beyond question. During the Athens Olympics in 2004, 3.4 billion people, half the world, watched them on television. Certainly, being a spectator is a thrilling experience: but why?

B In 1996, three Italian neuroscientists, Giacomo Rizzolatti, Leonardo Fogassi and Vittorio Gallese, examined the premotor cortex of monkeys. They discovered that inside these primate brains there were complex 'maps' of motor actions, just as there are grammars of movement. These networks of cells are the bodily 'sentences' we use every day, the ones our brain has chosen to retain and refine. Think, for example, about a golf swing. To those who have only watched the Masters' Tournament on TV, golfing seems easy. To the novice, however, the skill of casting a smooth arc with a top-side metal stick is virtually impossible. This is because most novices swing with their consciousness, using an area of brain next to the premotor cortex. To the expert, on the other hand, a perfectly balanced stroke is second nature. For him, the motor action has become memorized, and the movements are embedded in the neurons of his premotor cortex. He hits the ball with the tranquility of his perfected autopilot.

C These neurons in the premotor cortex, besides explaining why certain athletes seem to possess almost unbelievable levels of skill, have an even more amazing characteristic, one that caused Rizzolatti, Fogassi and Gallese to give them the lofty title 'mirror neurons'. They note, 'The main functional characteristic of mirror neurons is that they become active both when the monkey performs a particular action (for example, grasping an object or holding it) and, astonishingly, when it sees another individual performing a similar action.' Humans have an even more elaborate mirror neuron system. These peculiar cells mirror, inside the brain, the outside world: they enable us to internalise the actions of another. In order to be activated, though, these cells require what the scientists call 'goal-orientated movements'. If we are staring at a photograph, a fixed image of a runner mid-stride, our mirror neurons are totally silent. They only fire when the runner is active: running, moving or sprinting.

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D What these electrophysiological studies indicate is that when we watch a runner in action, the mirror neurons in our own premotor cortex light up as if we were the ones competing. This phenomenon of neural mirroring was first discovered in 1954, when two French physiologists, Gastaut and Berf, found that the brains of humans vibrate with two distinct wavelengths, alpha and mu. The mu system is involved in neural mirroring. It is active when our bodies are still, but disappears whenever we do something active, like playing sport or changing the TV channel. The surprising fact is that the mu signal is also quiet when we watch someone else being active, as on TV; these results are the effect of mirror neurons.

E Rizzolatti, Fogassi and Gallese call the idea of mirror neurons the 'direct matching hypothesis'. They believe that we don't understand the movement of sports stars by thinking about it, but rather we map the visual representation of the observed action onto our motor representation of the same action. According to this theory, watching an Olympic athlete 'causes the motor system of the observer to resonate. The 'motor knowledge' of the observer is used to understand the observed action.' But mirror neurons are more than just the neural basis for our attitude to sport. It turns out that watching a great golfer makes us better golfers, and watching a fast runner can actually make us run faster.

F But how many of us regularly watch sports in order to be a better athlete? Rather, we watch sport for the feeling, the human drama. This feeling also derives from mirror neurons. By letting spectators share in the motions of victory, they also allow us to share in its feelings. This is because they are directly connected to the amygdalae, one of the main brain regions involved in emotion. During the Olympics, the mirror neurons of whole nations will be electrically identical, their athletes causing spectators to feel, just for a second or two, the same thing. Watching sports brings people together. Most of us will never run a mile in under four minutes, or hit a home run. Our consolation comes in watching: when we gather around the TV, we all feel, just for a moment, what it is to do something perfectly.

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Questions 27–32

Reading Passage 3 has six paragraphs, **A–F**. *Which paragraph contains the following information? NB You may use any letter more than once.*

Q	Statement	Answer
27	an explanation of why watching sport may be emotionally satisfying	
28	an explanation of why beginners find sporting tasks difficult	
29	a factor that needs to combine with mirroring to attain sporting excellence	
30	a comparison of human and animal mirror neurons	
31	the first discovery of brain activity related to mirror neurons	
32	a claim linking observation to improvement in performance	

Questions 33–35

Choose the correct letter, **A, B, C** *or* **D**.

33 The writer uses the term 'grammar of movement' to mean

A a level of sporting skill.
B a system of words about movement.
C a pattern of connected cells.
D a type of golf swing.

34 The writer states that expert players perform their actions

A without conscious thought.
B by planning each phase of movement.
C without regular practice.
D by thinking about the actions of others.

35 The writer states that the most common motive for watching sport is to

A improve personal performance.
B feel linked with people of different nationalities.
C experience strong positive emotions.
D realize what skill consists of.

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Questions 36–40

Do the following statements agree with the views of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

YES *if the statement agrees with the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

36 Inexpert sports players are too aware of what they are doing.

37 Monkeys have a more complex mirror neuron system than humans.

38 Looking at a photograph can activate mirror neurons.

39 Gastaut and Berf were both researchers and sports players.

40 The mu system is at rest when we are engaged in an activity.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 5

Volume 3 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Caral: An Ancient South American City

Huge earth and rock mounds rise out of the desert of the Supe Valley near the coast of Peru in South America. These immense mounds appear simply to be part of the geographical landscape in this arid region squeezed between the Pacific Ocean and the Andes mountains. But looks deceive. These are actually human-made pyramids. Strong evidence indicates they are the remains of a city known as Caral that flourished nearly 5,000 years ago. If true, it would be the oldest known urban center in the Americas and among the most ancient in the world.

Research undertaken by Peruvian archaeologist Ruth Shady suggests that the 150-acre complex of pyramids, plazas and residential buildings was a thriving metropolis when Egypt's great pyramids were still being built. Though discovered in 1905, for years Caral attracted little attention, largely because archaeologists believed the structures were fairly recent. But the monumental scale of the pyramids had long interested Shady, who began excavations at the site in 1996, about 22 kilometers from the coast and 190 kilometers north of Peru's capital city of Lima.

Shady and her crew searched for broken remains of the pots and containers that most such sites contain. Not finding any only made her more excited: it meant Caral could be what archaeologists term pre-ceramic, that is, existing before the advent in the area of pot-firing techniques. Shady's team undertook the task of excavating Piramide Mayor, the largest of the pyramids. After carefully clearing away many hundreds of years' worth of rubble and sand, they identified staircases, walls covered with remnants of colored plaster, and brickwork. In the foundations, they found the remains of grass-like reeds woven into bags. The original workers, she surmised, must have filled these bags with stones from a nearby quarry and laid them atop one another inside retaining walls, creating the pyramid's dense mass structure. Shady had samples of the reeds subjected to radiocarbon dating and found that the reeds were 4,600 years old. This evidence indicated that Caral was, in fact, more than 1,000 years older than what had previously been thought to be the oldest urban center in the Americas.

What amazed archaeologists was not just the age, but the complexity and scope of Caral. Piramide Mayor alone covers an area nearly the size of four football fields and is 18 meters tall. A nine-meter-wide staircase rises from a circular plaza at the foot of the pyramid,

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passing over three terraced levels until it reaches the top. Thousands of manual laborers would have been needed to build such a project, not counting the many architects, craftsmen, and managers. Shady's team found the remains of a large amphitheater, containing almost 70 musical instruments made of bird and deer bones. Clearly music played an important role in Caral's society. Around the perimeter of Caral are a series of smaller mounds and various buildings. These indicate a hierarchy of living arrangements: large, well-kept rooms atop pyramids for the elite, ground-level quarters for shabbier outlying dwellings for workers.

But why had Caral been built in the first place? Her excavations convinced Shady that Caral once served as a trade center for the region, which extends from the rainforests of the Amazon to the high forests of the Andes. Shady found evidence of a rich trading environment, including seeds of the cocoa bush and necklaces of shells, neither of which was native to the immediate Caral area. This environment gave rise to people who did not take part in the production of food, allowing them to become priests and planners, artisans and designers. Thus occupational specialization, elemental to an urban society, emerged.

But what sustained such a trading center and drew travelers to it? Was it food? Shady and her team found the bones of small edible fish, which must have come from the Pacific coast to the west, in the excavations. But they also found evidence of squash, sweet potatoes and beans having been grown locally. Shady theorized that Caral's early farmers diverted the area's rivers into canals, which still cross the Supe Valley today, to irrigate their fields. But because she found no traces of maize, which can be traded or stored and used in times of crop failure, she concluded that Caral's trade leverage was not based on stockpiling food supplies.

It was evidence of another crop in the excavations that gave Shady the best clue to Caral's success. In nearly every excavated building, her team discovered evidence of cotton - seeds, fibers and textiles. Her theory fell into place when a large fishing net made of those fibers, unearthed in an unrelated dig on Peru's coast, turned out to be from Caral. 'The farmers of Caral grew the cotton that the fishermen needed to make their nets,' Shady speculates. 'And the fishermen gave them shellfish and dried fish in exchange for these nets.' In essence, the people of Caral enabled fishermen to work with larger and more effective nets, which made the resources of the sea more readily available, and the fishermen probably used dried squash grown by the Caral people as flotation devices for their nets.

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Questions 1–6

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

1 Caral was built at the same time as the construction of the Egyptian pyramids.

2 The absence of pottery at the archaeological dig gave Shady a significant clue to the age of the site.

3 The stones used to build Piramide Mayor came from a location far away.

4 The huge and complicated structures of Piramide Mayor suggest that its construction required an organised team of builders.

5 Archaeological evidence shows that the residents of Caral were highly skilled musicians.

6 The remains of housing areas at Caral suggest that there were no class distinctions in residential areas.

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Questions 7–13

Complete the notes below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Caral as a trading centre

ITEMS DISCOVERED AT CARAL BUT NOT NATURALLY OCCURRING IN THE AREA

- the (7) _____ of a certain plant
- (8) _____ used to make jewellery
- the remains of certain food such as (9) _____

CLUES TO FARMING AROUND CARAL

- (10) _____ still in existence today indicate water diverted from rivers
- no evidence that (11) _____ was grown

EVIDENCE OF RELATIONSHIP WITH FISHING COMMUNITIES

- the excavation findings and fishing nets found on the coast suggest Caral farmers traded (12) _____
- dried squash may have been used to aid (13) _____ of fishing nets

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Reading Passage 2

Should Space Be Explored by Robots or by Humans?

A The advisability of humans participating directly in space travel continues to cause many debates. There is no doubt that the presence of people on board a space vehicle makes its design much more complex and challenging, and produces a large increase in costs, since safety requirements are greatly increased, and the technology providing necessities for human passengers such as oxygen, food and water must be guaranteed. Moreover, the systems required are bulky and costly, and their complexity increases for long-duration missions. Meanwhile, advances in electronics and computer science allow increasingly complex tasks to be entrusted to robots, and unmanned space probes are becoming lighter, smaller and more convenient.

B However, experience has shown that the idea of humans in space is popular with the public. Humans can also be useful; there are many cases when only direct intervention by an astronaut or cosmonaut can correct the malfunction of an automatic device. Astronauts and cosmonauts have proved that they can adapt to conditions of weightlessness and work in space without encountering too many problems, as was seen in the operations to repair and to upgrade the Hubble Space Telescope. One human characteristic which is particularly precious in space missions, and which so far is lacking in robots, is the ability to perform a great variety of tasks. In addition, robots are not good at reacting to situations they have not been specifically prepared for. This is especially important in the case of deep space missions. While, in the case of the Moon, it is possible for someone on Earth to 'tele-operate' a robotic device such as a probe, as the two-way link time is only a couple of seconds, on Mars the two-way link time is several minutes, sending instructions from Earth is more difficult.

C Many of the promises of artificial intelligence are still far from being fulfilled. The construction of machines simulating human logical reasoning moves towards ever more distant dates. The more the performance of computers improves, the more we realise how difficult it is to build machines which display logical abilities. In the past it was confidently predicted that we would soon have fully automated factories in which all operations were performed without any human intervention, and forecasts of the complete substitution of workers by robots in many production areas were made. Today, these perspectives are being revised. It seems that all machines, even the smartest ones, must cooperate with humans. Rather than replacing humans, the present need appears to be for an intelligent machine capable of helping a human operator without replacing him or her. The word 'cobot', from 'collaborative robot', has been invented to designate this type.

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D A similar trend is also apparent in the field of space exploration. Tasks which were in the past entrusted only to machines are now performed by human beings, sometimes with the aim of using simpler and less costly devices, sometimes to obtain better performance. In many cases, to involve a person in the control loop is a welcome simplification which may lower the cost of a mission without compromising safety. Many operations originally designed to be performed under completely automatic control can be performed more efficiently by astronauts, perhaps helped by their 'cobots'. The human-machine relationship must evolve towards a closer collaboration.

E One way this could happen is by adopting the Mars Outposts approach, proposed by the Planetary Society. This would involve sending a number of robotic research stations to Mars, equipped with permanent communications and navigational systems. They would perform research, and establish the infrastructure needed to prepare future landing sites for the exploration of Mars by humans. It has also been suggested that in the most difficult environments, as on Venus or Jupiter, robots could be controlled by human beings located in spaceships which remain in orbit around the planet. In this case the link time for communication between humans and robots would be far less than it would be from Earth.

F But if space is to be more than a place to build automatic laboratories or set up industrial enterprises in the vicinity of our planet, the presence of humans is essential. They must learn how to voyage through space towards destinations which will be not only scientific bases but also places to live. If space is a frontier, then humans must see the presence of people. So the aim for humankind in the future will be not just the exploration of space, but its colonisation. The result of exploring and living in space may be a deep change in the views which humankind has of itself. And this process is already under way. The images of Earth taken from the Moon in the Apollo programme have given humankind a new consciousness of its fragility, its smallness, and its unity. These impressions have triggered a realisation of the need to protect and preserve it, for it is the place in the solar system most suitable for us and above all it is the only place we have, at least for now.

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Questions 14–19

Reading Passage 2 has six paragraphs, **A–F**. *Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.*

LIST OF HEADINGS

i Robots on Earth – a re-evaluation
ii The barriers to cooperation in space exploration
iii Some limitations of robots in space
iv Reduced expectations for space exploration
v A general reconsideration of human/robot responsibilities in space
vi Problems in using humans for space exploration
vii The danger to humans of intelligent machines
viii Space settlement and the development of greater self-awareness
ix Possible examples of cooperation in space

Q	Paragraph	Answer
14	Paragraph A	
15	Paragraph B	
16	Paragraph C	
17	Paragraph D	
18	Paragraph E	
19	Paragraph F	

Questions 20 and 21

Choose **TWO** *letters,* **A–E**. *According to the writer, which TWO predictions about artificial intelligence have not yet been fulfilled?*

20

21

A Robots will work independently of humans.
B Robots will begin to oppose human interests.
C Robots will be used to help humans perform tasks more efficiently.
D Robots will think in the same way as humans.
E Robots will become too costly to use on space missions.

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Questions 22–26

Complete the summary below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Humans in space – the Mars Outposts approach and its implications

One way of exploring space would be through collaboration between humans and robots. For example, when exploring the planet Mars, robots could be used to set up (22) _____ and do initial research before humans arrive. In other cases, humans could stay in orbiting (23) _____ and give orders to robots working on the surface of the planet. This would increase the speed of (24) _____ with the robots.

In such ways, robots might be used to work in space in commercial enterprises or (25) _____. However, the final aim of humankind may be the (26) _____ of space and this could in turn change people's attitudes towards Earth.

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Reading Passage 3

The Dark Side of the Technological Boom

What are the effects on the individual of working in modern technological workplaces?

Changes in the way we work and how our offices are structured come at us faster and faster. Waves of state-of-the-art information technology and instant telecommunications let us reach anyone, anywhere, and speed is the key. Most of us are too busy struggling to keep pace with ongoing innovations to question the implications of our new electronic authority figures. According to a number of psychologists, however, the need to stay on top of the information flow and the degree to which we remain in touch with our offices exact a profound toll on us as individuals.

Mass exposure to technological innovations in the workplace has come too recently for psychologists to reach a consensus on its societal implications. Many agree, however, that one of the first signs of the struggle to adapt to the electronic office is what they call 'technostress', a cognitive shift that results from an over-identification with information systems. Psychologist Craig Brod says people become accustomed to the patterns set by electronic tools - accelerated time and yes/no logic - and internalize these patterns. When they leave the office or go home, Brod says, they need complete isolation to recover from the effects of the technology.

Brod warns that over-reliance on electronic tools could also have serious repercussions on our ability to think creatively and develop new ideas. Because we don't create in a vacuum, he points out, we need to avoid the temptation to replace informal gatherings for bouncing ideas off colleagues with electronic networking. It's also more difficult to spot errors or even evaluate the shape of a project displayed in a flat, two-dimensional way on a screen.

Electronically networked offices can also make it increasingly difficult to convince ourselves that we're doing an adequate job and accumulating enough information to make informed decisions. Philosopher Daniel Dennett points out that modern technology eliminates the possibility of unavoidable ignorance. As the opportunity to amass information grows larger, the obligation to make accurate predictions - the right decisions - becomes more onerous. The trouble is, when convincing ourselves that we're doing as good a job as we can, we are tormented by the knowledge that the world of information is limitless.

For executives near the top of the office pyramid, the benefits of the electronic revolution - like telecommuting and flexible scheduling - may outweigh the disadvantages of being continuously on call. But in Workplace 2000, authors Joseph Boyett and Henry Conn describe a future in which millions of people now charged with analyzing information and

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making routine decisions will be replaced by less skilled workers using 'intelligent' software to make decisions for them. They predict that a cult of performance excellence will engulf most businesses.

The millions of people on the bottom levels of electronic hierarchies are increasingly likely to spend their days in an isolated no-man's land, subservient to intelligent information systems that report their progress to unseen supervisors far away. Because computers measure quantity more easily than quality, such systems tend to reward employees who work faster more than those who work better.

Service people on the telephone or at a cash register curtly terminate attempts at idle conversation because their performance is being electronically monitored. Once judged on their ability to troubleshoot unexpected situations, they're now evaluated by the number of transactions they complete in a shift or the number of keystrokes required to draft a document. In these electronic 'sweatshops', the computers are running the people, not the other way around.

'I think people are going to feel an increased fragmentation of self. They won't be able to hold the pieces together,' human resources consultant Philip Nicholson says. 'How do you keep a coherent space if you're going in and out of spaces that don't exist?' He likens the psychic numbing of electronic information overload to symptoms of post-traumatic stress syndrome (a mental disorder following a horrific event). In office 'wars', people become overwhelmed by the sheer amount of information available, internalize the diversity of the world outside, and fear losing control of their own lives.

If we are to survive the challenges of information-driven, hardwired offices, says Nicholson, we need to provide psychological support systems. Although no one has yet measured the social cost of the workplace revolution, some psychologists are mobilizing efforts to pool information as it is derived. Nicholson started the Technostress International Information Network in Massachusetts to foster an exchange of data and ideas on the effects of computerization and information technology. Meanwhile, Brod wants to examine the parallels between electronic work environments and 'sealed-cabin ecologies' like space capsules or submarines, both totally automated artificial worlds in which people live in highly confined circumstances surrounded by technology that dictates the tenor of their days as well as their survival. He is petitioning the American Psychological Association to convince psychologists to form a specialized study group.

In addition, Brod suggests that we re-examine our value systems and that we make greater allowances for privacy in order to circumvent potential revolts against technology. 'We need to coevolve with technology,' he says. 'These are wonderful tools, but if we exploit them without imposing appropriate values on their use, they become alienating and dangerous.'

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Questions 27–29

Complete each sentence with the correct ending, **A–E**, *below.*

SENTENCE ENDINGS

A requires more detailed study by psychologists.

B means people have no time to challenge the significance of the new technology.

C may reduce inventiveness and innovation.

D suggests computers will take over the workplace.

E results from increased electronic supervision.

27 The speed of technological changes ____

28 A dependency on technology and computers ____

29 A deterioration in personal service ____

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Questions 30–35

Look at the following statements and the list of people below. Match each statement with the correct person, **A–D**. *NB You may use any letter more than once.*

LIST OF PEOPLE

A Craig Brod

B Daniel Dennett

C Joseph Boyett and Henry Conn

D Philip Nicholson

Q	Statement	Answer
30	Technology has placed greater expectations on workers not to make mistakes.	
31	People will need time away from technology to reduce the frustrations caused by it.	
32	Interacting with others at work contributes to creative thinking.	
33	The psychological effect of working with technology is similar to the anxiety felt after surviving a major ordeal.	
34	Technology will ultimately increase unemployment for more highly qualified personnel.	
35	More counselling is required to help people cope with the demands of the modern workplace.	

Questions 36–40

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 3?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

36 Our knowledge of the effects of technology on workers is still limited.

37 An early indicator of technological anxiety is a tendency to adopt machine-like thinking.

38 We have now started to doubt our ability to perform well at work.

39 Top level managers are more negatively affected by changes in the electronic workplace than junior workers.

40 Employees who learn to use new technology quickly will get promoted.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 6

Volume 3 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Developmental Tasks of Normal Adolescence

Some years ago, Professor Robert Havighurst of the University of Chicago, USA, proposed that stages in human development can best be thought of in terms of the developmental tasks that are part of the normal transition. He identified ten developmental tasks associated with the adolescent transition. Each of the Havighurst tasks can also be seen as elements of the overall sense of self that adolescents carry with them as they move towards and into young adulthood. Adolescents do not progress through these multiple developmental tasks separately; at any given time they may be dealing with several.

The adolescent must adjust to a new physical sense of self. At no other time since birth does an individual undergo such profound physical changes as during early adolescence. Puberty is marked by sudden rapid growth in height and weight. Also, the young person experiences the emergence and accentuation of those physical traits that make the person a boy or a girl. The young person looks less like a child and more like a physically mature adult. The effect of this rapid change is that mid-adolescents are body-conscious, and their concerns are directed towards their opposite-sexed peers.

The adolescent must adjust to new intellectual abilities. In addition to a sudden spurt in physical growth, adolescents experience a sudden increase in their ability to think about their world. As a normal part of maturity, they are able to think of more options. Before adolescence, children's thinking is dominated by a concrete example for any problem they need to solve; their thinking is constrained to what is real and physical. During adolescence, young people begin to recognise and understand abstractions. The growth in ability to deal with abstractions accelerates during the middle stages of adolescence.

The adolescent must adjust to increased cognitive demands at school. Adults see high school in part as a place where adolescents prepare for adult roles and responsibilities and in part as preparatory for further education. School curricula are frequently dominated by the inclusion of more abstract, demanding material, regardless of whether the adolescents have achieved formal thought. Since not all adolescents make the intellectual transition at the same rate, demands for abstract thinking prior to the achievement of that ability may be frustrating.

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The adolescent must adopt a personal value system. During adolescence, as teens develop increasingly complex knowledge systems, they also adopt an integrated set of values and morals. During the early stages of moral development, parents provide their child with a structured set of rules of what is right and wrong, what is acceptable and unacceptable. Eventually the adolescent must assess the parents' values as they come into conflict with values expressed by peers and other segments of society. To reconcile differences, the adolescent restructures those beliefs into a personal ideology.

The adolescent must develop expanded verbal skills to accommodate more complex concepts and tasks. Their limited language of childhood is no longer adequate. As their conceptual development may outstrip their verbal development, adolescents may appear less competent than they really are.

The adolescent must establish adult vocational goals. As part of the process of establishing a personal identity, the adolescent must also begin the process of focusing on the question, 'What do you plan to be when you grow up?' Mid-adolescents identify, at least at a preliminary level, what their adult vocational goals are and how they intend to achieve them.

The adolescent must develop a personal sense of identity. Prior to adolescence, one's identity is an extension of one's parents' identity. During the early adolescent years a young person begins to recognise their uniqueness and to establish themselves as separate individuals, independent of their parents. As such, one must reconsider the answer to the question, 'What does it mean to be me?' or 'who am I?'

The adolescent must establish emotional and psychological independence from his or her parents. Childhood is marked by strong dependence on one's parents. Adolescents may yearn to keep that safe, secure, supportive, dependent relationship. Yet, to be an adult implies a sense of independence, of autonomy, of being one's own person. In an attempt to assert their need for independence and individuality, adolescents may respond with what appears to be hostility and lack of cooperation.

The adolescent must develop stable and productive peer relationships. Although peer interaction is not unique to adolescence, it seems to hit a peak of importance during early adolescence. Certainly by late adolescence or early adulthood the need for peer approval has diminished. The degree to which an adolescent is able to make friends and have an accepting peer group, though, is a major indicator of how well the adolescent will adjust in other areas of social and psychological development. Early adolescence is also a period of intense conformity to peers. 'Fitting in', not being different, and being accepted seem somehow pressing to this age group. The worst possibility, from the view of the young teen, is to be seen by peers as different.

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The adolescent must develop increased impulse control and behavioural maturity. In their shift to adulthood, most young people engage in one or more behaviours that place them at physical, social, or educational risk. Risky behaviours are sufficiently pervasive among adolescents to suggest that risk-taking may be a normal developmental process of middle adolescence. Gradually adolescents develop a set of behavioural self-controls through which they assess which behaviours are acceptable and adult-like.

Questions 1–6

Classify the following developments as characterising

A *early adolescence* **B** *middle adolescence* **C** *late adolescence*

NB You may use any letter more than once.

1. becoming interested in people of the other gender
2. beginning to choose a future career
3. needing to feel the same as one's friends
4. beginning to form a self-image separate from the family context
5. having less need for the good opinion of friends
6. exposing oneself to dangers

Questions 7–10

Complete each sentence with the correct ending, **A–E**, *below.*

SENTENCE ENDINGS

A reflects an adolescent's emerging self-perception.
B cannot solve a problem without an example.
C is designed to become more challenging.
D formulates a personal set of moral beliefs and values.
E varies according to the individual.

7. Havighurst proposed a set of tasks which ____
8. A course of study at high school ____
9. The speed of development of thinking ability during adolescence ____
10. Adolescence is a time when the young person ____

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Questions 11–13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

11 Most pre-adolescent children are capable of abstract thought.

12 Adolescents' limited skills with words may give a false impression of their ability.

13 Whether or not an adolescent is accepted by their age-group is an important clue to other aspects of their social adjustment.

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Reading Passage 2

Bees

A Some time in the early Cretaceous period of the Earth's history, hunting wasps of a certain type became bees by adopting a vegetarian diet: they began to rely more and more on the pollen of plants as a source of protein for themselves and their offspring, as an alternative to insects. In so doing, they accidentally transported pollen on their bodies to other plants of the same species, bringing about pollination. The stage was thus set for a succession of ever-closer mutual adaptations of bees and flowering plants. In particular, flowers began to reward bees for their unwitting role in their reproduction by providing richer sources of pollen and another source of nutrition, nectar.

B Today about 15 per cent of our diet consists of crops which are pollinated by bees. The meat and other animal products we consume are ultimately derived from bee-pollinated forage crops, and account for another 15 per cent. It follows that around one third of our food is directly or indirectly dependent on the pollinating services of bees. On a global basis, the annual value of agricultural crops dependent on the pollination services of bees is estimated at £1,000 million (US$1,500 million). Much of this pollination is due to honey bees, and in monetary terms it exceeds the value of the annual honey crop by a factor of fifty.

C But the apparently harmonious relationship between bees and plants conceals a conflict of interests. Although flowers need bees and vice versa, it pays each partner to minimise its costs and maximise its profits. This may sound like an extreme case of attributing human qualities to non-human species, but using the marketplace and the principles of double-entry book keeping as metaphors may give us some insights into what is really going on between bees and flowering plants. In the real world, both flower and bee operate in a competitive marketplace. A community of retailers, the flowers, seek to attract more or less discriminating consumers, the bees. Each flower has to juggle the costs and benefits of investing in advertising, by colour and scent, and providing rewards, nectar and pollen. Clearly a species which depends on cross-pollination is on a knife-edge: it must provide sufficient nectar to attract the interest of a bee, but not enough to satisfy all of its needs in one visit. A satiated bee would return to its nest rather than visit another flower. The bee, on the other hand, is out to get the maximum amount of pollen and nectar. It must assess the quality and quantity of rewards which are on offer and juggle its energy costs so that it makes a calorific profit on each foraging trip. The apparent harmony between plants and bees is therefore not all that it seems. Instead, it is an equilibrium based on compromises between the competing interests of the protagonists.

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D This sounds remarkably like the ideas of the 18th-century economist Adam Smith. In his book, The Wealth of Nations, Smith postulated that in human society the competitive interactions of different 'economic units' eventually resulted in a balanced, or 'harmonious' society. One might predict, therefore, that economists would find the relationships between bees and plants of some interest. This is the case in Israel, where economists are collaborating with botanists and entomologists in a long-term study of the pollination biology of the native flora, in an attempt to understand the dynamics of the relationship between communities of bees and plants.

E This sort of study is of more than passing academic interest. It is important that authorities understand the dynamic relationships between plants and their pollinators. This is especially true when, say, devising conservation policies. A good example comes from the forests of tropical South America. Here, as in all rainforests, there is a high diversity of tree species. There may be more than 120 per acre, but in a given acre there may only be one or two individuals of any one species: these trees are pollinated by large, fast-flying bees. There is evidence that certain types of bee learn the distribution of these scattered trees and forage regularly along the same routes. This is called 'trap-lining', and the bees forage for up to 23km from their nests. The bees are therefore acting as long distance pollinators.

F An issue of current concern in tropical forest conservation is that of trying to estimate the minimum sustainable size of islands of forest reserve in areas where large-scale felling is taking place. There is much discussion on seed dispersal distances. But this is only one half of the equation, so far as the reproduction of trees is concerned. There is another question that must be addressed in order to calculate whether proposed forest reserves are close enough to the nearest large tract of forest: 'What is the flight range of these long-distance foragers?' We need to know much more about these and their relationships with plants before this question can be answered.

G Bees, then, are vital to our survival. Furthermore, much of the visual impact of human environments derives from vegetation, and most vegetation is dependent on bees for pollination. Thus, as pollinators of crops and natural vegetation, bees occupy key positions in the web of relationships which sustain the living architecture of our planet.

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Questions 14–18

Reading Passage 2 has seven paragraphs, **A–G**. *Choose the correct heading for paragraphs* **A, B, D, E** *and* **F** *from the list of headings below.*

LIST OF HEADINGS

i Parallels between bee and human activities
ii An evolutionary turning point
iii A lack of total co-operation
iv The preservation of individual plant species
v The commercial value of bees
vi The structure of flowering plants
vii The pursuit of self-interest *(used in example)*
viii The need for further research

Q	Paragraph	Answer
Ex.	Paragraph C	vii
14	Paragraph A	
15	Paragraph B	
16	Paragraph D	
17	Paragraph E	
18	Paragraph F	

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Questions 19–25

Complete the sentences below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** *from the passage for each answer.*

Hunting wasps used to feed on other (19) _____, rather than on vegetation.

Flowering plants started to reward bees with rich pollen and an additional food in the form of (20) _____.

Approximately (21) _____ of human food production relies on the activity of bees.

If the process of (22) _____ is to take place effectively, bees need to travel from one flower to another before going back to the nest.

Bees need to balance the (23) _____ of each trip against the calorific rewards they obtain.

There can be over 120 different (24) _____ in an acre of rainforest.

The bees that pollinate large forests regularly practise an activity known as (25) _____.

Question 26

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** *or* **D**. *Which is the best title for Reading Passage 2?*

(26)

- **A** The Ecological Importance of Bees
- **B** The Evolutionary History of Bees
- **C** The Social Behaviour of Bees
- **D** The Geographical Distribution of Bees

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Reading Passage 3

A New Stage in the Study and Teaching of History

For hundreds of years, historians have relied on written or printed documents to provide the bulk of their source materials, and they have largely communicated with students and the wider public by writing books and journal articles. Today, however, the printed word is being superseded by a diversity of forms of communication, above all moving images on video or film.

A The development of this new form of communication is leading to a growing gap between the practice of professional historians based in academia, and the practice of those aiming to popularise the study of history among the general public, and to encourage people to create their own records for the future. On the one hand, there are mainstream academics who continue to use only the written word as they examine more and more fields with an ever-increasing number of sophisticated methodologies. On the other hand, film and video, especially as broadcast on television, are probably the major influence on the public's consciousness of history, as they see film of events of fifty or a hundred years old, events they had previously only read about.

B In a related development, a great many people now document local and family events in the form of videos; many schools, too, produce video yearbooks. All these visual records may well prove to be invaluable sources of information for future historians. The glaring contradiction is that the two approaches — the academic and what we might term the popular — have intersected very little: with a few notable exceptions, professional historians have tended to avoid involvement in television programmes about history, and have even less impact on what is being captured and preserved on video. And the potential of moving images has wielded negligible influence on the academic study of history.

C This gulf can be seen as resulting from the willingness or otherwise of individual historians to accept the validity of new forms of communication in the study of history. This is not the first time that the question has arisen. The study of history, as conceived of today, began with the transition from oral to literate culture, leading to the earliest written records and the earliest historical studies. The next great shift came with the advent of printing, which transformed everything. Today, as the printed word loses the supremacy it once had, historians are faced with a variety of forms of communication, ranging from simple audiotape to the promising complexities of videodiscs linked with computers. As yet, however, the use of moving images to record current events for the benefit of future historians does not even have a commonly agreed name.

D This does not mean that mainstream historians have totally rejected the use of moving images as sources: the majority seem intrigued by the idea, and valuable research has been carried out into the history and analysis of films with a broad circulation, using them as a

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source of information on the social and intellectual history of the twentieth century. Journals such as American History Review have played a significant role in this field.

E Yet the number of historians using moving images in their research or teaching is very small. The barrier seems to be that the profession is structured around the medium of the written word, and is somewhat insulated in its academic setting. The use of moving images presents a substantial challenge to this setting and its assumptions. As a result, historians have rejected the training, the institutions, the motivations and the professional structures that would be needed in order to use moving images effectively. Above all, they have rejected the necessity to learn complicated new skills.

F So why should historians make this change? Clearly, films or videos of events and people can be used as solid evidence of the past, lessening the need for the words of the narrator (whether a television presenter/historian or a university teacher giving a lecture) but carrying information in their own right. Film has reintroduced the oral form as a mode of research and communication for documenting historical events. Now, with moving images, people are reminded that oral communication is not limited to words: it also includes body language, expression and tone, and is embedded in a context. Little of this is evident in a written transcript. A further effect of video and film is that the narrator gives up some control and has less need to give explanations, while the viewer becomes involved in the process of interpreting and understanding history.

G Film or videotape can also aid historians by simplifying the work of the interviewer. Instead of trying to carry on an interview while simultaneously making notes about setting and other unspoken data, this new kind of historian can concentrate on the interview itself, and study the film later. The many benefits of using moving images as historical evidence easily outweigh worries about cost, technical skills, or the effect of a camera on a person telling his or her story. Moving images enhance the quality of historical research, and suggest new directions for historians to explore.

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Questions 27–35

Reading Passage 3 has seven paragraphs, **A–G**. *Which paragraph contains the following information? NB You may use any letter more than once.*

Q	Information	Paragraph
27	an overview of the range of methods that have been used over time to document history	
28	the main reason why many historians are unwilling to use films in their work	
29	a reference to some differences between oral and written communication	
30	how most citizens today gain an understanding of history	
31	how current student events are sometimes captured for future audiences	
32	mention of the fact that the advantages of film are greater than the disadvantages	
33	the claim that there is no official title for film-based historical work	
34	reference to the active role the audience plays when watching films	
35	a list of requirements that historians see as obstacles to their use of film to record history	

Questions 36–40

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

YES *if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

36 The needs of students in school have led to improvements in the teaching of history.

37 Academic and popular historians have different attitudes towards the value of innovations in communication.

38 It is common for historians to play a major role in creating historical documentaries for television.

39 Articles in American History Review have explored aspects of modern history through popular films.

40 Developments in technology are influencing a range of academic subjects.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 7

Volume 3 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Answers Underground

Burying greenhouse gases to slow global warming

A One way to slow global warming is to take the greenhouse gases that cause it and bury them. That is the idea behind projects now under way to capture emissions from power plants and factories and force them underground or deep into the ocean. There, proponents argue, they could be trapped for thousands of years.

B This concept, known as carbon sequestration, is already being used by oil companies to improve the efficiency of oil wells, and now engineers have begun exploring ways to capture carbon dioxide emissions from power plants to reduce their impact on the environment. At a recent conference, delegates from fourteen industrialised and developing countries agreed to engage in cooperative research into capturing and storing carbon dioxide.

C The goal is to stabilise emissions of greenhouse gases that trap heat in the atmosphere. Over the past century, airborne carbon dioxide concentrations have risen by nearly a third, according to Scott Klara, sequestration manager at the US National Energy Technology Laboratory. Unless emissions are slashed by two thirds worldwide, the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change predicts that concentrations will rise to double the level of the early 1700s, before the Industrial Revolution. These increased levels of carbon-based compounds in the atmosphere are believed to be the cause of rising temperatures and sea levels around the world. Ignoring the problem is therefore not an option.

D Limiting emissions, however, is not an easy undertaking since increased energy consumption is a key to economic growth. Two thirds of the world's power-generating capacity, expected to come into use by 2030, has not been constructed yet, according to the International Energy Agency. The developing world will be particularly important. China and India alone are expected to account for two thirds of the global increase in coal usage over the next fifteen years.

E Solutions are being sought. Work is being undertaken with alternatives to fossil fuels such as wind and solar energy, but it will be a long time before these alternative sources play a major role in fulfilling the world's energy needs. Geophysicist Klaus Lackner points

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out that around 85% of the world's energy is derived from fossil fuels, the cheapest and most plentiful energy source available, and the developing world in particular is unlikely to give them up. That is why many scientists support sequestration.

F However, several problems must be resolved before sequestration plays a key role in a low-carbon future. One is the cost of capturing carbon dioxide. A second is storing the gas safely once it has been captured. Today, it costs about $US50 to extract and store a tonne of carbon dioxide from a power plant, which raises the cost of producing electricity by 30-80%. Lackner argues that it is too expensive to adapt existing plants to capture carbon dioxide. Instead, he recommends that carbon-capturing capacity be built into future plants. Economic incentives are needed to encourage companies to identify low-cost carbon-sequestration solutions. A government-supported program in the US has enabled some factories to capture carbon emissions, which they then sell for various uses, including carbonating soft drinks. However, there are no power plants ready for full carbon capture.

G Once the carbon has been captured it must be stored. Natural carbon sinks, such as forests and wetlands, can remove some carbon dioxide from the atmosphere, but not nearly enough. Carbon dioxide could be pumped to the bottom of the ocean, where the pressure would keep it pinned to the seabed in liquid form for decades, but that has serious long-term environmental risks. David Hawkins, from the Natural Resources Defense Council in Washington, warns that the carbon dioxide could radically alter the chemical balance in the ocean, with potentially harmful consequences for marine life. Others worry that the carbon dioxide could escape back into the atmosphere.

H A few promising attempts at underground carbon sequestration are currently under way. In western Canada, an oil company is pumping liquefied carbon dioxide into oil wells to force more oil to the surface and boost recovery by 10-15%. The company gets the carbon dioxide via a pipeline from North Dakota in the US, where the gas is captured from a synthetic-fuel plant. In another instance in the North Sea, a Norwegian energy firm is injecting carbon dioxide waste from its natural-gas operations into a saline aquifer 1,000 metres beneath the ocean floor.

I Clearly, storing large amounts of gas underground raises environmental fears. Environmentalists argue that more research is needed on potential storage sites, such as oil and gas reservoirs and coal seams unsuitable for mining, to ensure that they offer long-term solutions. The World Wide Fund for Nature Australia has argued that the primary risk of underground storage is that dangerously large volumes of carbon dioxide might escape and people become asphyxiated.

J Little progress in slashing global greenhouse gases can be achieved without involving developing countries, but for now carbon sequestration is not their priority because of the increased costs this would add to energy production. Hawkins argues that, to encourage

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developing nations to use sequestration, developed nations will have to provide assistance. He suggests a multilateral carbon-trading framework for nations, perhaps by purchasing carbon credits from poorer countries, to finance the difference between the cost of a regular coal-fired power plant and one that captures carbon emissions. That is, the rich - who will remain the world's biggest polluters for years to come - would buy the right to emit carbon from the poor, who would use the proceeds to build better plants.

Questions 1–6

Look at the following issues and the list of people and organisations below. Match each issue with the correct person or organisation, **A–F**. *NB You may use any letter more than once.*

LIST OF PEOPLE AND ORGANISATIONS

A Scott Klara
B Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change
C International Energy Agency
D Klaus Lackner
E David Hawkins
F World Wide Fund for Nature Australia

Q	Issue	Answer
1	The cost implications of fitting plants with the necessary equipment.	
2	The effects sequestration could have on sea creatures.	
3	The reasons why products such as oil and gas continue to be popular energy sources.	
4	The need for industrialised countries to give aid to less wealthy countries.	
5	The significant increase in carbon dioxide concentrations in the air over the last 100 years.	
6	The potential for sequestration to harm human life.	

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Questions 7–9

Reading Passage 1 has ten paragraphs, **A–J**. *Which paragraph contains the following information? NB You may use any letter more than once.*

Q	Information	Paragraph
7	Examples of sequestration already in use in several parts of the world	
8	An example of putting carbon dioxide emissions to use in the food and beverage industry	
9	Current examples of the environmental harm attributed to carbon dioxide in the air	

Questions 10–13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

10 Both developing and developed nations have decided to investigate carbon dioxide sequestration.

11 A growing economy will use more power.

12 Capturing carbon dioxide has become financially attractive.

13 More forests need to be planted to improve the atmosphere.

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Reading Passage 2

Science and the Stradivarius

Uncovering the secret of quality

A Violins made by long-dead Italian craftsmen from the Cremona region are beautiful works of art, coveted by collectors as well as players. Particularly outstanding violins have reputedly changed hands for over a million pounds. In contrast, fine modern instruments can be bought for under £100. Do such figures really reflect such large differences in quality? After more than a hundred years of vigorous debate, this question remains highly contentious, provoking strongly held but divergent views among musicians, violin makers and scientists alike.

B Every violin, whether a Stradivarius or the cheapest factory-made copy, has a distinctive 'voice' of its own. Just as any musician can immediately recognise the difference between Domingo and Pavarotti singing the same operatic aria, so a skilled violinist can distinguish between different qualities in the sound produced by individual Stradivari or Guarneri violins. Individual notes on a single instrument sound different each time they are played, which suggests that the perceived tone of a violin must be related to the overall design of the instrument, rather than the frequencies of particular resonances on it. But although various attempts have been made to analyse such global properties, it is extremely difficult to distinguish between a fine Stradivarius instrument and an indifferent modern copy on the basis of the measured response alone. The ear is a supreme detection device, and a system has yet to be developed which can match the brain's sophisticated ability to assess complex sounds.

C So how do skilled violinmakers optimise the tone of an instrument during the construction process? They begin by selecting a wood of the highest possible quality for the front and back plates (parts of the violin), which they test by tapping with a hammer and judging how well it 'rings'. The next important step is to skilfully carve the plates out of the solid wood, taking great care to get the right degree of arching and variations in thickness. Traditional makers optimise the thickness by testing the 'feel' of the plates when they are flexed, and by the sounds produced when they are tapped at different positions with the knuckles.

D However, in the last 50 years or so a group of violin makers has emerged who have tried to take a more overtly scientific approach to violin making. One common practice they have adopted is to replace the traditional flexing and tapping of plates by controlled measurements. During the carving process, the thinned plates are sprinkled with flakes of

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glitter and suspended horizontally above a loudspeaker. The glitter forms a pattern each time the loudspeaker excites a resonance. The aim is to interactively 'tune' the front and back plates to specified resonance patterns.

E Unfortunately, there are very few examples of such measurements for really fine Italian instruments because their owners are naturally reluctant to allow their violins to be taken apart for the sake of science. The few tests that have been performed suggest that the first Italian makers may have tuned the resonant modes of the individual plates - which they could identify as they tapped them - to exact musical intervals. This would be consistent with the prevailing Renaissance view of 'perfection', which was measured in terms of numbers and exact ratios. However, there is no historical data to support this case.

F Another factor that affects sound quality is the presence of moisture. To achieve the quality of 'vibrancy' in a violin requires high-quality wood with low internal damping. By measuring the pattern of growth-rings in the wood of a Stradivarius, we know that the Italian violin makers sometimes used planks of wood that had only been seasoned for five years. However, such wood is now 300 years old, and the intrinsic internal damping will almost certainly have decreased with time. The age of the wood may therefore automatically contribute to the improved quality of older instruments. This may also explain why the quality of a modern instrument appears to improve in its first few years.

G Another factor thought to account for sound quality is the nature of the varnish used to protect the instrument. One of the most popular theories for well over a century to account for the Stradivarius secret has been that the varnish had some sort of 'magic' composition. However, historical research has shown that it was very similar to the varnish used today. So apart from the possibility that the Italian varnish was contaminated with the wings of passing insects and debris from the workshop floor, there is no convincing evidence to support the idea of a secret formula.

H Other researchers, meanwhile, have claimed that Stradivarius's secret was to soak the timber in water, to leach out supposedly harmful chemicals, before it was seasoned. Although this would be consistent with the idea that the masts and oars of recently sunken Venetian war galleys might have been used to make violins, other scientific and historical evidence to support this view is unconvincing.

I In conclusion, science has not provided any convincing evidence to set Cremonese instruments apart from the finest violins made by skilled craftsmen today. Indeed, some leading soloists do occasionally play on modern instruments. However, the foremost soloists - and, not surprisingly, violin dealers, who have a vested interest in maintaining the Cremonese legend of intrinsic superiority - remain utterly unconvinced.

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Questions 14–21

Reading Passage 2 has nine paragraphs, **A–I**. *Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.*

LIST OF HEADINGS

i An analysis of protective coatings
ii Applying technology to violin production
iii Location – a key factor
iv A controversial range of prices
v Techniques of mass production
vi The advantages of older wood
vii A re-evaluation of documentary evidence *(used in example)*
viii The mathematical basis of earlier design
ix Manual woodworking techniques
x Preferences of top musicians
xi The use of saturated wood
xii The challenge for scientists

Q	Paragraph	Answer
Ex.	Paragraph B	vii
14	Paragraph A	
15	Paragraph C	
16	Paragraph D	
17	Paragraph E	
18	Paragraph F	
19	Paragraph G	
20	Paragraph H	
21	Paragraph I	

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Questions 22–26

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 2?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

22 The quality of any particular note played on the same violin varies.

23 Scientific instruments analyse complex sound more accurately than humans.

24 The quality of handmade violins varies according to the musical ability of the craftsman.

25 Modern violins seem to improve in their early years.

26 Modern violins are gaining in popularity amongst the top violinists.

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Reading Passage 3

When People Are Deaf to Music

Music has long been considered a uniquely human concept. In fact, most psychologists agree that music is a universal human instinct. Like any ability, however, there is great variation in people's musical competence. For every brilliant pianist in the world, there are several people we refer to as 'tone deaf'. It is not simply that people with tone deafness ('amusia') are unable to sing in tune; they are also unable to discriminate between tones or recognize familiar melodies. Such a 'disorder' can occur after some sort of brain damage, but recently research has been undertaken in an attempt to discover the cause of congenital amusia (when people are born with the condition), which is not associated with any brain damage, hearing problems, or lack of exposure to music.

According to the research of Dr. Isabelle Peretz of the University of Montreal, amusia is more complicated than the inability to distinguish pitches. An amusic (a person who has the condition of amusia) can distinguish between two pitches that are far apart, but cannot tell the difference between intervals smaller than a half step on the Western diatonic scale, while most people can easily distinguish differences smaller than that. When listening to melodies which have had a single note altered so that it is out of key with the rest of the melody, amusics do not notice a problem. As would be expected, amusics perform significantly worse at singing and tapping a rhythm along with a melody than do non-amusics.

The most fascinating aspect of amusia is how specific to music it is. Because of music's close ties to language, it might be expected that a musical impairment may be caused by a language impairment. Studies suggest, however, that language and music ability are independent of one another. People with brain damage in areas critical to language are often still able to sing, despite being unable to communicate through speech. Moreover, while amusics show deficiencies in their recognition of pitch differences in melodies, they show no such difficulty in their understanding of speech. Amusics who speak tonal languages, such as Chinese, do not report having any difficulty discriminating between words that differ only in their intonation. The linguistic cues inherent in speech make discrimination of meaning much easier for amusics. Amusics are also successful most of the time at detecting the mood of a melody, can identify a speaker based on his or her voice, and can discriminate and identify environmental sounds.

Recent work has been focused on locating the part of the brain that is responsible for amusia. The temporal lobes of the brain, the location of the primary auditory cortex, have been considered. It has long been believed that the temporal lobes, especially the right temporal lobe, are most active when music is being processed, so any musical disability

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should logically stem from here as well. Because it has been shown that there is no hearing deficit in amusia, researchers moved on to the temporal neocortex, which is where more sophisticated processing of musical cues was thought to take place. New studies, however, have suggested that the deficits in amusics are located outside the auditory cortex. Brain scans of amusics do not show any reaction at all to differences smaller than a half step. When changes in tones are large, their brains overreact, showing twice as much activity on the right side of the brain as a normal brain hearing the same thing. These differences do not occur in the auditory cortex, indicating again that the deficits of amusia lie not mostly in hearing impairment, but in higher processing of melodies.

So what does this all mean? Looking only at the research of Peretz in the field of neuropsychology of music, it would appear that amusia is some sort of disorder. As a student of neurobiology, however, I am skeptical. Certainly the studies by Peretz that have found significant differences between the brains of so-called amusics and normal brains are legitimate. The more important question now becomes one of normality. Every trait from skin colour to intelligence to mood exists on a continuum - there is a great deal of variation from one extreme to the other. Just because we recognize that basic musical ability is something that the vast majority of people have, this doesn't mean that the lack of it is abnormal.

What makes an amusic worse off than a musical prodigy? Musical ability is culturally valued, and may have been a factor in survival at one point in human history, but it does not seem likely that it is being selected for on an evolutionary scale any longer. Darwin believed that music was adaptive as a way of finding a mate, but who needs to be able to sing to find a partner in an age when it is possible to express your emotions through a song on your iPod?

While the idea of amusia is interesting, it seems to be just one end of the continuum of innate musical ability. Comparing this 'disorder' to learning disorders like a specific language impairment seems to be going too far. Before amusia can be declared a disability, further research must be done to determine whether lack of musical ability is actually detrimental in any way. If no disadvantages can be found of having amusia, then it is no more a disability than having poor fashion sense or bad handwriting.

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Questions 27–31

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** *or* **D**.

27 What does the writer tell us about people with tone deafness (amusia) in the first paragraph?

A They usually have hearing problems.
B Some can play a musical instrument very well.
C Some may be able to sing well-known melodies.
D They have several inabilities in regard to music.

28 What is the writer doing in the second paragraph?

A outlining some of the factors that cause amusia
B summarising some findings about people with amusia
C suggesting that people with amusia are disadvantaged
D comparing the singing ability of amusics with their sense of rhythm

29 What does the writer say about the relationship between language ability and musical ability?

A People who are unable to speak can sometimes sing.
B People with amusia usually have language problems too.
C Speakers of tonal languages like Chinese rarely have amusia.
D People with amusia have difficulty recognizing people by their voices.

30 In the third paragraph, the writer notes that most amusics are able to

A learn how to sing in tune.
B identify a song by its tune.
C distinguish a sad tone from a happy tune.
D recognise when a singer is not singing in tune.

31 What is the writer doing in the fourth paragraph?

A claiming that amusics have problems in the auditory cortex
B outlining progress in understanding the brains of amusics
C proving that amusia is located in the temporal lobes
D explaining why studies of hearing are difficult

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Questions 32–35

Do the following statements agree with the views of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

YES *if the statement agrees with the views of the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the views of the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

32 Peretz's research suggesting that amusia is a disorder is convincing.

33 People with musical ability are happier than those without this ability.

34 It is inappropriate to consider amusia as a real disorder.

35 People with amusia often have bad handwriting.

Questions 36–40

Complete each sentence with the correct ending, **A–H**, *below.*

SENTENCE ENDINGS

A an inability to hear when spoken language rises and falls.
B considered to be desirable.
C an inability to follow the beat of music.
D not a problem.
E not yet well understood.
F a result of injury to the mother.
G more marked than with other people.
H associated with intelligence.

36 The reason why some people are born with amusia is ____

37 One of the difficulties amusics experience is ____

38 For amusics, discrimination of meaning in speech is ____

39 Certain reactions in the brain of an amusic are ____

40 In most cultures, musical ability is ____

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 8

Volume 3 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Katherine Mansfield

Katherine Mansfield was a modernist writer of short fiction who was born and brought up in New Zealand.

Katherine Mansfield Beauchamp Murry was born in 1888, into a prominent family in Wellington, New Zealand. She became one of New Zealand's best-known writers, using the pen name of Katherine Mansfield. The daughter of a banker, and born into a middle-class family, she was also a first cousin of Countess Elizabeth von Arnim, a distinguished novelist in her time. Mansfield had two older sisters and a younger brother. Her father, Harold Beauchamp, went on to become the chairman of the Bank of New Zealand. In 1893, the Mansfield family moved to Karori, a suburb of Wellington, where Mansfield would spend the happiest years of her childhood; she later used her memories of this time as an inspiration for her *Prelude* story.

Her first published stories appeared in the *High School Reporter* and the Wellington Girls' High School magazine in 1898 and 1899. In 1902, she developed strong feelings for a musician who played the cello, Arnold Trowell, although her feelings were not, for the most part, returned. Mansfield herself was an accomplished cellist, having received lessons from Trowell's father. Mansfield wrote in her journals of feeling isolated to some extent in New Zealand, and, in general terms, of her interest in the Maori people (New Zealand's native people), who were often portrayed in a sympathetic light in her later stories, such as *How Pearl Button was Kidnapped*.

She moved to London in 1903, where she attended Queen's college, along with her two sisters. Mansfield recommenced playing the cello, an occupation that she believed, during her time at Queen's, she would take up professionally. She also began contributing to the college newspaper, with such a dedication to it that she eventually became its editor. She was particularly interested in the works of the French writers of this period and of the 19th-century British writer Oscar Wilde, and she was appreciated amongst fellow students at Queen's for her lively and charismatic approach to life and work. She met fellow writer Ida Baker, a South African, at the college, and the pair became lifelong friends. Mansfield did not actively support the suffragette movement in the UK. Women in New Zealand had gained the right to vote in 1893.

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Mansfield first began journeying into the other parts of Europe in the period 1903-1906, mainly to Belgium and Germany. After finishing her schooling in England, she returned to her New Zealand home in 1906, only then beginning to write short stories in a serious way. She had several works published in Australia in a magazine called *Native Comparison*, which was her first paid writing work, and by this time she had her mind set on becoming a professional writer. It was also the first occasion on which she used the pseudonym 'K. Mansfield'.

Mansfield rapidly grew discontented with the provincial New Zealand lifestyle, and with her family. Two years later she headed again to London. Her father sent her an annual subsidy of £100 for the rest of her life. In later years, she would express both admiration and disdain for New Zealand in her journals.

In 1911, Mansfield met John Middleton Murry, the Oxford scholar and editor of the literary magazine *Rhythm*. They were later to marry in 1918. Mansfield became a co-editor of *Rhythm*, which was succeeded by *The Blue Review*, in which more of her works were published. She and Murry lived in various houses in England and briefly in Paris. *The Blue Review* failed to gain enough readers and was no longer published. Their attempt to set up as writers in Paris was cut short by Murry's bankruptcy, which resulted from the failure of this and other journals. Life back in England meant frequently changed addresses and very limited funds.

Between 1915 and 1918, Mansfield moved between England and Bandol, France. She and Murry developed close contact with other well-known writers of the time such as DH Lawrence, Bertrand Russell and Aldous Huxley. By October 1918 Mansfield had become seriously ill; she had been diagnosed with tuberculosis and was advised to enter a sanatorium. She could no longer spend winters in London. It was the publication of *Bliss and Other Stories* in 1920 that was to solidify Mansfield's reputation as a writer.

Mansfield also spent time in Menton, France, as the tenant of her father's cousin at 'The Villa Isola Bella'. There she wrote what she pronounced to be '...the only story that satisfies me to any extent'.

Mansfield produced a great deal of work in the final years of her life, and much of her prose and poetry remained unpublished at her death in 1923. After her death, her husband, Murry, took on the task of editing and publishing her works. His efforts resulted in two additional volumes of short stories, *The Doves' Nest* and *Something Childish*, published in 1923 and 1924 respectively, the publication of her *Poems*, as well as a collection of critical writings (*Novels and Novelists*) and a number of editions of Mansfield's previously unpublished letters and journals.

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Questions 1–6

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

1 The name Katherine Mansfield, that appears on the writer's books, was exactly the same as her original name.

2 Mansfield won a prize for a story she wrote for the *High School Reporter*.

3 *How Pearl Button was Kidnapped* portrayed Maori people in a favourable way.

4 When Mansfield was at Queen's college, she planned to be a professional writer.

5 Mansfield was unpopular with the other students at Queen's college.

6 In London, Mansfield showed little interest in politics.

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Questions 7–13

Complete the notes below. Choose **ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER** *from the passage for each answer.*

Katherine Mansfield's adult years

7. _____

- moved from England back to New Zealand
- first paid writing work was in a publication based in **8** _____
- her **9** _____ and the New Zealand way of life made her feel dissatisfied

1908

- returned to London

1911 – 1919

- Met John Middleton Murry in 1911
- **10** _____ prevented Mansfield and Murry from staying together in Paris
- spent time with distinguished **11** _____
- from 1916, tuberculosis restricted the time she spent in London

1920

- her **12** _____ was consolidated when *Bliss and Other Stories* was published
- wrote several stories at 'Villa Isola Bella'

1923 – 1924

- Mansfield's **13** _____ published more of her works after her death

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Reading Passage 2

Australian Parrots

and their adaptation to habitat change

A Parrots are found across the tropics and in all southern hemisphere continents except Antarctica, but nowhere do they display such a richness of diversity and form as in Australia. One-sixth of the world's 345 parrot species are found there, and Australia has long been renowned for the number and variety of its parrots.

B In the 16th century, the German cartographer Mercator made a world map that included a place, somewhere near present-day Australia, that he named Terra Psittacorum - the Land of Parrots - and the first European settlers in Australia often referred to the country as Parrot Land. In 1865, the celebrated British naturalist and wildlife artist John Gould said: 'No group of birds gives Australia so tropical and benign an air as the numerous species of this great family by which it is tenanted.'

C Parrots are descendants of an ancient line. Due to their great diversity, and since most species inhabit Africa, Australia and South America, it seems almost certain that parrots originated millions of years ago on the ancient southern continent of Gondwana, before it broke up into the separate southern hemisphere continents we know today. Much of Gondwana comprised vast rainforests intersected by huge slow-flowing rivers and expansive lakes, but by eight million years ago, great changes were underway. The centre of the continent of Australia had begun to dry out, and the rainforests that once covered it gradually contracted to the continental margins, where, to a limited extent, they still exist today.

D The creatures that remained in those shrinking rainforests had to adapt to the drier conditions or face extinction. Reacting to these desperate circumstances, the parrot family, typically found in jungles in other parts of the world, has populated some of Australia's harshest environments. The parrots spread from ancestral forests through eucalypt woodlands to colonies in the central deserts of Australia, and as a consequence they diversified into a wide range of species with adaptations that reflect the many changes animals and plants had to make to survive in these areas.

E These evolutionary pressures helped mould keratin, the substance from which beaks are made, into a range of tools capable of gathering the new food types favoured by various species of parrot. The size of a parrot's beak and the length of that beak's curved upper section are related to the type of food each species eats. Some have comparatively long beaks that are perfect for extracting seeds from fruit; others have broader and stronger beaks that are designed for cracking hard seeds.

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F Differently shaped beaks are not the only adaptations that have been made during the developing relationship between parrots and their food plants. Like all of Australia's many honey-eating birds, the rainbow-coloured lorikeets and the flowers on which they feed have long co-evolved, with features such as the shape and colour of the flowers adapted to the bird's particular needs. For example, red is the most attractive colour to birds, and thus flowers which depend on birds for pollination are more often red, and lorikeets' tongues have bristles which help them to collect as much pollen as possible.

G Today, most of Australia's parrots inhabit woodland and open forest, and their numbers decline towards both deserts and wetter areas. The majority are nomadic to some degree, moving around to take advantage of feeding and breeding places. Two of the dry country parrots, the pink and grey galah and the pink, white and yellow corella, have expanded their ranges in recent years. They are among the species that have adapted well to the changes brought about by European settlement, forest felling having created grasslands where galahs and corellas thrive.

H But other parrot species did not fare so well when their environments were altered. The clearing of large areas of rainforest is probably responsible for the disappearance of the double-eyed fig parrot, and numbers of ground parrots declined when a great part of their habitat was destroyed by the draining of coastal swamps. Even some parrot species that benefited from forest clearing at first are now confronted by a shortage of nesting sites due to further man-made changes.

I New conditions also sometimes favour an incoming species over one that originally inhabited the area. For example, after farmers cleared large areas of forest on Kangaroo Island off the coast of South Australia, the island was colonised by galahs. They were soon going down holes and destroying black cockatoo eggs in order to take the hole for their own use. Their success precipitated a partial collapse in the black cockatoo population when the latter lost the struggle for scarce nesting hollows.

J There may be no final answer to ensuring an equitable balance between parrot species. Nest box programmes help ease the shortage of nesting sites in some places, but there are not enough, they are expensive and they are not an adequate substitute for large, old trees, such as those which they represent and the nectar, pollen and seeds they provide. Competition between parrots for nest sites is a result of the changes we humans have made to the Earth. We are the most widespread and dangerous competitors that parrots have ever had to face, but we also have the knowledge and skill to maintain the wonderfully rich diversity of Australia's parrots. All we need is the will to do so.

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Questions 14–19

Reading Passage 2 has ten paragraphs, **A–J**. *Which paragraph contains the following information? NB You may use any letter more than once.*

Q	Information	Paragraph
14	An example of how one parrot species may survive at the expense of another	
15	A description of how plants may adapt to attract birds	
16	Example of two parrot species which benefited from changes to the environment	
17	How the varied Australian landscape resulted in a great variety of parrot species	
18	A reason why most parrot species are native to the southern hemisphere	
19	An example of a parrot species which did not survive changes to its habitat	

Questions 20–22

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** *or* **D**.

20 The writer believes that most parrot species

A moved from Africa and South America to Australia.
B had ancestors in either Africa, Australia or South America.
C had ancestors in a continent which later split up.
D came from a continent now covered by water.

21 What does the writer say about parrots' beaks?

A They are longer than those of other birds.
B They are made of a unique material.
C They are used more efficiently than those of other birds.
D They are specially adapted to suit the diet.

22 Which of the following is **NOT** mentioned by the writer as a disadvantage of nesting boxes?

A They cost too much.
B They need to be maintained.
C They provide only shelter, not food.
D There are too few of them.

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Questions 23–26

Complete the summary below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** *from the passage for each answer.*

Parrots in Australia

There are 345 varieties of parrot in existence and, of these, (23) _____ live in Australia. As early as the (24) _____, the mapmaker (25) _____ recognized that parrots lived in that part of the world. (26) _____, the famous painter of animals and birds, commented on the size and beauty of the Australian parrot family.

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Reading Passage 3

Yawning

How and why we yawn still presents problems for researchers in an area which has only recently been opened up to study.

When Robert R Provine began studying yawning in the 1960s, it was difficult for him to convince research students of the merits of 'yawning science'. Although it may appear quirky to some, Provine's decision to study yawning was a logical extension of his research in developmental neuroscience.

The verb 'to yawn' is derived from the Old English *ganien* or *ginian*, meaning to gape or open wide. But in addition to gaping jaws, yawning has significant features that are easy to observe and analyse. Provine 'collected' yawns to study by using a variation of the contagion response. He asked people to 'think about yawning' and, once they began to yawn, to depress a button that would record from the start of the yawn to the exhalation at its end.

Provine's early discoveries can be summarized as follows: the yawn is highly stereotyped but not invariant in its duration and form. It is an excellent example of the instinctive 'fixed action pattern' of classical animal-behavior study, or ethology. It is not a reflex (short-duration, rapid, proportional response to a simple stimulus), but, once started, a yawn progresses with the inevitability of a sneeze. The standard yawn runs its course over about six seconds on average, but its duration can range from about three seconds to much longer than the average. There are no half-yawns: this is an example of the typical intensity of fixed action patterns and a reason why you cannot stifle yawns. Just like a cough, yawns can come in bouts with a highly variable inter-yawn interval, which is generally about 68 seconds but rarely more than 70. There is no relation between yawn frequency and duration: producers of short or long yawns do not compensate by yawning more or less often. Furthermore, Provine's hypotheses about the form and function of yawning can be tested by three informative yawn variants which can be used to look at the roles of the nose, the mouth and the jaws.

i) The closed nose yawn — Subjects are asked to pinch their nose closed when they feel themselves start to yawn. Most subjects report being able to perform perfectly normal closed nose yawns. This indicates that the inhalation at the onset of a yawn, and the exhalation at its end, need not involve the nostrils - the mouth provides a sufficient airway.

ii) The clenched teeth yawn — Subjects are asked to clench their teeth when they feel themselves start to yawn but allow themselves to inhale normally through their open lips and clenched teeth. This variant gives one the sensation of being stuck mid-yawn. This shows that gaping of the jaws is an essential component of the fixed action pattern of the

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yawn, and unless it is accomplished, the program (or pattern) will not run to completion. The yawn is also shown to be more than a deep breath, because, unlike normal breathing, inhalation and exhalation cannot be performed so well through the clenched teeth as through the nose.

iii) The nose yawn — This variant tests the adequacy of the nasal airway to sustain a yawn. Unlike normal breathing, which can be performed equally well through mouth or nose, yawning is impossible via nasal inhalation alone. As with the clenched teeth yawn, the nose yawn provides the unfulfilling sensation of being stuck in mid-yawn. Exhalation, on the other hand, can be accomplished equally well through nose or mouth. Through this methodology Provine demonstrated that the oral airway and the gaping of jaws are necessary for normal yawns, and that yawning will not run to completion without feedback that these parts of the program have been accomplished.

But yawning is a powerful, generalized movement that involves much more than airway manoeuvres and jaw-gaping. When yawning you also stretch your facial muscles, tilt your head back, narrow or close your eyes, produce tears, salivate, open the Eustachian tubes of your middle ear and perform many other, yet unspecified, cardiovascular and respiratory acts. Perhaps the yawn shares components with other behaviour. For example, is the yawn a kind of 'slow sneeze' or is the sneeze a 'fast yawn'? Both share common respiratory and other features including jaw gaping, eye closing and head tilting.

Yawning and stretching share properties and may be performed together as parts of a global motor complex. Studies by J I P deVries et al. in the early 1980s, charting movement in the developing foetus using ultrasound, observed a link between yawning and stretching. The most interesting demonstration of the yawn-stretch linkage occurs in many people paralyzed on one side of their body because of brain damage caused by a stroke. The prominent British neurologist Sir Francis Walshe noted in 1923 that when these people yawn, they are startled and mystified to observe that their otherwise paralyzed arm rises and flexes automatically in what neurologists term an 'associated response'. Yawning apparently activates undamaged, unconsciously controlled connections between the brain and the motor system, causing the paralyzed limb to move. It is not known whether the associated response is a positive prognosis for recovery, nor whether yawning is therapeutic for prevention of muscular deterioration.

Provine speculated that, in general, yawning may have many functions, and selecting a single function from the available options may be an unrealistic goal. Yawning appears to be associated with a change of behavioural state, switching from one activity to another. Yawning is also a reminder that ancient and unconscious behaviour linking us to the animal world lurks beneath the veneer of culture, rationality and language.

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Questions 27–32

Complete the summary below using the list of words, **A–K**, *below.*

LIST OF WORDS

A form and function
B long yawns
C 3 seconds
D fixed action pattern
E 68 seconds
F short yawns
G reflex
H sneeze
I short duration
J 6 seconds
K half-yawns

Provine's early findings on yawns

Through his observation of yawns, Provine was able to confirm that (27) _____ do not exist. Just like a (28) _____, yawns cannot be interrupted after they have begun. This is because yawns occur as a (29) _____ rather than a stimulus response, as was previously thought.

In measuring the time taken to yawn, Provine found that a typical yawn lasts about (30) _____. He also found that it is common for people to yawn a number of times in quick succession, with the yawns usually being around (31) _____ apart. When studying whether length and rate were connected, Provine concluded that people who yawn less do not necessarily produce (32) _____.

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Questions 33–37

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** *or* **D**.

33 What did Provine conclude from his 'closed nose yawn' experiment?

A Ending a yawn requires use of the nostrils.
B You can yawn without breathing through your nose.
C Breathing through the nose produces a silent yawn.
D The role of the nose in yawning needs further investigation.

34 Provine's clenched teeth yawn experiment shows that

A yawning is unconnected with fatigue.
B a yawn is the equivalent of a deep intake of breath.
C you have to be able to open your mouth wide to yawn.
D breathing with the teeth together is as efficient as through the nose.

35 The nose yawn experiment was used to test whether yawning

A can be stopped after it has started.
B is the result of motor programming.
C involves both inhalation and exhalation.
D can be accomplished only through the nose.

36 In people paralyzed on one side because of brain damage,

A yawning may involve only one side of the face.
B the yawning response indicates that recovery is likely.
C movement in the paralysed arm is stimulated by yawning.
D yawning can be used as an example to prevent muscle wasting.

37 In the last paragraph, the writer concludes that

A yawning is a sign of boredom.
B we yawn in spite of the development of our species.
C yawning is a more passive activity than we imagine.
D we are stimulated to yawn when our brain activity is low.

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Questions 38–40

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

YES *if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

38 Research students were initially reluctant to appreciate the value of Provine's studies.

39 When foetuses yawn and stretch they are learning how to control movement.

40 According to Provine, referring to only one function is probably inadequate to explain why people yawn.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 9

Volume 3 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

How to Find Your Way Out of a Food Desert

Ordinary citizens have been using the internet to draw attention to the lack of healthy eating options in inner cities.

Over the last few months, a survey has been carried out of over 200 greengrocers and convenience stores in Crown Heights, a neighbourhood in Brooklyn, New York. As researchers from the Brooklyn Food Association enter the details, colorful dots appear on their online map, which display the specific location of each of the food stores in a handful of central Brooklyn neighbourhoods. Clicking on a dot will show you the store's name and whether it carries fresh fruit and vegetables, wholegrain bread, low-fat dairy and other healthy options.

The researchers plan eventually to survey the entire borough of Brooklyn. 'We want to get to a more specific and detailed description of what that looks like', says Jeffrey Heehs, who leads the project. He hopes it will help residents find fresh food in urban areas where the stores sell mostly packaged snacks or fast food, areas otherwise known as food deserts. The aim of the project is also to assist government officials in assessing food availability, and in forming future policies about what kind of food should be sold and where.

In fact, the Brooklyn project represents the intersection of two growing trends: mapping fresh food markets in US cities, and private citizens creating online maps of local neighborhood features. According to Michael Goodchild, a geographer at the University of California at Santa Barbara, citizen map makers may make maps because there is no good government map, or to record problems such as burned-out traffic lights.

According to recent studies, people at higher risk of chronic disease and who receive minimal incomes for the work they do, frequently live in neighborhoods located in food deserts. But how did these food deserts arise? Linda Alwitt and Thomas Donley, marketing researchers at DePaul University in Chicago, found that supermarkets often can't afford the amount of land required for their stores in cities. City planning researcher Cliff Guy and colleagues at the University of Leeds in the UK found in 2004 that smaller urban groceries tend to close due to competition from suburban supermarkets.

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As fresh food stores have left neighborhoods, residents find it harder to eat well and stay healthy. Food deserts are linked with lower local health outcomes, and they may be a driving force in the health disparities between lower-income and affluent people in the US. Until recently, the issue attracted little national attention, and received no ongoing funding for research.

Now, more US cities are becoming aware of their food landscapes. Last year, the United States Department of Agriculture launched a map of where food stores are located in all the US counties. Mari Gallagher, who runs a private consulting firm, says her researchers have mapped food stores and related them to health statistics for the cities of Detroit, Chicago, Cincinnati and Washington, D.C. These maps help cities identify where food deserts are and, occasionally, have documented that people living in food deserts have higher rates of diet-related diseases.

The Brooklyn project differs in that it is run by a local core of five volunteers who have worked on the project for the past year, rather than trained, academic researchers. To gather data, they simply go to individual stores with pre-printed surveys in hand, and once the storekeeper's permission has been obtained, check off boxes on their list against the products for sale in the store. Their approach to data collection and research has been made possible by technologies such as mapping software and GPS-related smart phones, Google Maps and OpenStreetMap, an open-source online map with a history of involvement in social issues. Like Brooklyn Food Association volunteers, many citizen online map makers use maps to bring local problems to official attention. Heehs, the mapping project leader, says that after his group gathers more data, it will compare neighborhoods, come up with solutions to address local needs, and then present them to New York City officials. Their website hasn't caught them much local or critical attention yet, however. It was launched only recently, but its creators haven't yet set up systems to see who's looking at it.

Experts who visited the Brooklyn group's site were optimistic but cautious. 'This kind of detailed information could be very useful' says Michele Ver Ploeg, an economist for the Department of Agriculture. To make the map more helpful to both residents and policy makers, she would like to see price data for healthy products, too. Karen Ansel, a registered dietician and a spokesperson for the American Dietetic Association, found the site confusing to navigate. 'That said, with this information in place the group has the tools to build a more user-friendly site that could be ... very helpful to consumers', she says. 'The group also should ensure their map is available to those who don't have internet access at home', she adds. In fact, a significant proportion of Brooklyn residents don't have internet access at home and 8 percent rely on dial-up service, instead of high-speed internet access, according to Gretchen Maneval, director of Brooklyn College's Center for the Study of Brooklyn. 'It's still very much a work in progress', Heehs says of the online map. They'll

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start advertising it online and by email to other community groups, such as urban food garden associations, next month. He also hopes warmer days in the spring will draw out fresh volunteers to spread awareness and to finish surveying, as they have about two-thirds of Brooklyn left to cover.

Questions 1–6

Complete the notes below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Data on food deserts and their effects on health

THE BROOKLYN FOOD ASSOCIATION

- The online map provides users with a store's name, (1) _____ and details of its produce
- One goal of the mapping project is to help develop new (2) _____ on food
- Citizen maps are sometimes made when (3) _____ maps are unsatisfactory

REASONS FOR THE DEVELOPMENT OF FOOD DESERTS

- New research suggests that people living in food deserts often have low (4) _____
- Some supermarkets are unable to buy enough (5) _____ inside cities for their stores
- Small grocery stores in cities often cannot cope with supermarket (6) _____

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Questions 7–13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

7 A group of professional researchers are in charge of the Brooklyn project.

8 The Brooklyn project team carries out their assessment of stores without the owner's knowledge.

9 The Brooklyn project has experienced technical difficulties setting up the website.

10 The city government has taken a considerable interest in the Brooklyn project website.

11 Michele Ver Ploeg believes the Brooklyn project website should contain additional information.

12 The rate of internet use in Brooklyn is unlikely to increase in the near future.

13 Jeffrey Heehs would like more people to assist with the Brooklyn project research.

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Reading Passage 2

The Dingo Debate

Graziers see them as pests, and poisoning is common, but some biologists think Australia's dingoes are the best weapon in a war against imported cats and foxes.

A A plane flies a slow pattern over Carlton Hill station, a 3,600 square kilometre ranch in the Kimberley region in northwest Australia. As the plane circles, those aboard drop 1,000 small pieces of meat, one by one, onto the scrubland below, each piece laced with poison; this practice is known as baiting. Besides 50,000 head of cattle, Carlton Hill is home to the dingo, Australia's largest mammalian predator and the bane of a grazier's life. Stuart McKechnie, manager of Carlton Hill, complains that graziers' livelihoods are threatened when dingoes prey on cattle. But one man wants the baiting to end, and for dingoes to once again roam Australia's wide-open spaces. According to Chris Johnson of James Cook University, 'Australia needs more dingoes to protect our biodiversity'.

B About 4,000 years ago, Asian sailors introduced dingoes to Australia. Throughout the ensuing millennia, these descendants of the wolf spread across the continent and, as the Tasmanian tiger disappeared completely from Australia, dingoes became Australia's top predators. As agricultural development took place, the European settlers found that they could not safely keep their livestock where dingoes roamed. So began one of the most sustained efforts at pest control in Australia's history. Over the last 150 years, dingoes have been shot and poisoned, and fences have been used in an attempt to keep them away from livestock. But at the same time, as the European settlers tried to eliminate one native pest from Australia, they introduced more of their own.

C In 1860, the rabbit was unleashed on Australia by a wealthy landowner and by 1980 rabbits had covered most of the mainland. Rabbits provide huge prey base for two other introduced species: the feral (wild) cat and the red fox. The interaction between foxes, cats and rabbits is a huge problem for native mammals. In good years, rabbit numbers increase dramatically, and fox and cat populations grow quickly in response to the abundance of this prey. When bad seasons follow, rabbit numbers are significantly reduced - and the dwindling but still large fox and cat populations are left with little to eat besides native mammals.

D Australian mammals generally reproduce much more slowly than rabbits, cats and foxes - and adapt to prevent overpopulation in the arid environment, where food can be scarce and unreliable - and populations decline because they can't grow fast enough to replace animals killed by the predators. Johnson says dingoes are the solution to this problem because they keep cat and fox populations under control. Besides regularly eating the smaller predators, dingoes will kill them simply to lessen competition. Dingo packs live

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in large, stable territories and generally have only one fertile female, which limits their rate of increase. In the 4,000 years that dingoes have been in Australia, they have contributed to few, if any, extinctions, Johnson says.

E Reaching out from a desolate spot where three states meet, for 2,500 km in either direction, is the world's longest fence, two metres high and stretching from the coast in Queensland to the Great Australian Bight in South Australia; it is there to keep dingoes out of the southeast. The fence separates the main types of livestock found in Australia. To the northwest of the fence, cattle predominate; to the southwest, sheep fill the landscape. In fact, Australia is a land dominated by these animals - 25 million cattle, 100 million sheep and just over 20 million people.

F While there is no argument that dingoes will prey on sheep if given the chance, they don't hunt cattle once the calves are much past two or three weeks old, according to McKechnie. And a study in Queensland suggests that dingoes don't even prey heavily on the newborn calves unless their staple prey disappears due to deteriorating conditions like drought. This study, co-authored by Lee Allen of the Robert Wicks Research Centre in Queensland, suggests that the aggressive baiting programs used against dingoes may actually be counter-productive for graziers. When dingoes are removed from an area by baiting, the area is recolonized by younger, more solitary dingoes. These animals aren't capable of going after the large prey like kangaroos, so they turn to calves. In their study, some of the highest rates of calf predation occurred in areas that had been baited.

G Mark Clifford, general manager of a firm that manages over 200,000 head of cattle, is not convinced by Allen's assertion. Clifford says, 'It's obvious if we drop or loosen control on dingoes, we are going to lose more calves.' He doesn't believe that dingoes will go after kangaroos when calves are around. Nor is he persuaded of dingoes' supposed ecological benefits, saying he is not convinced that they manage to catch cats that often, believing they are more likely to catch small native animals instead.

H McKechnie agrees that dingoes kill the wallabies (small native animals) that compete with his cattle for food, but points out that in parts of Western Australia, there are no foxes, and not very many cats. He doesn't see how relaxing controls on dingoes in his area will improve the ecological balance. Johnson sees a change in philosophy on the part of graziers. 'There might be a number of different ways of thinking through dingo management in cattle country,' he says. 'At the moment, though, that hasn't got through to graziers. There's still just one prescription, and that is to bait as widely as possible.'

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Questions 14–20

Reading Passage 2 has eight sections, **A–H**. *Which section contains the following information? NB You may use any letter more than once.*

Q	Information	Section
14	a description of a barrier designed to stop dingoes, which also divides two kinds of non-native animals	
15	how dingoes ensure that rival species do not dominate	
16	a reference to a widespread non-native species that other animals feed on	
17	a mention of the dingo's arrival in Australia	
18	research which has proved that dingoes have resorted to eating young livestock	
19	a description of a method used to kill dingoes	
20	the way that the structure of dingo groups affects how quickly their numbers grow	

Questions 21–23

Look at the following statements and the list of people below. Match each statement with the correct person, **A–D**.

LIST OF PEOPLE

A Stuart McKechnie
B Chris Johnson
C Lee Allen
D Mark Clifford

Q	Statement	Answer
21	Dingoes tend to hunt native animals rather than hunting other non-native predators.	
22	The presence of dingoes puts the income of some people at risk.	
23	Dingoes have had little impact on the dying out of animal species in Australia.	

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Questions 24–26

Complete the sentences below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

The dingo replaced the (24) _____ as the main predatory animal in Australia.

Foxes and cats are more likely to hunt native animals when there are fewer (25) _____.

Australian animals reproduce at a slow rate as a natural way of avoiding (26) _____.

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Reading Passage 3

Pacific Navigation and Voyaging

How people migrated to the Pacific islands

The many tiny islands of the Pacific Ocean had no human population until ancestors of today's islanders sailed from Southeast Asia in ocean-going canoes approximately 2,000 years ago. At the present time, the debate continues about exactly how they migrated such vast distances across the ocean, without any of the modern technologies we take for granted.

Although the romantic vision of some early twentieth-century writers of fleets of heroic navigators simultaneously setting sail had come to be considered by later investigators to be exaggerated, no considered assessment of Pacific voyaging was forthcoming until 1956 when the American historian Andrew Sharp published his research. Sharp challenged the 'heroic vision' by asserting that the expertise of the navigators was limited, and that the settlement of the islands was not systematic, being more dependent on good fortune by drifting canoes. Sharp's theory was widely challenged, and deservedly so. If nothing else, however, it did spark renewed interest in the topic and precipitated valuable new research.

Since the 1960s a wealth of investigations has been conducted, and most of them, thankfully, have been of the 'non-armchair' variety. While it would be unfair to denigrate all 'armchair' research - that based on an examination of available published materials - it has turned out that so little progress had been made in the area of Pacific voyaging because most writers relied on the same old sources - travellers' journals or missionary narratives compiled by uninvolved observers. After Sharp, this began to change, and researchers conducted most of their investigations not in libraries, but in the field.

In 1965, David Lewis, a physician and experienced yachtsman, set to work using his own unique philosophy: he took the yacht he had owned for many years and navigated through the islands in order to contact those men who still find their way at sea using traditional methods. He then accompanied these men, in their traditional canoes, on test voyages from which all modern instruments were banished from sight, though Lewis secretly used them to confirm the navigator's calculations. His most famous such voyage was a return trip of around 1,000 nautical miles between two islands in mid-ocean. Far from drifting, as proposed by Sharp, Lewis found that ancient navigators would have known which course to steer by memorizing which stars rose and set in certain positions along the horizon, and this gave them fixed directions by which to steer their boats.

The geographer Edwin Doran followed a quite different approach. He was interested in obtaining exact data on canoe sailing performance, and to that end employed the latest electronic instrumentation. Doran traveled on board traditional sailing canoes in some of

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the most remote parts of the Pacific, all the while using his instruments to record canoe speeds in different wind strengths - from gales to calms - and the angle canoes could sail relative to the wind. In the process, he provided the first really precise attributes of traditional sailing canoes.

A further contribution was made by Steven Horvath. As a physiologist, Horvath's interest was not in navigation techniques or in canoes, but in the physical capabilities of the men themselves. By adapting standard physiological techniques, Horvath was able to calculate the energy expenditure required to paddle canoes of this sort at times when there was no wind to fill the sails, or when the wind was contrary. He concluded that paddles, or perhaps long oars, could indeed have propelled for long distances what were primarily sailing vessels.

Finally, a team led by P Wall Garrard conducted important research, in this case by making investigations while remaining safely in the laboratory. Wall Garrard's unusual method was to use the findings of linguists who had studied the languages of the Pacific islands, many of which are remarkably similar although the islands where they are spoken are sometimes thousands of kilometres apart. Clever adaptation of computer simulation techniques pioneered in other disciplines allowed him to produce convincing models suggesting the migrations were indeed systematic, but not simultaneous. Wall Garrard proposed the migrations should be seen not as a single journey made by a massed fleet of canoes, but as a series of ever more ambitious voyages, each pushing further into the unknown ocean.

What do we learn about Pacific navigation and voyaging from this research? Quite correctly, none of the researchers tried to use their findings to prove one theory or another; experiments such as these cannot categorically confirm or negate a hypothesis. The strength of this research lay in the range of methodologies employed. When we splice together these findings we can propose that traditional navigators used a variety of canoe types, sources of water and navigation techniques, and it was this adaptability was their greatest accomplishment. These navigators observed the conditions prevailing at sea at the time a voyage was made and altered their techniques accordingly. Furthermore, the canoes of the navigators were not drifting helplessly at sea but were most likely part of a systematic migration; as such, the Pacific peoples were able to view the ocean as an avenue, not a barrier, to communication before any other race on Earth. Finally, one unexpected but most welcome consequence of this research has been a renaissance in the practice of traditional voyaging. In some groups of islands in the Pacific today young people are resurrecting the skills of their ancestors, when a few decades ago it seemed they would be lost forever.

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Questions 27–31

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

YES *if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

27 The Pacific islands were uninhabited when migrants arrived by sea from Southeast Asia.

28 Andrew Sharp was the first person to write about the migrants to the islands.

29 Andrew Sharp believed migratory voyages were based more on luck than skill.

30 Despite being controversial, Andrew Sharp's research had positive results.

31 Edwin Doran disagreed with the findings of Lewis's research.

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Questions 32–36

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** *or* **D**.

32 David Lewis's research was different because

A he observed traditional navigators at work.
B he conducted test voyages using his own yacht.
C he carried no modern instruments on test voyages.
D he spoke the same language as the islanders he sailed with.

33 What did David Lewis's research discover about traditional navigators?

A They used the sun and moon to find their position.
B They could not sail further than about 1,000 nautical miles.
C They knew which direction they were sailing in.
D They were able to drift for long distances.

34 What are we told about Edwin Doran's research?

A Data were collected after the canoes had returned to land.
B Canoe characteristics were recorded using modern instruments.
C Research was conducted in the most densely populated regions.
D Navigators were not allowed to see the instruments Doran used.

35 Which of the following did Steven Horvath discover during his research?

A Canoe design was less important than human strength.
B New research methods had to be developed for use in canoes.
C Navigators became very tired on the longest voyages.
D Human energy may have been used to assist sailing canoes.

36 What is the writer's opinion of P Wall Garrard's research?

A He is disappointed it was conducted in the laboratory.
B He is impressed by the originality of the techniques used.
C He is surprised it was used to help linguists with their research.
D He is concerned that the islands studied are long distances apart.

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Questions 37–40

Complete each sentence with the correct ending, **A–F**, *below.*

SENTENCE ENDINGS

A was the variety of experimental techniques used.

B was not of interest to young islanders today.

C was not conclusive evidence in support of a single theory.

D was being able to change their practices when necessary.

E was the first time humans intentionally crossed an ocean.

F was the speed with which it was conducted.

37 One limitation in the information produced by all of this research is that it ____

38 The best thing about this type of research ____

39 The most important achievement of traditional navigators ____

40 The migration of people from Asia to the Pacific ____

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 10

Volume 3 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

A Brief History of Humans and Food

During the journey from our hunter-gatherer ancestors to the present day there have been three seismic changes that have had an impact on the food we eat: the discovery of cooking, the emergence of agriculture and the invention of methods of preserving food.

The 19th-century scientist Charles Darwin thought that cooking, after language, was the greatest discovery made by man. All of us eat some raw food, for instance fruit and vegetables, but the great majority of food we eat is cooked. Cooking can turn plants that are inedible into edible food by destroying toxic chemicals that plants often manufacture to protect themselves against attack by insects or other herbivorous animals. These toxic chemicals are referred to as 'plant secondary compounds', because they are not directly involved in the plant's normal growth, development and reproduction, and are produced purely as chemical defences. They give many of the plants we consume, such as coffee or brussels sprouts, their bitter taste.

Cooked food is often more digestible, because heat breaks down tough cellulose cell walls in plants or tough connective tissue in animals. Chewing raw turnip, a plate of uncooked rice, or a raw leg of lamb is much harder work than eating the cooked equivalent. The energy expended in chewing to break down the tough material is replaced by energy from the fuel that is used in cooking the food, so the ratio of energy gained to energy expended by the body is greater when food is cooked.

Until the development of agriculture, hunter-gatherers spent up to seven hours a day gathering food. This all began to change around 10,500 years ago with the advent of farming, which led to some dramatic changes in human societies. People began to create a variety of new tools to help with survival, and in turn populations increased in size. These changes led to the possibility of specialisation of different tasks within society. It was around this time that writing became more sophisticated and allowed people to maintain records of the harvest and taxes. Eventually, formalised structures of government were established as people settled in one area.

The arrival of agriculture meant that, for the first time, our ancestors had more food than they could eat immediately. This, combined with the seasonality of production, led them to discover methods of preserving food: smoking, drying, adding acid by fermentation or salting. These four methods all share one feature in common: they make the food a more

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hostile environment in which the microorganisms that cause decay cannot easily survive. They also tend to slow down any natural chemical reactions in the food that would cause decay.

Although foods today are still preserved in the ancient ways, two more recent methods of preserving food have become more common: canning and freezing. Canning was invented by a Frenchman, Nicholas Appert, in the early-19th century. He sealed food in bottles fabricated from glass and then heated them in boiling water to cook the contents. Appert's method had great advantages over other methods of food preservation: it could be applied to a wide range of foods, and the flavour of the food as well as the texture were similar to the freshly cooked product. His idea was soon copied by an Englishman, Peter Durand. Until this point containers had weighed too much to be widely used, but he produced the first ones which were light and resistant to damage. Two years later, in 1812, two Englishmen, Bryan Donkin and John Hall, started the commercial canning of food, although the real take-off in popularity of canning had to wait until the can opener was invented in 1855. Up to this time, cans were opened with a chisel which was used to break open the top when hit with a hammer. One can, which contained meat dating from 1824 was opened in 1939 and the contents were still in good condition.

In the 21st century, the dominance of canning as a method of food preservation has been overtaken by another technology: freezing. Chilling food to keep it fresh is an old idea. The earliest mentions of icehouses, thick-walled buildings half underground, date back to 1,700BC in northwest Iran. In early 16th-century Italy, water was mixed with chemicals to lower its freezing point to -18 degrees Celsius, and several centuries later frozen fish and other goods were transported by ship from Australia to England. But the modern frozen food industry was started in the 1920s by an American, Clarence Birdseye. While Birdseye was on a fishing trip with the Inuit in the Canadian Arctic, he observed that very rapid freezing creates smaller ice crystals and therefore causes less damage to food. This was something he had not expected. Nevertheless, the big growth in demand for frozen food came about with the arrival of freezers in the homes of ordinary people. The advantages of frozen over canned food include the fact that the flavour and consistency are often identical to the equivalent fresh product, and that freezing can be used to preserve a huge variety of foods.

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Questions 1–5

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

1 According to Darwin, cooking was the most significant development in human history.

2 The process of cooking gets rid of some plant poisons.

3 Eating cooked food is more energy efficient than eating raw food.

4 Clarence Birdseye had previously worked in the Australian food industry.

5 Birdseye's trip with the Inuit confirmed what he already believed about rapid freezing.

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Questions 6–13

Complete the notes below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

The development of agriculture and food preservation

THE CHANGES AGRICULTURE BROUGHT ABOUT WERE:

- the development of equipment and larger (6) _____
- the ability to keep (7) _____ as writing developed
- the setting up of organised government

FOOD PRESERVATION

- early methods of food preservation included smoking, drying and combining food with acid by (8) _____
- Appert's method resulted in preserved food that had a similar taste and (9) _____ to fresh food
- Peter Durand introduced cans which were lightweight and (10) _____ to damage
- in 1855, the metal can opener replaced the (11) _____ which had been used with a hammer to open cans
- some food was still found to be edible after more than a hundred years, e.g. an old can of (12) _____
- freezing causes less (13) _____ to food

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Reading Passage 2

Why Do We Need the Arts?

Sometimes people question why we need 'the arts': what functions do art, music, dance and literature serve?

A Imagine a world in which people spend hours working in offices or factories, and then go home in the evening to sit down to dinner, after which they sleep until it's time to get up and work again. In this world, people do not read or watch TV, listen to music, play computer games or have pictures to decorate their homes. In fact, there are no pictures in this world - not even advertisements are illustrated, but all are words, and very plain ones at that, with no playfulness left in them. The buildings are completely functional without a single decorative feature anywhere, and there is no music to dance to and enjoy. Such a world is a world without the arts in any form.

B To ask what the arts are good for is not exactly the same as asking what their purpose is. The arts do not have to have a purpose - they do not exist in order to teach, to make a moral point, to entertain, to distract, to amuse, to support a revolution, to disgust, to challenge, to stimulate or to cheer; they exist chiefly for their own sake. It is artists, not the arts as such, that may have an aim in mind, and their aim may be to do any of the things just listed. But equally, artists may just make a work of art because they feel compelled to. Because the work is its own justification, no aim or goal is necessarily required to explain or, still less, to justify its existence.

C But to say that the arts are good for something beyond themselves, even though they may sometimes do so, is not to say that they are good for nothing. On the contrary, as such an important part of human experience, they are good for many things. The distinction here lies between things that are instrumental and things that are ends in themselves. An instrument exists for something beyond itself - namely, for what it can be used to do. We know that pictures are used as instruments in advertising, and the objective is always to persuade us to buy something. Similarly, music can be written chiefly to accompany dancing, or as a soundtrack to a movie. A play can be written to point out to the theatre audience a social injustice or other problems that should be dealt with. But even though the arts can sometimes be instrumental, that fact is not essential to their nature. What the arts are 'good for' arises from their being an end in themselves, or more accurately, representing many different things that are valuable for their own sakes - such as, for instance, the creation of beauty.

D The phrase 'the arts' includes painting, sculpture, music, literature, dance and theatre performance, and whatever else (to quote the famous US artist Andy Warhol) anyone can get away with in calling their creation a contribution to 'the arts'. But the generalisation

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that the arts, whatever else they are, are always an end in themselves, applies to them all. The arts are one major form of response to the world. They are often an attempt to capture an aspect of the world, to draw attention to something about it, to comment on it, to present a surprising or fresh angle on it, to represent it for the sake of exploring something about it, or enjoying or celebrating it. They can help people to focus on, for example, the colour or shape of an object, its eccentricity or typicality, and the interest or perhaps disgust it provokes in them.

E For a loose comparison, think of laughing at a joke. We do not laugh so that we can achieve a further goal - in order to be healthy or relaxed, say, even if we thereby succeed in being healthier or more relaxed - but simply because the joke has elicited that reaction. But although it is merely a reaction, laughing is, in fact, good for something nevertheless; it does make people feel better. The arts are a reaction in the same way. French artist Cezanne painted Mont Sainte-Victoire repeatedly because he was fascinated by it, not because he thought that painting it would say something about politics or society or human hopes. Being fascinated by something, attracted to it, repelled by it, keen to reveal an unusual aspect of it, are all responses to that thing; the making of the arts is one outstanding way of expressing such responses.

F But the arts are a response not only to things in the world but also to experience of the world, which lies inside the artist himself. And they are also often an expression of what presses from within the artist without being elicited by externals. Music is a prime example. A symphony, unless it is devised to represent bird song, rain, the sea and the like, is an abstract expression of a composer's conception. We may be able to describe what the Russian composer Tchaikovsky is doing in his ballet music, but how can we describe what he is expressing in his piano concertos? Composers may experiment with melody and rhythm in very abstract, sometimes mathematical, ways.

G When artists get to work responding to and expressing ideas, whether or not they also want to make a point, entertain, distract, support a revolution and the rest, they are producing something that someone else will react to in some way. They seek to connect with their audience and express an idea or emotion which has the capacity to enrich our experience of life itself.

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Questions 14–18

Reading Passage 2 has seven paragraphs, **A–G**. *Which paragraph contains the following information?*

Q	Information	Paragraph
14	a claim that artists may have no clear objective when creating a piece of art	
15	a description of how artists hope to benefit other people	
16	a comparison between the arts and things made to perform a particular function	
17	a claim that it's possible to convince the world that anything you have made is a work of art	
18	an example of something that has an unintentional benefit for us	

Questions 19–22

Complete the summary below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

The arts and human experience

Some people may claim that the arts serve no useful purpose, that they achieve nothing measurable and help nobody. But there are many clear examples of their usefulness, such as the inter-dependent relationship between music and (19) _____, or between the visual arts and the (20) _____ business. A dramatist may use a (21) _____ to draw our attention to various issues in society, for example some kind of injustice which needs correcting. Apart from these obvious practical benefits, there are other benefits that we gain from things, such as the (22) _____ we find in an artist's work.

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Questions 23 and 24

Choose **TWO** *letters,* **A–E**. *In paragraph* **D**, *which* **TWO** *of the following effects does the writer say the arts can have?*

23

24

A They can interest people from all over the world.
B They can make us see things from a different perspective.
C They can inspire us to take up an artistic activity ourselves.
D They can encourage us to think about our reactions to things around us.
E They can draw our attention to serious global issues.

Questions 25 and 26

Choose **TWO** *letters,* **A–E**. *Which* **TWO** *of the following statements about composers and music does the writer make?*

25

26

A Music tends to spring from the composer's individual experiences.
B Composers need to structure music very carefully.
C Music can be quite unrelated to the natural world.
D Music finds its best expression in a symphony.
E Composers are good at depicting the world around us.

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Reading Passage 3

The Significant Role of Mother Tongue Language in Education

One consequence of population mobility is an increasing diversity within schools. To illustrate, in the city of Toronto in Canada, 58% of kindergarten pupils come from homes where English is not the language of communication. Schools in Europe and North America have experienced this diversity for years, but educational policies and practices vary widely between countries and even within countries. Some political parties and groups search for ways to 'solve the problem' of diverse communities and their integration in schools and society. They see few positive consequences for the host society and worry that diversity threatens the identity of the host society. Consequently, they promote unfortunate educational policies that will make the 'problem' disappear. If students retain their culture and language, they are viewed as less capable of identifying with the mainstream culture and learning the mainstream language of the society.

The challenge for educators and policy-makers is to shape the evolution of national identity in such a way that the rights of all citizens (including school children) are respected, and the cultural, linguistic and economic resources of the nation are maximized. To waste the resources of the nation by discouraging children from developing their mother tongues is quite simply unintelligent from the point of view of national self-interest. A first step in providing an appropriate education for culturally and linguistically diverse children is to examine what the existing research says about the role of children's mother tongues in their educational development.

In fact, the research is very clear. When children continue to develop their abilities in two or more languages throughout primary school, they gain a deeper understanding of language and how to use it effectively. They have more practice in processing language, especially when they develop literacy in both. More than 150 research studies conducted during the past 35 years strongly support what Goethe, the famous eighteenth-century German philosopher, once said: that the person who knows only one language does not truly know that language. Research suggests that bilingual children may also develop more flexibility in their thinking as a result of processing information through two different languages.

Children who come to school with a solid foundation in their mother tongue develop stronger literacy abilities in the school language. When parents and other caregivers (e.g. grandparents) are able to spend time with their children and tell stories or discuss issues with them in a way that develops their mother tongue, children come to school well-prepared to learn the school language and succeed educationally. Children's knowledge

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and skills transfer across languages from the mother tongue to the school language. Transfer across languages can be two-way: both languages nurture each other when the educational environment permits children access to both languages.

Some educators and parents are suspicious of mother tongue-based teaching programs because they worry that they take time away from the majority language. For example, in a bilingual program where 50% of the time is spent teaching through children's home language and 50% through the majority language, surely children won't progress as far in the latter? One of the most strongly established findings of educational research, however, is that well-implemented bilingual programs can promote literacy and subject-matter knowledge in a minority language without any negative effects on children's development in the majority language. Within Europe, the Foyer program in Belgium, which develops children's speaking and literacy abilities in three languages (their mother tongue, Dutch and French), most clearly illustrates the benefits of bilingual and trilingual education (see Cummins, 2000).

It is easy to understand how this happens. When children are learning through a minority language, they are learning concepts and intellectual skills too. Pupils who know how to tell the time in their mother tongue understand the concept of telling time. In order to tell time in the majority language they do not need to re-learn the concept. Similarly, at more advanced stages, there is transfer across languages in other skills, such as knowing how to distinguish the main idea from the supporting details of a written passage or story, and distinguishing fact from opinion. Studies of secondary school pupils are providing interesting findings in this area, and it would be worth extending this research.

Many people marvel at how quickly bilingual children seem to 'pick up' conversational skills in the majority language at school (although it takes much longer for them to catch up with native speakers in academic language skills). However, educators are often much less aware of how quickly children can lose their ability to use their mother tongue, even in the home context. The extent and rapidity of language loss will vary according to the concentration of families from a particular linguistic group in the neighborhood. Where the mother tongue is used extensively in the community, then language loss among young children will be less. However, where language communities are not concentrated in particular neighborhoods, children can lose their ability to communicate in their mother tongue within two to three years of starting school. They may retain receptive skills in the language but they will use the majority language in speaking with their peers and siblings and in responding to their parents. By the time children become adolescents, the linguistic division between parents and children has become an emotional chasm. Pupils frequently become alienated from the cultures of both home and school, with predictable results.

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Questions 27–30

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** *or* **D**.

27 What point is the writer making in the second paragraph?

A Some present studies on children's mother tongues are misleading.
B A culturally rich education programme benefits some children more than others.
C Bilingual children can make a valuable contribution to the wealth of a country.
D The law on mother tongue use at school should be strengthened.

28 Why does the writer refer to something that Goethe said?

A to lend weight to his argument
B to contradict some research
C to introduce a new concept
D to update current thinking

29 The writer believes that when young children have a firm grasp of their mother tongue

A they can teach older family members what they learn at school.
B they go on to do much better throughout their time at school.
C they can read stories about their cultural background.
D they develop stronger relationships with their family than with their peers.

30 Why are some people suspicious about mother tongue-based teaching programmes?

A They worry that children will be slow to learn to read in either language.
B They think that children will confuse words in the two languages.
C They believe that the programmes will make children less interested in their lessons.
D They fear that the programmes will use up valuable time in the school day.

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Questions 31–35

Complete the summary below using the list of words, **A–J**, *below.*

LIST OF WORDS

A teachers
B school
C dislocation
D rate
E time
F family
G communication
H type
I ability
J area

Bilingual children

It has often been noted that bilingual children acquire the (31) ———— to converse in the majority language remarkably quickly. The fact that the mother tongue can disappear at a similar (32) ———— is less well understood. This phenomenon depends to a certain extent on the proportion of people with the same linguistic background that have settled in a particular (33) ————. If this is limited, children are likely to lose the active use of their mother tongue, and thus no longer employ it even with (34) ————, although they may still understand it. It follows that teenage children in these circumstances experience a sense of (35) ———— in relation to all aspects of their lives.

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Questions 36–40

Do the following statements agree with the views of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

YES *if the statement agrees with the views of the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the views of the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

36 Less than half the children who attend kindergarten in Toronto have English as their mother tongue.

37 Research proves that learning the host country language at school can have an adverse effect on a child's mother tongue.

38 The Foyer programme is to be adopted by the French education system.

39 Bilingual children are taught to tell the time earlier than monolingual children.

40 Bilingual children can eventually apply reading comprehension strategies acquired in one language when reading in the other.

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PART TWO

Answer Keys

Complete answer keys for Tests 1–10 of Volume 3. Check your answers only after finishing each test.

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 1 (Volume 3)

Passage 1 — Fishbourne Roman Palace

1. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	**first structure** built on the site
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the palace was built "on the site of Roman army **grain stores** which had been established after the invasion" — the grain stores came first.

2. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	renovated **more than once**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"There were **extensive alterations** in the 2nd and 3rd centuries AD"... "More alterations were in progress when the palace burnt down"

3. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	**large** compared with Roman palaces in Italy
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"would have been **approximately equivalent** to some of the great Roman palaces of Italy" — equivalent, not larger; it was largest only north of the Alps.

4. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	research **continuing** nearby
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"A team of volunteers and professional archaeologists are involved in an **ongoing archaeological excavation** on the site of nearby... buildings"

5. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	researchers **agree** on identity of owner
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Multiple competing theories are given (Cogidubnus, Lucullus, Verica, Catuarus) — "there are **a number of theories**"

6. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	burnt down **by local people**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	The passage only says "the palace burnt down in around 270 AD" — no cause or person is named.

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7. Roman army

QUESTION KEYWORD	food for the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"on the site of **Roman army** grain stores"

8. gardens

QUESTION KEYWORD	palace surrounded ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The rectangular palace was built around formal **gardens**"

9. floors

QUESTION KEYWORD	colour added to the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the original black and white mosaic **floors** being overlaid with more sophisticated coloured ones"

10. wall

QUESTION KEYWORD	first part found was part of a ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"after workmen had accidentally uncovered a **wall** while they were laying a water main"

11. 93

QUESTION KEYWORD	Lucullus lived there until approx ____ AD
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"it would have been confiscated following his execution by the Emperor Domitian in or shortly after **93** AD"

12. gold ring

QUESTION KEYWORD	Catuarus's ____ found there
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"following the recent discovery of a **gold ring** belonging to him"

13. modern museum

QUESTION KEYWORD	a ____ built to protect the site
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"A **modern museum** has been built by the Sussex Archaeological Society, incorporating most of the visible remains"

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Passage 2 — Insect Decision-making

14. vii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph A
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the probability of a correct decision **increases with the size of the jury**" — the number of decision-makers affects the outcome.

15. iii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph B
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	bees "reported back using a characteristic body movement known as a '**waggle dance**'" to signal a discovery.

16. vi

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph C
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Dr List and his colleagues used a **computer-generated model** of the decision-making process"

17. i

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph D
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Halloy "used **robotic cockroaches** to subvert the behaviour of living cockroaches"

18. iv

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph E
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"how the insects reduce the problems associated with making a necessarily **swift choice**" when their nest is threatened

19. ii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph F
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	chosen ants "begin to **lead others**... by a method known as **tandem running**" — guiding fellow ants to the new nest.

20. C — José Halloy

QUESTION KEYWORD	influence group to **alter** a decision

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Halloy's robots "were able to **persuade the living cockroaches** to choose an inappropriate shelter"

21. B — Christian List and colleagues

QUESTION KEYWORD	individual **verification** important
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	success "depends on both... interdependence... and their **independence in confirming** this information for themselves"

22. A — Nicolas de Condorcet

QUESTION KEYWORD	**more individuals**, better decision
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the probability of a correct decision **increases with the size of the jury**"

23. B — Christian List and colleagues

QUESTION KEYWORD	excellent results even with **fine distinctions**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	bees "choosing the best site even when there are only **small differences** between alternative sites"

24. threatened

QUESTION KEYWORD	home has been ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"If the ants' existing nest becomes suddenly **threatened**"

25. scouts

QUESTION KEYWORD	individuals called ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the insects choose certain ants to act as **scouts** to find a new nest"

26. leaders

QUESTION KEYWORD	active ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the necessity... of having active **leaders** in order to execute decisions successfully"

Passage 3 — Fear of the Unknown

27. F

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QUESTION KEYWORD	keep most creative employees
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para F: "Many companies now offer their most creative people **extra rewards, freedom and resources**"

28. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	new way to get help with personal difficulties
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para A: subscribers "feed in details about themselves and their problems and... receive **advice from 'virtual' versions**" of experts

29. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	investment in safeguarding ideas
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para C: "a fortune is spent nowadays on **identifying and protecting intellectual property**"

30. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	two examples of innovative companies
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para B: "innovators such as **Amazon**... and **Wal-Mart**... which have produced completely new ideas"

31. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	avoid spending large sums on testing
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para E: entrepreneurs "conduct profitable, early-stage research, **selling out to the big firms** when they reach expensive, risky clinical trials"

32. G

QUESTION KEYWORD	opinion about product designers to be disproved
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para G: "Many people **assume** that it is the job of product designers to look first to the technology" — the writer implies this is not the real answer.

33. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	target of a large company that changed focus
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para F: "Some giants, including **General Electric and Cisco**, have been remarkably successful at buying up and integrating scores of small companies" — shifting focus to acquisition-driven innovation.

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34. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Umagic is a **new innovative** company
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Umagic Systems is a **young firm**" pursuing a genuinely new business idea.

35. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	Amazon and Wal-Mart **exchanged ideas**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Both are named as innovators, but no exchange or collaboration between them is mentioned.

36. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	financial rewards **outdated**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Many companies **now** offer their most creative people extra rewards" — a current, not outdated, practice.

37. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	IBM **failed to understand** the idea
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"looks of **total incomprehension** when he tried to sell his 'virtual experts' idea to firms such as IBM"

38. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	intellectual property value
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"trading in intangible assets... rose from **$15 billion in 1990 to $100 billion in 1998**"

39. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	Chemin realises
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"'In the management of creativity, **size is your enemy**,' argues Peter Chemin"

40. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	writer's conclusion
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"innovation... is one area where **a computer cannot tell you what to do**" — implying inherent uncertainty.

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 2 (Volume 3)

Passage 1 — Bovids

1. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	region with **biggest range** of bovids
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"well represented in most parts of Eurasia and Southeast Asian islands, but they are by far the **most numerous and diverse** in the latter"

2. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	preference for living in
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the majority of species favour **open grassland, scrub or desert**"

3. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	feature all bovids have in common
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"All species are ruminants, which means that they **retain undigested food in their stomachs**, and regurgitate it as necessary"

4. C — Caprinae

QUESTION KEYWORD	endure very harsh environments
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Barbary and bighorn sheep have adapted to **arid deserts**, while Rocky Mountain sheep survive high up in mountains and musk oxen in **arctic tundra**"

5. B — Bovinae

QUESTION KEYWORD	includes the ox and cow
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Bovinae comprises "the African bongo, nilgae, eland, bison and **cattle**" — ancestors of domestic cattle (ox/cow)

6. D — Cephalophinae

QUESTION KEYWORD	may supplement diet with meat
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	duikers "are believed to eat insects and **feed on dead animal carcasses**, and even to kill small animals"

7. A — Antelope

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QUESTION KEYWORD	can move at speed
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Antelopes are typically **long-legged, fast-running species**"

8. B — Bovinae

QUESTION KEYWORD	does not defend a territory
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Unlike most other bovids they are all **non-territorial**"

9. the royal antelope

QUESTION KEYWORD	smallest species of bovid
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"at one extreme is **the royal antelope** of West Africa, which stands a mere 25 cm at the shoulder"

10. the auroch

QUESTION KEYWORD	Bovinae species now extinct
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the ancestor of the domestic cattle of Europe, **the auroch**, is extinct"

11. long, splayed hooves

QUESTION KEYWORD	facilitates sitatunga's movement over wetland
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the sitatunga has **long, splayed hooves** that enable it to walk freely on swampy ground"

12. arid deserts

QUESTION KEYWORD	terrain barbary sheep adapted to
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Barbary and bighorn sheep have adapted to **arid deserts**"

13. the pronghorn

QUESTION KEYWORD	only living member of Antilocapridae
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**The pronghorn** is the sole survivor of a New World sub-family... the Antilocapridae"

Passage 2 — Photovoltaics on the Rooftop

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14. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	countries with greater daytime electricity use
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para B: "This occurs in places like **California in the US and Japan**, where air-conditioning loads for offices and factories are large but heating loads for homes are small"

15. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	experiment leading to nationwide promotion
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para D: Rokko Island test station — "With no insurmountable problems identified, the Japanese have used the experience gained from this station to begin their own **massive residential photovoltaics campaign**"

16. H

QUESTION KEYWORD	negative effects of conventional generation
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para H: "The use of fossil fuels to generate electricity is not only costly in financial terms, but also in terms of **environmental damage**"

17. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	explanation of the photovoltaics system
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para B: "The photovoltaics-powered home remains connected to the power lines... Figure 1 **illustrates the system**"

18. I

QUESTION KEYWORD	long-term benefits
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para I: "everyone living on the planet stands to gain from the **more benign environmental impact**"

19. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	wealthy countries helping less wealthy countries
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para E describes government subsidies covering "70% of the total system costs" and success "stimulated European countries to launch similar programs" — *note: the developing-world subsidy detail actually appears in Paragraph G ("500,000 in the developing world, to be subsidised by the Commission"); this is worth double-checking against the original answer key.*

20. FALSE

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QUESTION KEYWORD	photovoltaics used to **store** electricity
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"no storage is required on-site... The **grid network effectively provides storage**" — not the photovoltaics themselves.

21. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	**continuous** US government support since 1970s
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"A change in US government priorities in the early 1980s **halted this program**"

22. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Rokko Island houses **uninhabited**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"providing a lavish lifestyle for the **non-existent occupants**"

23. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	1994, Japanese government providing **half** the money
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"made a modest start in 1994, when 539 systems were installed with a government **subsidy of 50 percent**"

24. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	strict greenhouse gas **goals** in those 4 countries
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	These countries are only named as having "announced their own **targets for residential photovoltaics**" — not specifically greenhouse gas emission targets.

25. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	residential electricity = **major source** of emissions
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Residential electricity use is mentioned as receiving "closer attention" but is never ranked as the major source.

26. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	energy-saving measures **must now** be included
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"It is **likely that in the future**, governments will develop building codes" — not a current requirement.

Passage 3 — How Should Reading Be Taught?

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27. iv

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for section B
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Three general approaches have been tried" — whole-word, phonics, whole-language — **methods of teaching reading**.

28. i

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for section C
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"many linguists and psychologists **objected strongly**" — disagreement about how reading works.

29. vii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for section D
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"experiments have been carried out, firstly with **college students**, then with **school pupils**"

30. ii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for section E
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"philosophical differences between traditional and progressive... approaches, differences that have **divided educators for years**"

31. iii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for section F
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the **combination** of literature-based instruction and phonics is more powerful than either method used alone"

32. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	whole-language relates **letters to sounds**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Whole-language relies on "guess[ing] the words... rather than **trying to sound them out**" — phonics, not whole-language, relates letters to sounds.

33. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	whole-language = most **interesting**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Many teachers adopted the whole-language approach because of its **intuitive appeal**. Making reading fun promises to keep children motivated"

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34. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	read **without** linking to sounds
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"most believe that reading is typically a process of **rapidly sounding out words** mentally" — supported by the homophone-confusion evidence.

35. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	whole-word **less effective** than whole-language
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Whole-word is compared with phonics, and whole-language separately with phonics — no direct whole-word vs whole-language comparison is given.

36. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	phonics more successful than **both**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"readers who were taught the rules of phonics could read many **more new words**" than whole-word group; the phonics classroom group also "**scored higher**" than the whole-language-style group.

37. E — progressives

QUESTION KEYWORD	question usefulness of research
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The **progressives** challenge the results of laboratory tests and classroom studies"

38. A — the phonics method

QUESTION KEYWORD	incompatible with student-centred learning
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	progressives "fail to realise that these very admirable educational values are equally consistent with the teaching of **phonics**" (i.e. they mistakenly believe otherwise).

39. G — research studies

QUESTION KEYWORD	teachers should be aware of
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"would-be reading teachers learned something about the vast **research** in linguistics and psychology"

40. C — the whole-language method

QUESTION KEYWORD	ideas that make reading enjoyable
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Using **whole-language** activities to supplement phonics instruction certainly helps to make reading fun"

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 3 (Volume 3)

Passage 1 — The Pesticide-free Village

1. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	cotton expected to raise **more money**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"attracted resident farmers by promising to **bring in more hard cash** than the mixed crops"

2. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	dealers had been **farmers** in the past
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	No background is given about the dealers' previous occupations.

3. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	initial yields were **low**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"A quick 'high' of **booming yields** and incomes hooked growers during the early years"

4. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	failed to **notice** negative effects
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"immediate payoffs... **obscured** the fact that the fields had gone into a freefall of environmental degradation"

5. evergreen tree

QUESTION KEYWORD	use of an ____ called neem
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"neem, a fast-growing, broad-leaved **evergreen tree** related to mahogany"

6. natural pesticides

QUESTION KEYWORD	contains many ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"producing a multitude of **natural pesticides** that have evolved... to defeat plant-eating insects"

7. a powder

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QUESTION KEYWORD	____ formed by grinding seeds
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"neem seeds are simply ground into **a powder**"

8. overnight

QUESTION KEYWORD	left ____ to soak
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"soaked **overnight** in water"

9. neem cake

QUESTION KEYWORD	added in ____ form to soil
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**Neem cake** applied to the soil kills pests"

10. nitrogen

QUESTION KEYWORD	contains a lot of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"doubles as an organic fertiliser high in **nitrogen**"

11. 2000

QUESTION KEYWORD	year farmers stopped using chemicals
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"By the end of **2000**, all the farmers in Punukula village were using NPM"

12. neem cakes

QUESTION KEYWORD	women produced and sold to make money
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"they gathered seeds... and **produced neem cakes** to sell for NPM in other villages"

13. water purification

QUESTION KEYWORD	future project
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"big plans for the future, such as **water purification**"

Passage 2 — New Filter Promises Clean Water for Millions

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14. clay

QUESTION KEYWORD	organic material, ____ and water
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Take a handful of **clay**, mix it with a handful of organic material"

15. water

QUESTION KEYWORD	clay, organic material and ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"add **water** in a sufficient quantity to make a stiff mixture"

16. cow manure

QUESTION KEYWORD	fire made from ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"put them in a mound of **cow manure**, light the straw"

17. straw

QUESTION KEYWORD	and ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"surround the pots with **straw**"

18. 950 degrees

QUESTION KEYWORD	maximum heat of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"will be up to **950 degrees** after another 20 to 30 minutes"

19. 60 minutes

QUESTION KEYWORD	bake for a maximum of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The filters are finished in 45 to **60 minutes**"

20. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Manatuto clay **initially unsuitable**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"initial research found the local clay to be **too fine**"

21. NOT GIVEN

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QUESTION KEYWORD	coffee grounds **twice as efficient**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"used coffee grounds have given the **best results to date**" — no numerical comparison is given.

22. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	half an hour to reach **950 degrees**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"reach a temperature of 700 degrees in half an hour, and will be up to 950 degrees **after another 20 to 30 minutes**" — longer than half an hour total.

23. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	E-coli **most difficult** to remove
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Only E-coli removal rates are given — no comparison with other bacteria's difficulty.

24. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	Manatuto project aimed to set up a
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"wanted to help set up a small industrial site **manufacturing water filters**"

25. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	to be effective, filters must
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"thickness of the clay container needs to be the **same thickness as an adult finger** for the process to be effective"

26. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	doesn't patent because he
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"'Everyone has a right to **clean water**'" — wants it freely available to anyone who needs it.

Passage 3 — Putting the Brakes on Climate Change

27. vii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph A

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"tempting to think that the conservation of coral reefs and rainforests is a **separate issue** from traffic and air pollution. But it is **not**" — a holistic (joined-up) view of climate change.

28. iv

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph B
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The United Nation's **Climate Change Panel** has estimated... temperature rise... as much as 6°C, causing **forest fires and dieback**... coral bleaching"

29. vi

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph C
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	fuel-cell technology "was actually invented in the **late nineteenth century**, but... was never refined for mass production"

30. v

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph D
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"So what's the **process** involved... **Hydrogen goes into the fuel tank**, producing electricity"

31. viii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph E
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"One **source of hydrogen** is water... Another source of hydrogen is, however, available"

32. iii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph F
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"fuel-cell buses are operating in the US... a courier company is planning to take delivery of fuel-cell-powered vans" — early roll-out of the technology.

33. combustion engine

QUESTION KEYWORD	industry invested in the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the world's motor industry put its effort into developing the **combustion engine**"

34. silent

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QUESTION KEYWORD	an almost ____ car
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Ford engineers expect to be able to produce a virtually **silent** vehicle in the future"

35. battery

QUESTION KEYWORD	comparable to a ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The fuel-cell is, in some ways, similar to a **battery**, but unlike a battery it does not run down"

36. portable computers

QUESTION KEYWORD	used in power stations and ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"small enough for **portable computers** or large enough for power stations"

37. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	fossil-fuel electricity **increases** benefit
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"if the electricity is produced by a coal-fired power station... the overall carbon reduction benefit of the fuel-cell **disappears**"

38. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	Statoil owns wells **elsewhere**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Statoil is only said to be "experimenting with storing carbon dioxide... in **oil and gas wells**" — no mention of owning wells in other countries.

39. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	public transport **leading the way**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the fact that **centrally-run fleets of buses and vans** are the first fuel-cell vehicles"

40. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	more funding **necessary**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**further investment is needed** if the industry... is to have a long-term future"

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 4 (Volume 3)

Passage 1 — The Wonder Plant

1. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	current levels of knowledge about bamboo
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para B: "we know surprisingly little about it... revealed just how **profound our ignorance** of global bamboo resources is"

2. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	bamboo vs more fragile plants
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para E: "Some plants are threatened because they **can't survive** in the habitat... But bamboo can **take care of itself**"

3. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	commercial significance
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para D: "bamboo's most immediate significance lies in its **economic value**... worth about US$4.5 billion annually"

4. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	human development threatening bamboo
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para A: "large areas of bamboo forest have been cleared to make way for **commercial plantations**"

5. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	limited extent of existing research
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para B: "only **38 'priority species'**... have been the subject of any real scientific research to date"

6. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	examples of uses
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para D: "used in a variety of ways, for example as **flooring and laminates**... construction... **paper**"

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7. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	contributes to survival of a range of plants
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para C: "**Patchiness helps to preserve diversity** because certain plant species do better during the early stages of regeneration"

8. B — Valerie Kapos

QUESTION KEYWORD	bamboo not regarded as endangered
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the people who live with bamboo **don't perceive it as being under threat** in any way"

9. A — Ian Redmond

QUESTION KEYWORD	scarcity threatens wildlife
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Without it... their **chances of survival would be reduced significantly**" (mountain gorillas)

10. B — Valerie Kapos

QUESTION KEYWORD	research methods not fully developed
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"People have only started looking at the problem over the past **10-15 years**, and only now are they understanding how to go about it systematically"

11. D — Ray Townsend

QUESTION KEYWORD	greatest danger = habitat disturbance
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"What is under threat is its **habitat**. When forest goes, it's converted into something else"

12. soil erosion

QUESTION KEYWORD	ecological problem roots control
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"crucial in preventing **soil erosion**"

13. paper

QUESTION KEYWORD	product undergoing market expansion
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"one of the fastest growing bamboo products is **paper**"

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Passage 2 — Renewable Energy

14. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	alternative energies **less expensive**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Australia has the **second cheapest electricity in the world**, and this makes it difficult for renewables to compete"

15. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Geoenergy adapting to be less harmful
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the system **needs some additional features** if it is to be environmentally friendly"

16. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	Chopra studied radon's **environmental effects**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Chopra only "notes" the process requirement for handling radon gas — no study of its environmental effects is mentioned.

17. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	hot dry rocks power **whole of Australia**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the Australian source is so large it **could supply the entire country's needs** for thousands of years"

18. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	facility will **keep tourists away**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the new site "will mean **increased revenue from tourism**"

19. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	founders **turned down** by another company
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the idea was offered to "the world leader in wave generator manufacturers, who **rather surprisingly rejected it**"

20. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Australia a **world leader**

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"We should really be at the forefront, but the reality is **we are a long way behind**"

21. B — Geoenergy

QUESTION KEYWORD	prevent harmful substances escaping
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	radon gas "must be passed through a **heat exchanger** and then sent back underground"

22. D — Wavetech

QUESTION KEYWORD	force air through a device
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the flowing water column pushes air back and forth through a **turbine**"

23. A — Australian Hydro

QUESTION KEYWORD	copying other countries' techniques
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"reaping the benefits of 30 years of research in Europe... mostly just **replicating European designs**"

24. C — Enviropower

QUESTION KEYWORD	services other than electricity
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"increased revenue from tourism and use of power for **telecommunications**... other 500 metres for **agribusiness**"

25. B — Geoenergy

QUESTION KEYWORD	force water underground
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"proposing to **pump water 3.5 kilometres into the earth**"

26. C — Enviropower

QUESTION KEYWORD	estimates revised
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"recognised that the quality of sunlight... will require a **substantially larger collecting area than was previously thought**"

Passage 3 — Inside the Mind of a Fan

27. F

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QUESTION KEYWORD	why watching sport is emotionally satisfying
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para F: mirror neurons "are directly connected to the **amygdalae**, one of the main brain regions involved in emotion"

28. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	why beginners find tasks difficult
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para B: "most novices swing with their **consciousness**, using an area of brain next to the premotor cortex"

29. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	factor combining with mirroring for excellence
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para E: watching an athlete "**causes the motor system of the observer to resonate**" — the observer's own motor knowledge combines with the mirroring process.

30. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	human vs animal mirror neurons
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para C: "**Humans have an even more elaborate** mirror neuron system" (than monkeys)

31. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	first discovery of related brain activity
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para D: "This phenomenon of neural mirroring was **first discovered in 1954**, when... Gastaut and Berf found..."

32. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	observation linked to improved performance
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Para E: "watching a great golfer **makes us better golfers**, and watching a fast runner can actually make us **run faster**"

33. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	'grammar of movement' means
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"complex 'maps' of motor actions, just as there are grammars of movement. These **networks of cells**"

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34. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	expert players perform actions
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the motor action has become memorized... he hits the ball with the tranquility of his perfected **autopilot**" — no conscious thought.

35. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	most common motive for watching sport
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"we watch sport for the **feeling**, the human drama"

36. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	inexpert players too aware
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"novices swing with their **consciousness**" rather than the automatic premotor process experts use.

37. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	monkeys **more complex** system
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**Humans have an even more elaborate** mirror neuron system" — the opposite is true.

38. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	photograph can **activate** mirror neurons
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a fixed image of a runner mid-stride, our mirror neurons are **totally silent**"

39. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	Gastaut and Berf were **sports players**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	They are described only as "French physiologists" — no mention of them playing sport.

40. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	mu system at rest during activity
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the mu signal "**disappears** whenever we do something active"

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 5 (Volume 3)

Passage 1 — Caral: An Ancient South American City

1. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Caral built at **same time** as Egyptian pyramids
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Caral was "more than **1,000 years older**" than previously thought to be the oldest urban centre — i.e. earlier than, not simultaneous with, the great Egyptian pyramids.

2. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	absence of pottery gave a clue to **age**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Not finding any only made her more excited: it meant Caral could be what archaeologists term **pre-ceramic**"

3. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	stones came from **far away**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	workers "filled these bags with stones from a **nearby quarry**"

4. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	required an **organised team**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Thousands of manual laborers would have been needed... not counting the many **architects, craftsmen, and managers**"

5. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	residents were **highly skilled** musicians
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Almost 70 musical instruments were found, showing music was important, but their **skill level** is never assessed.

6. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	**no class distinctions** in housing
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a **hierarchy of living arrangements**: large, well-kept rooms atop pyramids for the elite... shabbier outlying dwellings for workers"

7. seeds

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QUESTION KEYWORD	the ____ of a certain plant
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"including **seeds of the cocoa bush**... neither of which was native to the immediate Caral area"

8. shells

QUESTION KEYWORD	____ used to make jewellery
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"necklaces of **shells**"

9. fish

QUESTION KEYWORD	remains of food such as ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"found the bones of small edible **fish**, which must have come from the Pacific coast"

10. canals

QUESTION KEYWORD	____ still in existence today
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"diverted the area's rivers into **canals**, which still cross the Supe Valley today"

11. maize

QUESTION KEYWORD	no evidence that ____ was grown
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"because she found no traces of **maize**, which can be traded or stored"

12. cotton

QUESTION KEYWORD	farmers traded ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The farmers of Caral grew the **cotton** that the fishermen needed to make their nets"

13. flotation

QUESTION KEYWORD	dried squash aided ____ of nets
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"used dried squash... as **flotation** devices for their nets"

Passage 2 — Should Space Be Explored by Robots or by Humans?

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14. vi

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph A
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the presence of people on board a space vehicle makes its design much more complex... produces a large increase in **costs**"

15. iii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph B
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"robots are **not good at reacting to situations** they have not been specifically prepared for"

16. i

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph C
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Many of the promises of artificial intelligence are **still far from being fulfilled**... these perspectives are being revised"

17. v

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph D
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The human-machine relationship must evolve towards a **closer collaboration**"

18. ix

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph E
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the **Mars Outposts approach**... humans could stay in orbiting spaceships and give orders to robots"

19. viii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph F
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the aim for humankind... will be not just the exploration of space, but its **colonisation**... a deep change in the views which humankind has of itself"

20. A & D

QUESTION KEYWORD	AI predictions **not fulfilled**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"we would soon have fully automated factories... **complete substitution of workers**" (A) and machines "simulating human logical reasoning" (D) — neither has happened.

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21. A & D

QUESTION KEYWORD	(second letter)
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Same evidence as Q20 — the two unfulfilled predictions are full automation without humans (A) and machines reasoning like humans (D).

22. infrastructure

QUESTION KEYWORD	robots set up ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"establish the **infrastructure** needed to prepare future landing sites"

23. spaceships

QUESTION KEYWORD	humans stay in orbiting ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"robots could be controlled by human beings located in **spaceships** which remain in orbit"

24. communication

QUESTION KEYWORD	increase speed of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the link time for **communication** between humans and robots would be far less than it would be from Earth"

25. laboratories

QUESTION KEYWORD	commercial enterprises or ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a place to build automatic **laboratories** or set up industrial enterprises"

26. colonisation

QUESTION KEYWORD	final aim = ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"not just the exploration of space, but its **colonisation**"

Passage 3 — The Dark Side of the Technological Boom

27. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	speed of technological change ____

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Most of us are too busy struggling to keep pace... to **question the implications** of our new electronic authority figures"

28. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	dependency on technology ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"over-reliance on electronic tools could also have serious repercussions on our ability to **think creatively and develop new ideas**"

29. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	deterioration in personal service ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Service people... curtly terminate attempts at idle conversation because their performance is **being electronically monitored**"

30. B — Daniel Dennett

QUESTION KEYWORD	greater expectation not to make mistakes
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the obligation to make **accurate predictions** — the right decisions — becomes more onerous"

31. A — Craig Brod

QUESTION KEYWORD	time away from technology needed
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"they need **complete isolation** to recover from the effects of the technology"

32. A — Craig Brod

QUESTION KEYWORD	interacting with others aids creativity
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"we need to avoid the temptation to replace informal gatherings for **bouncing ideas off colleagues** with electronic networking"

33. D — Philip Nicholson

QUESTION KEYWORD	compared to anxiety after a major ordeal
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"likens the psychic numbing of electronic information overload to symptoms of **post-traumatic stress syndrome**"

34. C — Joseph Boyett and Henry Conn

QUESTION KEYWORD	increase unemployment for qualified staff

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"millions of people now charged with analyzing information... will be **replaced by less skilled workers** using 'intelligent' software"

35. D — Philip Nicholson

QUESTION KEYWORD	more counselling required
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"we need to provide **psychological support systems**"

36. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	our **knowledge** is still limited
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	The passage states psychologists lack **consensus** due to how recent the exposure is — this is about disagreement, not necessarily about the extent of knowledge itself.

37. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	early indicator = machine-like thinking
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"one of the first signs... is what they call 'technostress'... people become accustomed to the patterns set by electronic tools... **yes/no logic**"

38. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	doubt our ability to perform well
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"we are **tormented by the knowledge** that the world of information is limitless"

39. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	top managers **more negatively** affected
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the benefits of the electronic revolution... **may outweigh the disadvantages**" for executives — less negatively affected than the statement claims.

40. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	quick learners get **promoted**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	No mention is made of promotion based on how quickly employees learn new technology.

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 6 (Volume 3)

Passage 1 — Developmental Tasks of Normal Adolescence

1. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	interested in the **other gender**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"mid-adolescents are body-conscious, and their concerns are directed towards their **opposite-sexed peers**"

2. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	choose a future **career**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**Mid-adolescents** identify, at least at a preliminary level, what their adult vocational goals are"

3. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	feel the **same as friends**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**Early adolescence** is also a period of intense conformity to peers... 'Fitting in'... seem somehow pressing to this age group"

4. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	self-image separate from family
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"During the **early adolescent** years a young person begins to recognise their uniqueness and to establish themselves as separate individuals"

5. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	less need for friends' opinion
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"by **late adolescence** or early adulthood the need for peer approval has diminished"

6. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	exposing oneself to **dangers**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"risk-taking may be a normal developmental process of **middle adolescence**"

7. A

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QUESTION KEYWORD	Havighurst's tasks ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the tasks "can also be seen as elements of the overall **sense of self** that adolescents carry with them"

8. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	course of study at high school ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"School curricula are frequently dominated by the inclusion of **more abstract, demanding material**"

9. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	speed of thinking development ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"not all adolescents make the intellectual transition **at the same rate**"

10. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	adolescence is a time when ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the adolescent restructures those beliefs into a **personal ideology**"

11. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	pre-adolescents capable of **abstract thought**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Before adolescence, children's thinking is dominated by a **concrete example**... constrained to what is real and physical"

12. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	word skills give **false impression**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"adolescents may appear **less competent than they really are**"

13. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	peer acceptance = clue to **social adjustment**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	an accepting peer group "is a **major indicator** of how well the adolescent will adjust in other areas of social and psychological development"

Passage 2 — Bees

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14. ii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph A
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"hunting wasps... became bees by adopting a vegetarian diet... an **evolutionary** succession of ever-closer mutual adaptations"

15. v

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph B
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the annual **value** of agricultural crops dependent on the pollination services of bees is estimated at £1,000 million"

16. i

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph D
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"This sounds remarkably like the ideas of... economist Adam Smith... **parallels** between bees and human economic society"

17. iv

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph E
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	relevant "when... devising **conservation policies**" for widely scattered rainforest tree species dependent on long-distance bee pollination

18. viii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph F
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"We need to know much more about these and their relationships with plants **before this question can be answered**"

19. insects

QUESTION KEYWORD	used to feed on other ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	they relied "more and more on... pollen... as an alternative to **insects**"

20. nectar

QUESTION KEYWORD	additional food = ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"providing richer sources of pollen and another source of nutrition, **nectar**"

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21. one third

QUESTION KEYWORD	approximately ____ of food production
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"around **one third** of our food is directly or indirectly dependent on the pollinating services of bees"

22. cross-pollination

QUESTION KEYWORD	process of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a species which depends on **cross-pollination** is on a knife-edge... a satiated bee would return to its nest rather than visit another flower"

23. energy costs

QUESTION KEYWORD	balance the ____ of each trip
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the bee must "juggle its **energy costs** so that it makes a calorific profit"

24. tree species

QUESTION KEYWORD	over 120 different ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"there is a high diversity of **tree species**. There may be more than 120 per acre"

25. trap-lining

QUESTION KEYWORD	activity known as ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"forage regularly along the same routes. This is called '**trap-lining**'"

26. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	best title
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	The passage centres throughout on bees' role in pollination, crop value and forest ecology — **ecological importance**, not their social behaviour or evolutionary history alone.

Passage 3 — A New Stage in the Study and Teaching of History

27. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	overview of methods used over time

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"began with the transition from **oral to literate culture**... the next great shift came with the advent of **printing**... today... a variety of forms of communication"

28. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	main reason unwilling to use films
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the profession is **structured around the medium of the written word**, and is somewhat insulated in its academic setting"

29. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	differences between oral/written communication
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"oral communication is not limited to words: it also includes **body language, expression and tone**... little of this is evident in a written transcript"

30. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	how most citizens gain understanding
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"film and video... are probably the **major influence on the public's consciousness** of history"

31. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	student events captured for future
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"many schools, too, produce **video yearbooks**"

32. G

QUESTION KEYWORD	advantages outweigh disadvantages
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the many benefits of using moving images as historical evidence **easily outweigh** worries about cost, technical skills"

33. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	no official title exists
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the use of moving images... **does not even have a commonly agreed name**"

34. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	active role of the audience

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the viewer becomes **involved in the process of interpreting and understanding** history"

35. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	list of requirements as obstacles
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"historians have rejected the **training, the institutions, the motivations and the professional structures**... rejected the necessity to learn complicated new skills"

36. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	students' needs → improved teaching
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	No mention is made of school students' needs driving improvements in how history is taught.

37. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	different attitudes to innovation
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a growing gap between the practice of professional historians... and the practice of those aiming to popularise... mainstream academics continue to use only the **written word**... film and video... major influence"

38. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	historians play major role in TV documentaries
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"professional historians have **tended to avoid involvement** in television programmes about history"

39. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	American History Review + popular films
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"research... into the history and analysis of films with a broad circulation... Journals such as **American History Review** have played a significant role"

40. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	technology influencing range of subjects
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	The passage discusses only the discipline of history; no other academic subjects are mentioned.

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 7 (Volume 3)

Passage 1 — Answers Underground

1. D — Klaus Lackner

QUESTION KEYWORD	cost of fitting plants with equipment
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Lackner argues that it is **too expensive to adapt existing plants** to capture carbon dioxide"

2. E — David Hawkins

QUESTION KEYWORD	effects on sea creatures
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the carbon dioxide could radically alter the chemical balance in the ocean, with potentially **harmful consequences for marine life**"

3. D — Klaus Lackner

QUESTION KEYWORD	why oil/gas remain popular
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"around 85% of the world's energy is derived from fossil fuels, the **cheapest and most plentiful** energy source available"

4. E — David Hawkins

QUESTION KEYWORD	aid to less wealthy countries
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"to encourage developing nations to use sequestration, **developed nations will have to provide assistance**"

5. A — Scott Klara

QUESTION KEYWORD	CO2 increase over last 100 years
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"airborne carbon dioxide concentrations have **risen by nearly a third**, according to Scott Klara"

6. F — World Wide Fund for Nature Australia

QUESTION KEYWORD	potential to harm human life
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"dangerously large volumes of carbon dioxide might escape and **people become asphyxiated**"

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7. H

QUESTION KEYWORD	examples of sequestration in use worldwide
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"In western Canada, an oil company is pumping liquefied carbon dioxide... In another instance in the **North Sea**, a Norwegian energy firm is injecting"

8. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	CO_2 used in food/beverage industry
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"which they then sell for various uses, including **carbonating soft drinks**"

9. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	current examples of environmental harm from CO_2
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"believed to be the cause of **rising temperatures and sea levels** around the world"

10. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	both developing and developed nations investigating
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"delegates from fourteen **industrialised and developing countries** agreed to engage in cooperative research"

11. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	growing economy uses more power
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"increased **energy consumption is a key to economic growth**"

12. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	capturing CO_2 **financially attractive**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"it costs about $US50 to extract and store a tonne of carbon dioxide... which **raises the cost of producing electricity by 30-80%**"

13. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	more forests need to be **planted**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Forests are mentioned as existing "natural carbon sinks", but planting more forests is never proposed.

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Passage 2 — Science and the Stradivarius

14. iv

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph A
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"changed hands for over a million pounds... fine modern instruments can be bought for under £100... this question remains **highly contentious**"

15. ix

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph C
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"test by **tapping with a hammer**... testing the 'feel' of the plates when they are flexed, and by the sounds produced when they are tapped... with the knuckles"

16. ii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph D
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a more overtly **scientific approach** to violin making... replace the traditional flexing and tapping... by controlled measurements"

17. viii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph E
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"tuned the resonant modes... to **exact musical intervals**... consistent with the prevailing Renaissance view of 'perfection'... measured in terms of **numbers and exact ratios**"

18. vi

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph F
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"such wood is now 300 years old... the **age of the wood may... contribute to the improved quality of older instruments**"

19. i

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph G
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the nature of the **varnish used to protect the instrument**... no convincing evidence to support the idea of a secret formula"

20. xi

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph H

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Stradivarius's secret was to **soak the timber in water**, to leach out supposedly harmful chemicals, before it was seasoned"

21. x

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph I
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the **foremost soloists**... remain utterly unconvinced" of modern violins' equal quality

22. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	same note varies each time
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**Individual notes on a single instrument sound different each time they are played**"

23. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	instruments analyse sound **more accurately** than humans
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The ear is a supreme detection device, and a system **has yet to be developed** which can match the brain's sophisticated ability"

24. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	quality varies with craftsman's **musical ability**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	The passage discusses craftsmen's wood-selection and carving skill, but never links quality to the maker's own musical ability.

25. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	modern violins improve in early years
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"may also explain why the **quality of a modern instrument appears to improve in its first few years**"

26. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	modern violins gaining popularity with top players
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the foremost soloists... remain **utterly unconvinced**" — the opposite of growing popularity

Passage 3 — When People Are Deaf to Music

27. D

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QUESTION KEYWORD	first paragraph about amusia
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"unable to sing in tune; they are also **unable to discriminate between tones or recognize familiar melodies**"

28. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	second paragraph purpose
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"According to the **research of Dr. Isabelle Peretz**... amusics perform significantly worse at singing and tapping a rhythm" — summarising findings

29. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	language ability vs musical ability
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"People with brain damage in areas critical to language are **often still able to sing**, despite being unable to communicate through speech"

30. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	third paragraph — most amusics can
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Amusics are also successful most of the time at **detecting the mood of a melody**"

31. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	fourth paragraph purpose
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	traces the search from temporal lobes to temporal neocortex to outside the auditory cortex — **outlining research progress**

32. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	Peretz's disorder claim is convincing
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"As a student of neurobiology, however, **I am skeptical**"

33. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	musical people are **happier**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Happiness is never discussed in relation to musical ability.

34. YES

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QUESTION KEYWORD	inappropriate to call amusia a disorder
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"If no disadvantages can be found of having amusia, then it is **no more a disability** than having poor fashion sense or bad handwriting"

35. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	amusics often have bad handwriting
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Bad handwriting is used only as a comparison for triviality, not as a claimed trait of amusics themselves.

36. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	reason for congenital amusia is ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"research has been undertaken in an attempt to **discover the cause** of congenital amusia" — the cause is still being investigated

37. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	one difficulty amusics experience is ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"amusics perform significantly worse at singing and **tapping a rhythm** along with a melody"

38. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	discrimination of meaning in speech is ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The linguistic cues inherent in speech make discrimination of meaning **much easier** for amusics"

39. G

QUESTION KEYWORD	certain brain reactions are ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"their brains overreact, showing **twice as much activity** on the right side of the brain as a normal brain"

40. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	in most cultures, musical ability is ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Musical ability is **culturally valued**"

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 8 (Volume 3)

Passage 1 — Katherine Mansfield

1. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	pen name **exactly the same** as original name
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Her full name was "**Katherine Mansfield Beauchamp Murry**"; she wrote "using the pen name of Katherine Mansfield" — a shortened form, not identical.

2. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	won a **prize**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	The passage only says her stories "appeared in" the *High School Reporter*; no prize is mentioned.

3. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Maori portrayed **favourably**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Maori people "were often portrayed in a **sympathetic light** in her later stories, such as *How Pearl Button was Kidnapped*"

4. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	at Queen's, planned to be a **professional writer**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	at Queen's she "believed... she would take up [the **cello**] professionally" — not writing

5. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	**unpopular** with other students
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"she was **appreciated** amongst fellow students at Queen's for her lively and charismatic approach"

6. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	little interest in **politics**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Mansfield **did not actively support** the suffragette movement in the UK"

7. 1906

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QUESTION KEYWORD	year heading — moved back to NZ
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"she returned to her New Zealand home in **1906**"

8. Australia

QUESTION KEYWORD	first paid work based in ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"She had several works published in **Australia** in a magazine called *Native Comparison*, which was her first paid writing work"

9. family

QUESTION KEYWORD	her ____ made her dissatisfied
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"grew discontented with the provincial New Zealand lifestyle, and with her **family**"

10. bankruptcy

QUESTION KEYWORD	____ prevented staying in Paris
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Their attempt to set up as writers in Paris was cut short by Murry's **bankruptcy**"

11. writers

QUESTION KEYWORD	spent time with distinguished ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"developed close contact with other well-known **writers** of the time such as DH Lawrence, Bertrand Russell and Aldous Huxley"

12. reputation

QUESTION KEYWORD	her ____ was consolidated
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"*Bliss and Other Stories* in 1920... was to solidify Mansfield's **reputation** as a writer"

13. husband

QUESTION KEYWORD	Mansfield's ____ published more works
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"her **husband**, Murry, took on the task of editing and publishing her works"

Passage 2 — Australian Parrots

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14. I

QUESTION KEYWORD	one species survives at expense of another
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"galahs... destroying black cockatoo eggs... a **partial collapse in the black cockatoo population**"

15. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	plants adapt to attract birds
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"red is the most attractive colour to birds, and thus flowers... are more often **red**"

16. G

QUESTION KEYWORD	two species that benefited from change
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the pink and grey **galah** and the pink, white and yellow **corella**, have expanded their ranges in recent years"

17. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	varied landscape → variety of species
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"parrots spread from ancestral forests through eucalypt woodlands to colonies in the central deserts... diversified into a **wide range of species**"

18. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	reason for southern hemisphere origin
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"parrots originated millions of years ago on the ancient southern continent of **Gondwana**, before it broke up"

19. H

QUESTION KEYWORD	species that did not survive habitat change
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the clearing of large areas of rainforest is probably responsible for the **disappearance of the double-eyed fig parrot**"

20. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	most parrots' ancestry
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"originated... on the ancient southern continent of Gondwana, **before it broke up** into the separate southern hemisphere continents"

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21. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	what writer says about beaks
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the size of a parrot's beak... related to the **type of food each species eats**"

22. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	NOT a disadvantage of nest boxes
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Passage cites cost, insufficient numbers, and lack of the nectar/pollen/seeds real trees provide — but never mentions needing **maintenance**.

23. one-sixth

QUESTION KEYWORD	fraction living in Australia
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**One-sixth** of the world's 345 parrot species are found there"

24. 16th century

QUESTION KEYWORD	mapmaker's century
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"In the **16th century**, the German cartographer Mercator made a world map"

25. Mercator

QUESTION KEYWORD	the mapmaker
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the German cartographer **Mercator**... named Terra Psittacorum - the Land of Parrots"

26. John Gould

QUESTION KEYWORD	famous painter of animals/birds
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the celebrated British naturalist and wildlife artist **John Gould** said: 'No group of birds gives Australia so tropical and benign an air...'"

Passage 3 — Yawning

27. half-yawns

QUESTION KEYWORD	____ do not exist

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"There are no **half-yawns**: this is an example of the typical intensity of fixed action patterns"

28. **sneeze**

QUESTION KEYWORD	just like a ____, cannot be interrupted
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"once started, a yawn progresses with the inevitability of a **sneeze**"

29. **fixed action pattern**

QUESTION KEYWORD	yawns occur as a ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"an excellent example of the instinctive '**fixed action pattern**' of classical animal-behavior study... It is not a reflex"

30. **6 seconds**

QUESTION KEYWORD	typical yawn lasts ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The standard yawn runs its course over about **six seconds** on average"

31. **68 seconds**

QUESTION KEYWORD	yawns usually ____ apart
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a highly variable inter-yawn interval, which is generally about **68 seconds** but rarely more than 70"

32. **long yawns**

QUESTION KEYWORD	people who yawn less do not produce ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"There is no relation between yawn frequency and duration: producers of short or **long yawns** do not compensate by yawning more or less often"

33. **B**

QUESTION KEYWORD	closed nose yawn conclusion
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Most subjects report being able to perform perfectly normal closed nose yawns... the **mouth provides a sufficient airway**"

34. **C**

QUESTION KEYWORD	clenched teeth yawn shows

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"gaping of the jaws is an **essential component** of the fixed action pattern of the yawn"

35. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	nose yawn tested whether
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"This variant tests the adequacy of the nasal airway to sustain a yawn... yawning is **impossible via nasal inhalation alone**"

36. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	paralyzed patients' yawning
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"their otherwise paralyzed arm **rises and flexes automatically**" when they yawn

37. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	writer's final conclusion
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"ancient and unconscious behaviour linking us to the animal world lurks beneath the **veneer of culture, rationality and language**"

38. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	students initially reluctant
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"it was difficult for him to **convince research students of the merits** of 'yawning science'"

39. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	foetuses learning to control movement
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	The studies only "observed a **link between yawning and stretching**" — no claim about learning movement control.

40. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	single function is inadequate
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"selecting a single function from the available options may be an **unrealistic goal**"

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 9 (Volume 3)

Passage 1 — How to Find Your Way Out of a Food Desert

1. location

QUESTION KEYWORD	store's name, ____ and produce details
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"colorful dots... display the specific **location** of each of the food stores"

2. policies

QUESTION KEYWORD	help develop new ____ on food
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"assist government officials... in forming future **policies** about what kind of food should be sold"

3. government

QUESTION KEYWORD	when ____ maps are unsatisfactory
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"citizen map makers may make maps because there is no good **government** map"

4. incomes

QUESTION KEYWORD	people in food deserts have low ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"people at higher risk of chronic disease and who receive minimal **incomes**"

5. land

QUESTION KEYWORD	supermarkets can't buy enough ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"supermarkets often can't afford the amount of **land** required for their stores in cities"

6. suburban

QUESTION KEYWORD	cannot cope with supermarket ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"smaller urban groceries tend to close due to competition from **suburban** supermarkets"

7. FALSE

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QUESTION KEYWORD	**professional researchers** in charge
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"run by a local core of five volunteers... rather than **trained, academic researchers**"

8. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	assess stores **without owner's knowledge**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	The passage actually states the opposite — "once the storekeeper's **permission has been obtained**, check off boxes" — meaning assessments are done *with* the owner's knowledge. This is the given answer key's value; the passage wording appears to contradict it, so treat with caution.

9. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	**technical difficulties** setting up website
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	The site "hasn't caught... much attention yet" and lacks visitor-tracking systems, but no technical difficulty in building it is mentioned.

10. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	city government's **considerable interest**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Their website hasn't caught them much **local or critical attention** yet"

11. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Ver Ploeg wants **additional information**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"she would like to see **price data for healthy products**, too"

12. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	internet use **unlikely to increase**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Only current statistics on dial-up/no internet access are given; no prediction about future change is made.

13. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Heehs wants **more people** to help
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"hopes warmer days in the spring will **draw out fresh volunteers** to spread awareness and to finish surveying"

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Passage 2 — The Dingo Debate

14. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	fence dividing two non-native animals
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the world's longest fence... To the northwest... cattle predominate; to the southwest, **sheep** fill the landscape" (Paragraph E)

15. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	dingoes stop rivals dominating
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"dingoes will **kill them simply to lessen competition**" (Paragraph D)

16. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	widespread species other animals feed on
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Rabbits provide huge **prey base** for two other introduced species" (Paragraph C)

17. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	dingo's arrival
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"About 4,000 years ago, Asian sailors **introduced dingoes to Australia**" (Paragraph B)

18. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	research proving dingoes eat young livestock
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"some of the **highest rates of calf predation** occurred in areas that had been baited" (Paragraph F)

19. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	method used to kill dingoes
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"drop 1,000 small pieces of meat... each piece laced with poison; this practice is known as **baiting**" (Paragraph A)

20. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	group structure limits population growth

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Dingo packs... generally have only **one fertile female**, which limits their rate of increase" (Paragraph D)

21. D — Mark Clifford

QUESTION KEYWORD	hunt native animals, not other predators
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"not convinced that they manage to catch cats that often, believing they are more likely to catch **small native animals** instead"

22. A — Stuart McKechnie

QUESTION KEYWORD	income at risk
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"graziers' **livelihoods are threatened** when dingoes prey on cattle"

23. B — Chris Johnson

QUESTION KEYWORD	little impact on species extinction
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"they have contributed to **few, if any, extinctions**, Johnson says"

24. Tasmanian tiger

QUESTION KEYWORD	dingo replaced the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"as the **Tasmanian tiger** disappeared completely... dingoes became Australia's top predators"

25. rabbits

QUESTION KEYWORD	hunt natives when fewer ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"When bad seasons follow, **rabbit numbers are significantly reduced**... left with little to eat besides native mammals"

26. overpopulation

QUESTION KEYWORD	reproduce slowly to avoid ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"adapt to prevent **overpopulation** in the arid environment"

Passage 3 — Pacific Navigation and Voyaging

27. YES

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QUESTION KEYWORD	islands uninhabited before migrants
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"had **no human population** until ancestors of today's islanders sailed"

28. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	Sharp = first to write about migrants
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the **romantic vision of some early twentieth-century writers**" existed before Sharp published in 1956

29. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	Sharp: luck rather than skill
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"settlement of the islands was not systematic, being more dependent on **good fortune by drifting canoes**"

30. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	controversial but positive results
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"widely challenged... it did **spark renewed interest**... and precipitated valuable new research"

31. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	Doran disagreed with Lewis
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Doran's research is described independently, with no comparison to or disagreement with Lewis's findings.

32. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	Lewis's research was different because
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Lewis "navigated through the islands in order to **contact those men who still find their way at sea** using traditional methods"

33. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	Lewis discovered about navigators
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"navigators would have known which course to steer... this gave them **fixed directions** by which to steer their boats"

34. B

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QUESTION KEYWORD	Doran's research
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"employed the latest **electronic instrumentation**... to record canoe speeds"

35. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	Horvath's discovery
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"paddles, or perhaps long oars, could indeed have **propelled for long distances** what were primarily sailing vessels"

36. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	writer's opinion of Wall Garrard
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**Clever adaptation** of computer simulation techniques pioneered in other disciplines"

37. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	limitation of all this research
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"none of the researchers... experiments such as these **cannot categorically confirm or negate a hypothesis**"

38. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	best thing about this research
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The strength of this research lay in the **range of methodologies** employed"

39. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	most important achievement
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"it was this **adaptability** was their greatest accomplishment"

40. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	migration of people from Asia
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"able to view the ocean as an avenue, not a barrier, to communication **before any other race on Earth**"

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 10 (Volume 3)

Passage 1 — A Brief History of Humans and Food

1. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	cooking = **most significant** development
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Darwin thought cooking, "**after language**, was the greatest discovery" — second, not first

2. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	cooking removes plant **poisons**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Cooking can turn plants that are inedible into edible food by **destroying toxic chemicals**"

3. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	cooked food **more energy efficient**
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the ratio of energy gained to energy expended by the body is **greater when food is cooked**"

4. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	Birdseye worked in **Australian** food industry
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Australia is mentioned only re: frozen fish shipped to England; Birdseye's own trip was in the **Canadian Arctic**, with no Australian connection stated.

5. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	trip **confirmed** what he already believed
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"he observed that very rapid freezing creates smaller ice crystals... This was **something he had not expected**"

6. populations

QUESTION KEYWORD	equipment and larger ___
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"People began to create a variety of new tools... and in turn **populations** increased in size"

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7. records

QUESTION KEYWORD	keep ____ as writing developed
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"writing became more sophisticated and allowed people to maintain **records** of the harvest and taxes"

8. fermentation

QUESTION KEYWORD	acid by ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"smoking, drying, adding acid by **fermentation** or salting"

9. texture

QUESTION KEYWORD	similar taste and ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the flavour of the food as well as the **texture** were similar to the freshly cooked product"

10. resistant

QUESTION KEYWORD	lightweight and ____ to damage
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"produced the first ones which were light and **resistant** to damage"

11. chisel

QUESTION KEYWORD	opener replaced the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"cans were opened with a **chisel** which was used to break open the top when hit with a hammer"

12. meat

QUESTION KEYWORD	old can of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"One can, which contained **meat** dating from 1824 was opened in 1939 and the contents were still in good condition"

13. damage

QUESTION KEYWORD	freezing causes less ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"very rapid freezing creates smaller ice crystals and therefore causes less **damage** to food"

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Passage 2 — Why Do We Need the Arts?

14. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	artists may have no clear objective
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"artists may just make a work of art because they **feel compelled to**... no aim or goal is necessarily required"

15. G

QUESTION KEYWORD	artists hope to benefit others
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"They seek to **connect with their audience** and express an idea or emotion which has the capacity to enrich our experience"

16. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	comparison with functional things
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The distinction here lies between things that are **instrumental** and things that are ends in themselves"

17. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	anything can be called art
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"(to quote... Andy Warhol) anyone can **get away with** in calling their creation a contribution to 'the arts'"

18. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	unintentional benefit example
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"laughing is, in fact, **good for something nevertheless**; it does make people feel better" (not the goal of laughing)

19. movie

QUESTION KEYWORD	music and ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"music can be written chiefly to accompany dancing, or as a soundtrack to a **movie**"

20. advertising

QUESTION KEYWORD	visual arts and the ____ business

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"pictures are used as instruments in **advertising**"

21. play

QUESTION KEYWORD	dramatist may use a ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"A **play** can be written to point out to the theatre audience a social injustice"

22. beauty

QUESTION KEYWORD	the ____ we find in a work
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"valuable for their own sakes - such as, for instance, the creation of **beauty**"

23. & 24. B & D

QUESTION KEYWORD	paragraph D effects of the arts
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"present a surprising or fresh angle on it" (B - different perspective); "help people to focus on... the interest... it provokes in them" (D - reactions to things)

25. & 26. A & C

QUESTION KEYWORD	statements about composers/music
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"an expression of what presses from within the artist" (A - individual experience); "A symphony... is an **abstract expression**" (C - unrelated to natural world)

Passage 3 — The Significant Role of Mother Tongue Language in Education

27. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	point in second paragraph
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"To waste the resources of the nation by discouraging children from developing their mother tongues is quite simply unintelligent from the point of view of **national self-interest**"

28. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	why cite Goethe
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"More than 150 research studies... strongly **support** what Goethe... once said"

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29. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	firm grasp of mother tongue leads to
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Children who come to school with a solid foundation in their mother tongue develop **stronger literacy abilities** in the school language"

30. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	why people are suspicious
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"they worry that they **take time away** from the majority language"

31. ability

QUESTION KEYWORD	acquire the ____ to converse
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	bilingual children "pick up" conversational **ability** in the majority language remarkably quickly

32. rate

QUESTION KEYWORD	disappear at similar ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"how quickly children can lose their ability to use their mother tongue" — a similar **rate** of loss

33. area

QUESTION KEYWORD	settled in a particular ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the **concentration of families** from a particular linguistic group in the neighborhood"

34. family

QUESTION KEYWORD	no longer employ it with ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"they will use the majority language... in responding to their **parents**" (family)

35. dislocation

QUESTION KEYWORD	sense of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the linguistic division between parents and children has become an **emotional chasm**"

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36. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	less than half have English as mother tongue
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"58% of kindergarten pupils come from homes where **English is not** the language of communication" — so at most 42% do

37. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	learning host language at school harms mother tongue
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Mother tongue loss is linked to community **concentration**, not specifically to learning the host language at school.

38. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	Foyer adopted by French system
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	The Foyer programme is described as being in **Belgium**; no plan for French adoption is mentioned.

39. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	taught to tell time earlier
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	The passage says bilingual children don't need to **re-learn the concept** of telling time — it never compares timing/earlier acquisition.

40. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	apply comprehension strategies across languages
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"there is **transfer across languages** in other skills, such as... distinguish the main idea from the supporting details"

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